

General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.

February 1, 2021 via video conference

1:00 p.m.

The trustees of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. held their first quarterly meeting via video conference with Chair Michele Grinberg, presiding.

Chair Michele Grinberg called the meeting to order, opened with a moment of silence, followed by the serenity prayer.

Present: Leslie Backus; Cathy Beckham; Beau Bush; Hon. Christine Carpenter; James Dean; Josh Eggleston; Mark Everett; Kathryn Fowler; Francis H. Gilroy; Sister Judith Ann Karam, CSA; Patricia LaNauze; Jan Lembke; Michael Lewis, Peter F. Luongo, Ph.D. LCSW-C; Nancy J. McCarthy; Al J. Mooney, M.D.; David T. Noll; Newton Pritchett; Ginger Rhoades-Bell and Irma Van De Bon-Nicol.

At the invitation of the Board, the following persons were also present: Amy Bailey, Brenda Brown, Clement Cann, Patrick Claymore, Mary Cumings, Irene Donoso, James Hurst, Racy Joseph, Paul Konigstein, Diana Lewis, Stephanie Lyles, Zenaida Medina, Michelle Mirza, Steve Smith, Greg Tobin, Craig Weidner, Sandra Wilson, Jeff Wine and Jacob Diaz, recording secretary. Also present were A.A.W.S. Directors: Deborah Koltai, Carolyn Walsh-Barnes; AA Grapevine Directors: Ino Fernandez, Tommi Hanley; and Appointed Committee Member Shari Miller.

Also present as guests of the Board were the delegate chair Donny MacLean and Conference Committee chairs, Mary Ferguson, Kevin Fowler, Debi Keane, Bill Lewis, Ruth Llano, Jamey Nehring, Jess Nickum, Sheri Poore, Gary Provo, Randy Shaw, Shane Shepard, J.J. Stafford, and Sandi Wright.

Chair's remarks: Chair Michele Grinberg warmly welcomed all to the First Quarterly Meeting of the Trustees and Members of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. She shared what a joy and privilege it has been to work with this group of servant leaders, thanked all those on staff at the G.S.O. who help make the board's vision a reality, thanked Greg for his leadership, and thanked the delegate chairs for making it such an enjoyable and productive weekend.

Minutes: Following a motion and second, the minutes of the November 2, 2020 Fourth Quarterly Meeting of the Trustees and Members of the General Service Board were approved.

Communications: The secretary, Mark Everett, reported on six communications that were received including one on the need for a policy concerning the employment of Canadian citizens at G.S.O. and several regarding the disposition of proposed agenda items.

Corporate Reports:

Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.): Chairperson Beau Bush presented a written report on behalf of the corporation.

The Board noted the record amount of Seventh Tradition contributions from the Fellowship in response to the loss of Publishing revenue.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report.

Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.: Chairperson Kathi Fowler presented a written report on behalf of the corporation.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report.

Reports of Trustees' Committees:

Trustees' Archives Committee: Chairperson Francis Gilroy presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Committee on Archives the "Report on Proposed Book on A.A. history."

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Archives Committee.

Trustees' General Service Conference Committee: Chairperson Cathy Beckham presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions six proposed agenda items related to the topic of online groups not affiliated with a physical meeting space, having a voice and a vote in the General Service structure.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions a proposed agenda item to "Request a procedure be drafted to appeal a ruling by the Conference chair. This procedure may include that the chair provides an explanation as to such ruling and the process for challenging a ruling of the chair as defined in Robert's Rules of Order."

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Committee on Agenda a proposed agenda item to "Consider the implementation of new opportunities for A.A. members to submit input on the General Service Conference agenda items prior to the full Conference convening." The committee understands the importance of pre-Conference meetings that occur across the U.S./Canada service structure to gather local member input.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions a proposed agenda item to "Consider revising the Process for Polling the General Service Conference between Annual Meetings as to include virtual meeting technologies."

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Report and Charter Committee a proposed agenda item to "Update paragraph 1 of the current Conference charter, the Purpose, to include the Concepts in addition to the Steps and Traditions as the legacies

that the General Service Conference serves as guardians for. The revised text of the Purpose paragraph would read “The General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous is the guardian of the world services and of the Twelve Steps, the Twelve Traditions and the Twelve Concepts of Alcoholics Anonymous....”

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Report and Charter Committee a proposed agenda item to “Update the Concept XI essay to accurately describe both the Trustee Committee structure and the organization of the service corporations, Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc., and the AA Grapevine, Inc. The ownership of these service corporations by the General Service Board should also be clarified.”

The committee agreed to forward the revised proposed process for equitable distribution of workload including a scoring tool to the 2021 Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions for consideration.

The committee agreed to forward the report on the newly developed Conference Committee Assignment Application implemented for the 2020 Committee Selection process to the 2021 Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions for consideration.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Committee on Agenda the “Report to the Conference on the Implementation and Effectiveness of the 2021 Conference Agenda Process.” This report includes an annual survey of Conference committee chairs about the effectiveness of the communication between the trustees’ committee chair or corporate board chair and the corresponding Conference committee chair.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation to invite ACM members from trustees’ committees to attend the 71st General Service Conference, except sessions designated for delegates or trustees only, on a one-year trial basis, as non-Conference members to share points of information, be approved.

The Board considered a recommendation to extend an open invitation to all Panel 70 delegates to attend a future face-to-face General Service Conference as a non-voting observer with each delegate to cover their own expense for the trip. After a wide-ranging discussion, a motion to recommit the item to the Trustees’ Committee on the General Service Conference was made, seconded, and passed.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees’ Committee on the General Service Conference.

Trustees’ Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee: Chairperson Peter Luongo presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community the draft update of the pamphlet “Members of the Clergy Ask about A.A.”

The committee received a verbal update regarding the pamphlet “A.A. for the Older

Alcoholic.” The committee noted that additional stories would be helpful for the development of the pamphlet. The committee requested that the staff secretary initiate another call for stories with a deadline no later than March 15. The committee suggested that a subcommittee to work on story selection might be formed at the July 2021 meeting. The committee agreed to forward a progress report to the 2021 Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.

The committee listened to one final draft of an audio interview by the Appointed Committee Member (ACM) and an A.A. member in the military. The committee expressed appreciation for the work being done and noted the effectiveness of the interview format for carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics in the Armed Services. The committee asked the secretary to work with the Publishing department to finalize the three remaining audio interviews by the ACM and A.A. member from the military. The committee agreed to forward a progress report to the 2021 Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees’ Committee on C.P.C./Treatment and Accessibilities.

Trustees’ Corrections Committee: Chairperson Nancy McCarthy presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Committee on Corrections a proposed agenda item “that the Conference Committee on Corrections review corrections related literature intended for use by members in corrections facilities and take action to remove the words 'inmate' and 'offender' from A.A.W.S. literature and replace these words with more inclusive terms.”

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Committee on Corrections a proposed agenda item to “request sharing from the Fellowship to assist A.A. groups in finding innovative ways of carrying the message to alcoholics in correctional facilities/programs” for consideration and discussion.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees’ Committee on Corrections.

Trustees’ Finance and Budgetary Committee: Chairperson Leslie Backus presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

The committee agreed to forward the following agenda items to the 2021 Conference Committee on Finance:

- a. Review the Ad Hoc Committee Progress Report – Google Grants and the Seventh Tradition.
- b. Consider the relevance and applicability of the passage in the essay portion of Concept Twelve, Warranty Two, (*A.A. Service Manual*, p. 62) which states that

neither the groups nor A.A. as a whole should function as a 'money charity' via the practice of 'selling of our books at cost or less'.

- c. Discuss how the pamphlet "Self-Support – Where Money and Spirituality Mix" has contributed to the mechanization of Group contributions that has not worked well in these peculiar times.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation to approve the 2021 G.S.O. budget, which reflects total revenues of \$15,594,000, total expenses of \$14,952,613 and a bottom-line surplus of \$641,387 before depreciation.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation to approve the 2021 Grapevine budget, which reflects total revenues of 1,358,481 and a bottom-line deficit of \$354,225.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation to approve the 2021 La Viña budget, which reflects total revenues of \$62,968 and a bottom-line net cost of \$401,790.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that Grapevine be reimbursed \$180,000 for expenses from the 2020 International Convention.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee.

Trustees' International Committee: Chairperson Newton Pritchett presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation to adopt the revised "Purpose of International Travel by Trustees & Staff (A.A., U.S./Canada)" as policy.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that the U.S./Canada participate in Argentina's Region 6 Forum on May 15, 2021, providing the virtual platform, technical expertise, interpretation in French and Spanish, with a projected cost of \$16,500.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' International Committee.

Trustees' International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee: Chairperson Jan Lembke presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that the addition of a virtual pan-continental Special Forum targeting certain international and U.S./Canada remote communities be held near the end of 2021.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee.

Trustees' Literature Committee: Chairperson David Noll presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

The committee agreed to forward the following agenda items to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature:

- a. Review a draft memo to the Conference Literature committee related to the request to update the pamphlet "A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic" as part of the background of this committee which is already being forwarded for the agenda item under consideration by the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.
- b. Discuss draft language on safety and A.A. to be included in the booklet, *Living Sober*, and the pamphlet, "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship." The committee noted that care was taken to address accessible reading levels in the draft language.
- c. Review a draft update of the pamphlet, "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated," with the working title, "Experience Has Taught Us: Our Twelve Traditions Illustrated." The committee noted that the revision suggestions from the 2020 Conference Committee on Literature were addressed.
- d. Review a draft of the pamphlet for Spanish-speaking women in A.A.
- e. Review draft pamphlet based on A.A.'s Three Legacies with the working title, "Recovery, Unity and Service: Our Three Legacies."
- f. Review the draft revised pamphlet "Young People and A.A." The committee suggested that the Publishing department forward the stories that were submitted but not included in the pamphlet for consideration in the A.A. Grapevine.
- g. Discuss a progress report from the Subcommittee on "Researching Issues, Possible Tools and Access to the Book (2020-21 RIPTAB), *Alcoholics Anonymous*."
- h. Consider adding the Long Form of each Tradition at the beginning of each essay for that Tradition in the book *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*.
- i. Consider updating the pamphlet, "A.A. for the Native North American."
- j. Consider the development of a draft Fifth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, noting past Advisory Actions.
- k. Consider revising the pamphlet "The A.A. Group," to reflect the importance of the group as a "spiritual entity" as stated in the Long Form of Tradition Five.
- l. Consider revising language on page 29, question 9 in the pamphlet, "The A.A. Group."

- m. Review a draft update of the pamphlet "Is A.A. for You?"
- n. Review a draft update of the pamphlet "Is there an Alcoholic in Your Life?"
- o. Review a draft update of the pamphlet, "Frequently Asked Questions about A.A."
- p. Review a draft update of the pamphlet "This is A.A."

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Literature Committee.

Trustees' Nominating Committee: Chairperson Kathi Fowler presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that Procedure No. 2 "Procedures for Selecting ACM" be updated to reflect that "ACMs have a voice and a vote at the trustees' committee to which they are appointed."

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that Katie Heilmann of Fair Oaks, CA be reappointed for an additional one-year term to serve as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Literature Committee commencing with the July 2021 General Service Board weekend.

Following a motion and second, the Board tabled a recommendation that Nancy McCarthy remain for an additional one-year term to serve as Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee on the General Service Board, with her term expiring in 2023. Time is needed to further research the By-laws regarding terms.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Committee on Trustees their response regarding a consideration of Alternate Trustees as part of the procedures for a partial or complete reorganization of the General Service Board/Corporate Boards.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation of the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April 2021, following presentation at the 2021 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A Trustees

Molly Anderson
 Hon. Christine Carpenter
 Linda Chezem, J.D.
 Sir. Judith Ann Karam, C.S.A
 Al Mooney, M.D., FAAFP, FASAM
 Nancy McCarthy
 Kevin Prior, MBA, CFA, CPA

Class B Trustees (See "Note" below)

Beau Bush
 Jimmy Dean
 Josh Eggleston
 Kathi Fowler
 Francis Gilroy
 Tommi Hanley
 Deborah Koltai
 Trish LaNauze
 Jan Lembke

Mike Lewis
Irma Van De Bon-Nicol
East Central Regional Trustee-elect
Southeast Regional Trustee-elect
Trustee-at-Large/U.S. Trustee-elect

Note: East Central, Southeast Regional trustees, and Trustee-at-Large/U.S. to be elected at April 2021 Conference.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation of the following slate of officers of the General Service Board for election at the Second Quarterly Meeting of the General Service Board in April 2021, following presentation at the 2021 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Chairperson:	Linda Chezem, J.D.
First Vice-Chairperson:	Trish LaNauze
Second Vice-Chairperson :	Jan Lembke
Treasurer:	Kevin Prior, MBA, CFA, CPA
Secretary:	Francis Gilroy
Assistant Treasurer:	Paul Konigstein*
Assistant Secretary:	Jeff Wine*

*G.S.O. employees

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation of the following slate of Directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., for election in April 2021, following presentation at the 2021 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Beau Bush	Irma Van De Bon-Nicol
Jimmy Dean	Carolyn Walsh
Vera Farrell	John Weis
Deborah Koltai	Jeff Wine*
General Manager*	

*G.S.O. employees

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation of the following slate of Directors of AA Grapevine, Inc., for election in April 2021 following presentation at the 2021 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Josh Eggleston	Coree Hogan
Ino Fernandez	Mike Lewis
Cindy French	Nancy McCarthy
Francis Gilroy	Albin Zezula*
Tommi Hanley	

*AA Grapevine employee

A Floor Motion was presented to the General Service Board:

“To forward the Statement of Concern and Motion to Censure the General Service Board to the Conference Committee on Trustees after legal review and the preparation of additional background.”

The motion was seconded and approved by the General Service Board.

Following approval of the motion, the following minority opinion was submitted:

“I serve at the pleasure of the General Service Conference. I very much want to discuss the topics brought up in this request and would enjoy a discussion of solutions and healing at the Conference, it would have been ideal if this recommendation requested a conversation and reporting of progress on these items rather than moving directly to censure. It would have also been ideal if the submitters had brought this appropriately through the Conference process and even allowed the Groups in their Areas to contribute to that conversation. Make no mistake, I stand ready to be censured if that is the will of the Conference.

By moving this recommendation forward from a handful of A.A. members we are dignifying and validating that it is appropriate to shop and lobby opinions outside of the General Service Conference process as a means of forcing their item into the Conference. This is a form of outside pressure and influence on the members of the Conference conducted by current and previous members of Conference, members that know better. By entertaining this approach, we dilute all the efforts of those Conference members working within the Conference process and we allow the good Twelfth Step work of the Conference and office staff to be derailed by politicking and emotions. We have a Conference process in place for good reason and by moving this item forward we cross a line that disrespects our own process and boundaries.”

The Chair of the General Service Board appointed an Ad Hoc Committee to assist in gathering background materials for the item “Statement of Concern and Motion to Censure the General Service Board” to include David Noll, chair; Cathy Beckham; Beau Bush; Jimmy Dean; Stephanie Lyles; Michele Grinberg, ex-officio. Staff support to include Ames Sweet, Executive Editor; Sandra Wilson, Director of Staff Services; Jeff Wine, Staff Coordinator; and Diana Lewis, secretary.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees’ Nominating Committee.

Trustees’ Public Information Committee: Chairperson Trish LaNauze presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information a progress report of the development of two PSAs.

The committee reviewed and agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information a report on the progress on the development of a Public Information Comprehensive Media Plan.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information a report, Google Ads Performance: December 16, 2020 to January 14, 2021.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information the 2020 Annual Report on A.A.W.S. Board Oversight of G.S.O.'s A.A. website and the Report from Grapevine Board on Oversight of the Grapevine/La Viña website.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information the Communication Services department draft plan to create a podcast.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information the report from the Survey Methodology working group on the Triennial A.A. Membership Survey, including the suggestion that the 2021 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted, including updated pre-survey communications, survey instructions and the option for a digital delivery method.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information the request that the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" be revised.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Committee on Public Information.

Audit Committee – Chairperson Leslie Backus gave a verbal report on behalf of the committee. The committee met on Tuesday, January 26, 2021.

The committee reviewed the changes to the Composition, Scope and Procedure as presented. Additional changes were made, and the amended policy was accepted. The Independent Auditors presented the Audit Plan for this year and explained the steps the auditors will take during the audit which will begin at the end of February. An Executive Session was held.

Retirement Committee – Stephanie Lyles gave a verbal report on behalf of the committee. The committee last met on Thursday, November 19, 2020. It was noted that Paul Konigstein, CFO, will serve as chair of the committee.

Report of General Sharing Session: Mark Everett presented a written report of the General Sharing Session on the topic, "Communication Up and Down the Triangle." A summary of the report and presentations are attached.

Trustees' Planning and Sharing Session: The trustees met on Sunday, January 31, 2021 beginning at 5 p.m. for the trustees' Planning and Sharing Session. The chair reported that the group reviewed the agenda items and heard terrific sharing on efforts to extend the hand of A.A. both in the U.S./Canada and internationally. There was a five-hour executive session that began at 7pm.

Reports of Trustees' Activities: Trustees submitted written reports of their activities since the November 2020 meeting. A synopsis of those reports is attached to these Minutes.

Old Business: Responding to a consideration to amend the By-laws of A.A.W.S. to include language similar to that of the G.S.B., the chair clarified that it is not the affiliate corporate that amends their by-laws. The G.S.B. trustees are the ones who need to amend those by-laws. The chair will send that item forward to the July meeting.

New Business:

On behalf of all the chair warmly welcomed the new Interim General Manager, Stephanie Lyles, and thanked her for her willingness to serve.

There being no further business, the First Quarterly Meeting of the Trustees of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. adjourned at 4:24 p.m.

PENDING APPROVAL

Trustees' activities since the November 2020 meeting:

Cathy Beckham

November 4	Post Board Weekend Report Back to SE Region
November 5	TLC RIPTAB Subcommittee Meeting
November 6	Post Board Weekend Zoom with Conference Agenda Chair
November 9	Post Board Weekend Zoom with Delegate Chair
	Post Board Weekend Zoom with Policy & Admissions Chair
November 11	SSAASA VI Planning Meeting
November 12	TLC RIPTAB Subcommittee Meeting
November 14	Big Book Presentation Area 78
November 16	Delegates Get-Together Planning Meeting
November 17	Trustees Planning & Sharing Zoom
November 23	TLC RIPTAB Subcommittee Meeting
November 25	SSAASA VI Planning Meeting
December 1	TGSCC Agenda and Background Planning Zoom
December 2	SSAASA VI Planning Meeting
December 5	US/CAN East Virtual Forum
December 7	TLC RIPTAB Subcommittee Meeting
December 10	GSB Strategic Plan Ad-Hoc committee meeting
December 12	Grapevine Board Meeting
December 14	TLC RIPTAB Subcommittee Meeting
December 17	Proposed Agenda Item Disposition Meeting
January 2	Big Book Presentation – Area 50
January 6	SSAASA VI Planning Meeting
January 7	TLC RIPTAB Subcommittee Meeting
January 9 – 10	Area 14 Assembly
January 11	Pre Board Weekend Zoom – Conference Committee on Agenda
January 13	Pre Board Weekend Zoom – Report & Charter committee
January 16	Area 73 Agenda Planning
January 20	Pre Board Weekend Zoom – Policy & Admissions committee
January 22	Conference Chair Orientation
January 24	Pre Board Weekend Zoom with Delegate Chair
	Pre Board Weekend Zoom with Agenda Committee Chair
January 25	Pre Board Weekend Zoom with Policy & Admissions Committee Chair
	GSB Strategic Planning Meeting
January 29	A.A.W.S./GV Board Meeting
Jan. 30 – Feb. 1	GSB Quarterly Meeting

Christine Carpenter

November 17	Trustees' Planning and Sharing
November 23	PI subcommittee meeting
December 1	Class A candidate interviews
December 2	US/CAN practice meeting
December 5	US/CAN Regional Forum
December 9	Nominating committee meeting

December 10	Strategic Planning committee meeting
January 5	Nominating committee meeting
January 13	Class A candidate interviews
January 14	Class A candidate interviews
January 15	Class A candidate interviews
January 22	Conference Committee Chair Orientation
January 25	PI committee meeting
	Strategic Planning committee meeting
January 26	Nominating committee meeting
January 27	Farewell to Greg Tobin
January 29	Observer at Grapevine meeting
Jan. 30 – Feb. 1	Board weekend

Jimmy Dean

November 8 – 9	Finance Advisory Body (FAB) Meeting (Zoom)
November 10	ICOAA Steering Committee Meeting (Zoom)
November 12	AAWS IAC Executive Session (Zoom)
November 13 – 15	Area 10 (Colorado) Assembly (Zoom)
November 16	AAWS Delta Committee Meeting (Zoom)
November 17	GSB Trustees Planning/Sharing Session (Zoom)
November 18	AAWS Self Support Sub-Committee Meeting (Zoom)
November 19	GSB Retirement Committee (Zoom)
November 20	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
November 23	GSB Sub-Committee on GM Relationship to Boards (Zoom)
November 25	AAWS IAC Meeting (Zoom)
November 27	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
November 30	AAWS Finance w/Paul & Zenaida Meeting (Zoom)
December 1	GM Search Discussion Meeting (Zoom)
December 3	GM Search – Meeting with WittKieffer (Zoom)
	Trustees' Finance Committee 7 th Tradition Sub-Committee (Zoom)
December 4	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
December 5	Eastern USCAN (Zoom)
	Delegate Conference Committee Selection Training (Zoom)
December 7	Southwest Regional Delegates Bring to Date (Zoom)
December 8	Finance Advisory Body (FAB) Meeting (Zoom)
	Delegate Conference Committee Selection (Zoom)
December 9	AAWS Nominating Committee (Zoom)
	AAWS Board Executive Session (Zoom)
December 10	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
	ICOAA Steering Committee Meeting (Zoom)
December 11	AAWS Board Regular Meeting (Zoom)
December 18	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
	AAWS Executive Session (Zoom)
December 19	Western USCAN (Zoom)
December 21	Trustees' Finance Committee 7 th Tradition Sub-Committee (Zoom)
December 29	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
January 5	AAWS IAC Meeting (Zoom)
January 8	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)

January 11	Trustees' Finance Committee 7 th Tradition Sub-Committee (Zoom)
January 12	Finance Advisory Body (FABV) Meeting (Zoom)
	AAWS Self-Support Sub-Committee Meeting (Zoom)
	2021 Budget Review Meeting AAWS Finance/TFC (Zoom)
January 14	AAWS IAC Executive Session (Zoom)
January 15	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
	AAWS/Management Bring to Date Meeting (Zoom)
January 16	Area 25 (Kansas) Assembly Trustee Report (Zoom)
January 19	AAWS Delta Committee Meeting (Zoom)
January 20	AAWS IAC Meeting (Zoom)
January 22	GSC Delegate Chair Orientation (Zoom)
	AAWS IAC Executive Session (Zoom)
January 23	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
January 26	AAWS Nominating Meeting (Zoom)
January 29	AAWS Board Regular Meeting (Zoom)
Jan. 30 – Feb. 1	General Service Board Meeting

Josh Eggleston

November 4	GV Finance Subcommittee Meeting
November 14	Interviewed for Boiled Owl Podcast
November 17	GV Finance Subcommittee Meeting
	GSB Trustees Sharing Planning and Sharing Session
November 19	Retirement Committee
December 5	Virtual US/CAN Forum - East
	Review and Demo of Delegate Committee assignment automation
December 8	Finance Advisory Body Meeting
	Committee Selection Process for 71st Conference Incoming Delegates
December 12	AA Grapevine Board Meeting
January 5	Coordination of initiatives Ad Hoc Committee Meeting
January 7	Grapevine Nominating Committee Meeting
	Instagram Report Review
January 9 – 10	Kentucky Area Assembly
January 11	Ad Hoc Google / 7th Tradition Committee
January 12	2020 Budget Review
January 18	Grapevine Finance
January 19	Subcommittee on Conference Improvements
January 22	Delegate Conference Committee Chair Orientation
January 23	Area 87 Public Information Workshop
	Grapevine Executive Session
January 25	Trustee's PI Meeting
January 26	Coordination of initiatives Ad Hoc Committee Meeting
	Audit Committee Meeting
	NTD Interviews
January 28	GSB General Sharing Session
January 29	Grapevine Board Meeting
Jan. 30 – Feb. 1	GSB Meetings

Kathi Fowler***AAGV Staff meetings - EVERY Wednesday through January 27, 2021***

November 4 AAGV Vendor conf. call
Trustee Report to Pacific Region Delegates

November 5 GSO Employee Huddle
Area 6 Assembly election practice

November 7 CNCA Chaired Elections

November 10 ICOAA Conference Call
Board Chairs Call

November 11 Meeting with AAGV employees Nivia and Janet
Trustee Report at Phoenix meeting

November 12 Video call with AAGV/LV Conference Committee Chair
Video call with C. C. on Trustees Chair

November 13 Virtual US/Can practice session

November 17 AAGV Vendor meeting
GSB Planning and Sharing Session
Report for Pacific Region delegates

November 18 Conference call with Paul CFO
Self – Support Committee Meeting

November 21 – 22 Area 93, Central California Election Assembly

November 22 AAGV presentation for Area 31 MA

November 23 GM Ad Hoc Committee

November 28 Service Workshop for group “Basic AA”

November 29 Video call with C. C. on Trustees Chair

November 30 Video call with AAGV/LV Conference Committee Chair

December 1, 4 Class A Interviews

December 2 US/Can practice

December 3 Concept 8 talk for group

December 5 Virtual US/Can East Presenter

December 7 AAGV Finance Committee Meeting

December 8 GSB Finance Advisory Board
Board Chairs Conference Call
Area 5 District meeting Concept 12

December 9 TIC Ad hoc meeting
TNC Committee meeting

December 10 Strategic Planning Committee Meeting
Area 02 Election for TAL US Candidate

December 12 GV/LV Board meeting, Zoom Call

December 14 AAGV Vendor conference

December 15 AAGV and No. Cal H and I-Electronic Literature Call

December 16 Call with Diana to go over TNC Agenda
Virtual US/Can West walkthrough

December 18 Met with Stephanie about Acting Publisher

December 19 Virtual US/Can Regional Trustee Host

December 29 TIC Ad Hoc Committee Call

January 4 TNC Committee

January 7 AAGV Committee meeting about Acting Publisher
TIC Ad Hoc Committee Meeting

January 9 – 10	Speak and present at Area 17 Hawaii Assembly-Virtual
January 12	Finance Advisory Board Meeting
	Self – Support Committee
	Board Chair Conference Call
January 13	4 Class A Candidate Interviews
January 14	Conference Call with AAGV Vendor
	4 Class A Candidate Interviews
January 15	3 Class A Candidate Interviews
January 16	AAGV/LV Conference Committee Meeting
	Trustee Report Area 92
January 18	Interview for Acting Publisher
	Meeting with the Conference Committee on Trustees
January 22	GSC Committee Chair Orientation
January 23	AAGV Executive Session
January 24	Group Inventory Chair
January 25	HR meeting AAGV
	Strategic Planning Committee Meeting
January 26	TNC Executive Committee Meeting
	Audit Committee Meeting
January 27	Greg's Farewell Event

Francis Gilroy

November 4, 17	AA Grapevine Inc., Finance Subcommittee Meeting
November 4, 11	Area 11 (Connecticut) Election Assembly Planning Session(s)
November 5	US/Canada Forum Planning Session
November 7	Area 47 (Central New York) DCM Summit
November 8	Area 49 (Southeast New York) Staten Island Presentation to DCMs
November 10	Northeast Regional Alternate Delegates Meeting
	Videoconference with GSO Archivist and the Delegate Archives Chair
November 13	US/Canada Forum-East AA Grapevine Planning Session
November 13 – 15	Area 59 (Eastern Pennsylvania) Election Assembly
November 15	Northeast Regional AA Service Assembly Inventory Planning Committee
	Area 11 (Connecticut) Election Assembly
	Northeast Regional Delegates and Alternates Meeting
November 17	GSB Trustees Planning and Sharing Session
November 18	Area 30 (Eastern Mass.) Area Committee Meeting (Alternate's Day)
November 21	Area 43 (New Hampshire) Area Assembly (Trustee-at-Large Nominee)
November 22	Area 31 (Western Massachusetts) AA Grapevine Workshop
	Area 30 (Eastern Massachusetts) Grapevine and La Viña Meeting
November 23	General Service Board General Manager Affiliates Subcommittee
	Interview with AA Grapevine, Inc.'s Nontrustee Director Nominee
November 27 – 29	CSCYPAA 35 (Connecticut State Conference of Young People in AA)
November 30	Area 38 (Missouri) "Threads of Recovery" (Corrections and Grapevine)

December 1	North America (US and Canada) Alternate Delegates Meeting
December 2 – 5	US/Canada Forum-East (and Planning Sessions)
December 3	Area 30 (Eastern Massachusetts) AA Service Manual Study
December 6	Area 49 (SENY) “The Grapevine and AA’s Three Legacies” Workshop
December 7	AA Grapevine Inc., Finance Subcommittee Meeting
December 8	Northeast Regional Alternate Delegates Meeting
December 11	A.A. World Services, Inc. Board Meeting
December 12	AA Grapevine, Inc. Board Meeting
December 13	Area 45 (Southern New Jersey) “Recovery Through Service” Workshop
December 15	General Service Board General Manager Affiliates Subcommittee
December 16, 19	US/Canada Forum-West (and Planning Session)
December 17	AAGV Executive Session, Search for Acting Publisher
December 20	Northeast Regional AA Service Assembly Inventory Planning Committee
	Northeast Regional Delegates and Alternates Meeting
December 22	Northeast Regional Alternate Delegates Meeting
December 23	Area 11 (Connecticut) District 11 Formation Meeting
December 24	Area 28 (Maine) Christmas Alkathon
December 31	Area 44 (Northern New Jersey) District 24 New Year’s Eve Alkathon
January 1	North America (US and Canada) Alternate Delegates Meeting
January 2	Area 50 (Western New York) General Service Assembly
	MSCYPAA (Mass State Conference of Young People in AA) Host
	NECYPAA (New England Conference of YPAA) Virtual Conference
January 4, 10, 24	Northeast Regional AA Service Assembly Inventory Planning Committee
January 7, 18, 23	AAGV Executive Session, Search for Acting Publisher
January 8	Teleconference with GSO Archivist and the Delegate Archives Chair
January 9, 14	Trustees Dashboard Orientation Training Session, and Q & A
January 9	Area 44 (Northern New Jersey) Tradition 2 Workshop
January 10	Area 30 (Eastern Massachusetts) General Service Assembly
January 12	Discuss Return to Workplace with GM-GSO and Interim GM-GSO
	2021 Budget Review Meeting
January 12	Northeast Regional Alternate Delegates Meeting
January 15	METS (Meeting, Events, and Travel Services) to discuss NERF 2023
	Area 43 (New Hampshire) to discuss Fellowship Connection
January 16	National Public Information Working Group
January 17	Northeast Regional AA Service Assembly Inventory Planning Committee
	Northeast Regional Delegates and Alternates Meeting
	Area 30 and 31 Mass State Convention Planning in a COVID-Era
January 19	Conference Committee on Archives “Meet and Greet”
January 21	Area 12, 28 & 29 (Delaware, Maine & Maryland) Service Manual Study
January 22	Conference Delegate Chairs Orientation Session

January 26	Audit Committee Meeting Pre-Audit Presentation
January 27	Northeast Regional AA Service Assembly Inventory Meeting
January 29	AA Grapevine, Inc. Board Meeting
Jan. 30 – Feb 1	General Service Board Quarterly Meeting

Michele Grinberg

November 7	Area 87 Quebec convention, speaker
November 16	Participation at concepts meetings —Park Slope Caton, Brooklyn group
November 21	Japan Shonan group – Attended and extended greetings “The Global Kitchen Table.”
November 28 – 30	World Service Meeting – Chair
December 5	Virtual US/CAN Forum – East – Participated and presented
December 11	Altered Attitudes Group [based in Sweden]. “World Bill’s sobriety birthday 12x12x12.” Spoke on concept 12
December 12	World Service Meeting – Chair
December 19	Virtual US/CAN Forum – West – Participated and presented
December 21	Participation at concepts meetings —Park Slope Caton, Brooklyn group
January 18	Participation at concepts meetings — Park Slope Caton, Brooklyn group

Trish LaNauze

November 2	Phone Meeting with Public Information Staff Secretary
November 5	Phone Meeting with International Desk consultant re: Int’l Cttee Sub-Committee
November 7	Area 6 Northern California Voting Assembly
November 8	Western Canada Regional Meeting
November 11	Phone meeting with Alberto C., Argentina World Service Meeting Delegate re: North/South
November 11	Phone meeting with Conference PI Committee Chair Shane S.
November 12	Trustees’ International Committee sub-committee on International Travel
	REDELA (Meeting of the Americas) Sharing Session organized by Paraguay (Teleconference)
	Eastern Canada Regional Meeting re North/South Project
November 15	North East Regional Meeting
November 16	Communications and Assets Meeting
	Inter-Area Remote Communities Meeting re North/South Project
November 17	Trustees Planning and Sharing Meeting
November 20	Search Committee Meeting
November 21	World Service Meeting Mock Session
November 23	Public Information Pamphlet Working Group
November 24	Phone Meeting with PI Staff Secretary
November 27	Search Committee Meeting
	REDELA (Meeting of the Americas) Sharing Session organized by Paraguay (Teleconference)

November 28 – 30 World Service Meeting
 November 30 National Corrections Committee Meeting
 December 2 US/CAN Forum run-through
 Area 79 Upper Fraser Valley Corrections Committee
 December 4 Search Committee Meeting
 December 5 Eastern US/CAN Forum
 December 8 Phone meeting with International Desk consultant
 Services Touchpoint Meeting
 December 9 Trustees' International Committee sub-committee on International Travel
 December 10 Search Committee Meeting
 December 11 AAWS Meeting
 December 12 World Service Meeting Gratitude Meeting and Stepping Stones Tour
 December 12 Grapevine Board Meeting
 December 13 Western Canada Regional Meeting
 December 15 Entity Wide Projects Ad Hoc Committee
 December 17 Public Information/Comprehensive Media Plan Meeting
 REDELA (Meeting of the Americas) Sharing Session organized by Paraguay (Teleconference)
 Eastern Canada Regional Meeting
 December 18 Search Committee meeting
 December 19 Western US/CAN Forum
 December 20 XIII Seminario Latinoamerica de AA
 December 21 Phone Meeting with PI Staff Secretary
 December 22 Meeting with International Desk Consultant
 Services Touchpoint Meeting
 December 29 Search Committee Meeting
 Phone Meeting with Staff-Co-Ordinator re: Orientation
 Trustees' International Committee sub-committee on International Travel
 January 4 Phone Meeting with PI Secretary
 January 5 Entity Wide Projects Ad Hoc Committee
 Services Touchpoint Meeting
 January 6 Phone Meeting with Conference PI Chair Shane S.
 January 7 Internal North/South Project Meeting
 Trustees at Large/International Desk meeting
 Trustees' International Committee sub-committee on International Travel
 January 8 Meeting with International Desk re North/South project
 Search Committee Meeting
 Joint meeting with Argentina re: North/South project
 January 10 Phone meeting re: Orientation Manual
 January 12 Meeting with International Desk consultant re North/South project
 January 14 Dashboard walk-through
 January 15 Phone call with Ravi D. AARCISB (emerging service entity)
 Search Committee Meeting
 Joint meeting with Argentina re: North/South project
 Phone Meeting with PI Staff Secretary

January 17	Workshop in Russia – AARCISB
	Western Canada Regional Meeting
January 19	Internal North/South Project Meeting
	Services Touchpoint Meeting
January 20	Conference Public Information Committee Meeting
January 21	Trustees at Large/International Desk meeting
	REDELA (Meeting of the Americas) Sharing Session organized by Paraguay (Teleconference)
January 22	Delegate Chair Orientation
	Joint meeting with Argentina re: North/South project
January 23	Search Committee Meeting
January 25	Special Trustees PI Committee Meeting
January 27	Phone Meeting with PI Staff Secretary
January 29	AAWS Board Meeting
Jan. 30 – Feb. 1	General Service Board Weekend

Jan Lembke

November 4	Call with Chair of Conference Committee ICRF
November 7 – 8	Area 86 Assembly
November 11	Trustees' Nominating Committee (TNC)
November 12	ECR Report back with region
November 17	Trustees' Planning & Sharing
December 1	TNC – Class A Interviews
December 5	Eastern US/Can Forum
December 9	A.A.W.S. Nominating Committee
	A.A.W.S. Executive Session
	Trustees' Nominating Committee (TNC)
December 10	A.A.W.S. Strategic Planning
December 11	A.A.W.S. Board Meeting
December 17	ECR Meeting
December 18	A.A.W.S. Board Meeting
December 19	Western US/Can Forum
December 29	Eastern Canada Region Delegate Orientation Sub Committee
January 5	Trustees' Nominating Committee (TNC) – reconvene
January 12	A.A.W.S. – 2021 Budget meeting
January 13	TNC – Class A Interviews
January 14	TNC – Class A Interviews
January 15	A.A.W.S. Info Sharing
	TNC – Class A Interviews
January 19	ECR Delegates' Orientation Sub Committee
January 22	2021 Conference Committee Chair Orientation
January 25	CERAASA Steering Committee meeting
January 26	Trustees Nominating Committee
	A.A.W.S. Nominating Committee
January 27	A.A.W.S. – GT Farewell
January 29	A.A.W.S. Board Meeting
Jan 30 – Feb 1	General Service Board weekend

Nancy McCarthy

November 10 Call with Conference Chair
November 12 International Travel Meeting
November 13 USCAN training meeting
November 17 Trustee Planning and Sharing Meeting
December 3 GV Strategic Planning Meeting/GV Meeting
December 5 US/CAN East Forum
December 6 SENY Area 49-The Grapevine and AA's Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service

December 9 Meeting with staff for Entity wide Policy meeting
December 10 GSB Strategic Planning Meeting
December 11 Grapevine Meeting/AAWS Board Meeting
December 12 Grapevine Board Meeting
December 13 Area 45, District 24 Southern NJ—Recovery thru Service Workshop
December 15 Electronic Literature Meeting-GV
GSB Policy Process Planning Meeting

December 16 Virtual US/CAN ZOOM practice
December 17 Grapevine Meeting
December 19 Virtual US/CAN West Forum
January 2 Corrections Workshop
January 5 Entity Wide Policy Meeting
January 7 International Travel Committee Meeting
Grapevine Meeting

January 12 Conference Call with Corrections Conference Committee Meeting
January 18 Interview for Grapevine
January 21 TLC Disposition Meeting
January 23 California Northern Interior Area PI/CPC Workshop
GV Executive Meeting

January 25 Strategic Planning Meeting
January 26 Entity Wide Policy Meeting
January 27 Meeting with Class A Candidate
January 29 Grapevine Board Meeting

David Noll

November 7 CNCA 06 Election Assembly, AAWS and Trustee's Literature Committee Report

November 16 AAWS Ad Hoc Committee on Pricing, Discounts and Distribution
November 17 GSB Planning and Sharing Session
November 19 Meeting with Conference Literature Committee Chair
November 20 GM Search Committee Meeting
November 21 CNCA 06 Literature Workshop, Trustee's Literature Committee Report

November 27 GM Search Committee Meeting
December 04 GM Search Committee Meeting
December 09 AAWS Nominating Committee Meeting
AAWS Executive Session

December 10 GM Search Committee Meeting

December 11	AAWS Board Meeting
December 16	Meeting with Literature Staff Secretary
December 18	GM Search Committee Meeting
	AAWS Executive Session
December 19	USCAN Western Forum
December 29	GM Search Committee Meeting
January 06	Meeting with Literature Staff Secretary
January 08	GM Search Committee Meeting
January 12	Budget Review w/ CFO
January 14	Meeting with Conference Committee on Literature
January 15	GM Search Committee Meeting
	AAWS Information Sharing Session
January 19	AAWS Ad Hoc Committee on Pricing, Discounts and Distribution
January 20	CNCA 06, District 12, Sub-District 9, Presentation on Conference Timeline
January 21	Trustee's Literature Committee Pre-Disposition Meeting
January 23	GM Search Committee Meeting
January 26	AAWS Nominating Committee Meeting

Newton Pritchett

November 12	REDELA Delegates' Get-Together
November 17	General Service Board Planning and Sharing Session
November 21	World Service Meeting Orientation
November 26	REDELA Delegates' Get-Together
November 28 – 30	26th World Service Meeting
December 1	Trustees' Nominating Committee - Class A Trustee Candidate Interviews
December 4	68th Argentina A.A. Anniversary
December 5	Eastern U.S./Can Forum
December 9	Trustees' Nominating Committee Meeting
December 11	A.A.W.S. Board Meeting – Guest
December 12	Stepping Stones Tour for World Service Meeting Delegates and Guests
December 16	Western U.S./Can Forum
December 17	REDELA Delegates' Get-Together
December 18	Ad Hoc Bylaws Committee Meeting
December 20	13th Latin American Spiritual Principles That Guide Us Conference
January 5	Trustees' Nominating Committee Meeting
January 13 – 15	Trustees' Nominating Committee – Class A Trustee Candidate Interviews
January 15	North-South Forum Planning Committee
January 17	AACIS & Baltic Countries Workshop
January 19	North-South Forum Planning Session
January 21	REDELA Delegates' Get-Together
January 25	Ad Hoc Bylaws Committee Meeting
January 26	Trustees Nominating Committee Meeting

Ginger Rhoades Bell

November 5	Board Events Steering Committee
November 7	Arizona Area 03 Assembly Speaker
November 7	AAGV Finance Committee
November 13	USCAN Meeting re breakout rooms
November 14	Area 3 Grapevine Workshop Presentation
November 17	AAGV Finance Committee
	GSB Trustees Planning & Sharing
November 19	Board Events Steering Committee
	Retirement Committee
December 1	TNC Class A Interviews
December 5	USCAN East AAGV Presentation
December 7	AAGV Finance Committee
December 9	Trustees Nominating Committee
December 10	Board Events Steering Committee
	GSB Strategic Planning
December 12	AAGV Board Meeting
December 17	AAGVB Executive Meeting
December 19	US/CAN West AAGV Presentation
January 5	Trustees Nominating Committee
January 9	Trustee & Director Dashboard Orientation
January 12	Trustees Finance Committee GSB Budget Review
January 13	TNC Class A Interviews
January 14	TNC Class A Interviews
January 15	TNC Class A Interviews
January 16 – 17	Area 15 Assembly AAGV Workshop Presentation & Speaker
January 22	GSO AA Meeting
January 23	AAGVB Executive Meeting
January 26	GSB Executive Session
January 27	GSO GM Farewell Celebration
January 29	AAGV Board Meeting
Jan. 30 – Feb. 1	GSB Weekend

Irma Van De Bon-Nicol

November 8	Western Canada Regional Meeting
November 14	Area 78 Literature Presentation (attended as an observer)
	District 6 Area 91 Assisted with Elections
November 17	GSB Sharing and Planning Session
November 29	WRAASA Committee Meeting
November 30	WRAASA 2021 draft Agenda created
December 5	US/Can Regional Forum East
December 12	District 6 Area 91 (attended as a guest)
December 13	WRAASA Committee Meeting
	Western Canada Regional Meeting
December 19	US/Can Regional Forum West (moderated a panel)
December 21	Phone Meeting with Trustee Buddy
January 3	WRAASA Committee Meeting
January 6	Meeting with Area 91 Delegate (re Area Committee Meeting)

January 7	Service Manual Study
January 8	WRAASA History of participation Area 91 draft
January 14	Dashboard Tutorial
	Service Manual Study
January 17	WRAASA Committee Meeting
	Western Canada Regional Meeting
January 21	Service Manual Study
January 27	Greg's Farewell Celebration
	Meeting with Area 80 Delegate
January 28	Meeting with Area 80 Delegate
January 29	A.A.W.S. Board Meeting (attended as an observer)
January 30 – 31	Trustee Committee Meetings
	1728 Meeting Speaker (Tradition X11)
February 1	General Service Board Meeting

General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.

November 2, 2020 via video conference

1:00 p.m.

The trustees of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. held their fourth quarterly meeting via video conference with Chair Michele Grinberg, presiding.

Chair Michele Grinberg called the meeting to order, opened with a moment of silence, followed by the serenity prayer.

Present: Leslie Backus; Cathy Beckham; Beau Bush; Hon. Christine Carpenter; Jimmy Dean; Josh Eggleston; Mark Everett; Kathryn Fowler; Francis H. Gilroy; Sister Judith Ann Karam, CSA; Patricia LaNauze; Jan Lembke; Mike Lewis; Peter F. Luongo, Ph.D. LCSW-C; Nancy J. McCarthy; Al J. Mooney, M.D.; David T. Noll; Newton Pritchett; Ginger Rhoades Bell and Irma Van De Bon Nicol.

At the invitation of the Board, the following persons were also present: Brenda Brown, Clement Cann, Patrick Claymore, Irene Donoso, Racy Joseph, Deborah Koltai, Paul Konigstein, Diana Lewis, Stephanie Lyles, Zenaida Medina, Michelle Mirza, Steve Smith, Greg Tobin, Bob Wilcox, Sandra Wilson, Jeff Wine, and Nay Williams, recording secretary. Also present was Appointed Committee Member: Shari Miller

Chair's remarks: Chair Michele Grinberg warmly welcomed all to the Fourth Quarterly Meeting of the Trustees and Members of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. and second virtual General Service Board weekend. The Chair extended a special welcome to the appointed committee member, nontrustee directors and staff. The chair also thanked all board members and staff for their participation and expressed her overwhelming gratitude to all for the amount of work getting done and great attitude being shown despite the stress caused by the pandemic.

Michele Grinberg announced that, at their executive session on Sunday, November 1, 2020, following the Third Legacy Procedure, the Board recommended that Linda Chezem be elected to serve as chairperson of the General Service Board at the second quarterly meeting of the Board of Trustees in April 2021.

Minutes: Following a motion and second, the minutes of the Third Quarterly Meeting of the Trustees and Members of the General Service Board held August 3, 2020 and Special Meetings on September 25, October 2, 2020, October 14, 2020 were approved.

Communications: The Secretary, Mark Everett reported that the board received five communications.

Corporate Reports:

Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.): Chairperson Beau Bush presented a written report on behalf of the corporation.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report.

Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.: Chairperson Kathi Fowler presented a written report on behalf of the corporation.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report.

Reports of Trustees' Committees:

Trustees' Archives Committee: Chairperson Francis Gilroy presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Archives Committee.

Trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference: Chairperson Cathy Beckham presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that the 71st General Service Conference be conducted during the scheduled time period of April 18-24, 2021 via remote meeting technology. Sessions of the 71st Conference will be conducted on a digital platform.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.

Trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities: Chairperson Peter Luongo presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Committee on C.P.C./Treatment and Accessibilities.

Trustees' Committee on Corrections: Chairperson Nancy McCarthy presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Committee on Corrections.

Trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee: Chairperson Leslie Backus presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee.

Trustees' International Committee: Chairperson Newton Pritchett presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' International Committee.

Trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums: Chairperson Jan Lembke presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee.

Trustees' Literature Committee: Chairperson David Noll presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that item number three in the committee Scope, which currently reads:

"Reviewing existing items to determine the need for revisions and discontinuance."

Be changed to:

"Reviewing or suggesting recommendations for revisions to or discontinuance of existing literature."

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Literature Committee.

Trustees' Committee on Nominating: Chairperson Kathi Fowler presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that that the trustees' Committee on Public Information begin the search for up to two (2) appointed committee members (ACMs) with professional expertise in evaluation and interpretation of online metrics to assess the effectiveness of public information efforts in digital media.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that George Wright of Louisville, KY be reappointed for an additional one-year term to serve as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities commencing with the July 2021 General Service Board Weekend.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that Amalia Castillo of Newington, CT be reappointed for an additional one-year term to serve as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Committee on Literature commencing with the July 2021 General Service Board Weekend.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that Deborah Koltai serve as General Service Trustee and Trustee Director on the A.A.W.S. Corporate Board following the April 2021 General Service Conference, to fill the vacancy that will be left by David Noll.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that Vera Farrell serve as Nontrustee Director on the A.A. World Services Corporate Board following the April 2021 General Service Conference

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that John Weis serve as Nontrustee Director on the A.A. World Services Corporate Board following the April 2021 General Service Conference.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that

Irma Van De Bon-Nicol serve as Trustee Director for two years on the A.A. World Services Corporate Board, following the April 2021 General Service Conference, to succeed Jan Lembke.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that Tommi Hanley serve as General Service Trustee and Trustee Director on the AA Grapevine Corporate Board following the April 2021 General Service Conference, to fill the vacancy that will be left by Ginger Rhoades Bell.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that Coree Hogan serve as Nontrustee Director on the AA Grapevine Corporate Board following the April 2021 General Service Conference.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation that Mike Lewis serve as Trustee Director for two years on the AA Grapevine Corporate Board, following the April 2021 General Service Conference, to succeed Kathi Fowler.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Nominating Committee.

Trustees' Committee on Public Information: Chairperson Trish LaNauze presented a written report on behalf of the committee.

Following a motion and second, the Board approved a recommendation for a revision to the Public Information Policy on the Co-Founders' Posthumous Anonymity to include the following text [in bold]:

G.S.O. Public Information Policy on the Co-Founders' Posthumous Anonymity

The G.S.O. Public Information policy should maintain the anonymity of all A.A. members living or dead, including the co-founders, to the maximum extent possible.

The Public Information desk of G.S.O. exists in relation to the general public as a source of information regarding the recovery program and Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous, not as a source of information regarding individual members of Alcoholics Anonymous, living or dead.

To the extent that non-anonymous information concerning our co-founders exists in A.A. literature, which is already available to the general public, inquiries may be directed to that information. The Public Information desk can also provide copies of such information to the media. Additional information should not be volunteered or provided, out of respect for A.A.'s traditional principles of personal anonymity, and the honor accorded those principles by the co-founders themselves as members of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous.

****An anonymity protected image of the co-founders may be provided to news media upon request, when appropriate, from the G.S.O. Public Information desk.***

No information should be provided regarding any other A.A. members, past or present, under any circumstances.

Following a motion and second, the Board accepted the report of the trustees' Committee on Public Information.

Audit Committee – Chairperson Leslie Backus gave a verbal report on behalf of the committee. The committee is scheduled to meet sometime before the next Quarterly meeting in January 2021.

Retirement Committee – Chairperson Stephanie Lyles gave a verbal report on behalf of the committee. The Retirement Committee met on August 18, 2020.

Report of General Sharing Session: Mark Everett presented a written report of the General Sharing Session on the topic, “Anonymity –Meeting the Challenge in Unique Situations.” A summary of the report and presentations are attached.

Reports of Trustees' Activities: Trustees submitted written reports of their activities since the February meeting. A synopsis of those reports is attached to these Minutes.

There being no further business, the Fourth Quarterly Meeting of the Trustees of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. adjourned at 3:00 p.m.

Trustees' activities since the August 2, 2020 meeting:

Leslie Backus

July 31 – Aug 3	GSB Board Weekend
August 7	Nominating Meeting
August 7	Update on My Portal Meeting
August 7	Prep Meeting for Financial Presentation
August 11	Nominating Meeting
August 11	Work Group for Special Virtual Finance Presentation
August 12	Prep Meeting for Financial Presentation
August 15	Special Virtual Financial Presentation
August 18	Retirement Committee Meeting
August 31	Nominating Committee Meeting
September 4	Meeting with CFO
September 11	AAWS Board Meeting
September 16	Focus Group on Strategic Planning
September 18	Compensation Committee Meeting
September 22	Call with CFO
September 23	Call with CFO
September 25	GSB Special Meeting
September 30	Special Finance Presentation Follow up Meeting
September 30	Finance Committee Meeting
October 1	TFC Subcommittee Meeting
October 2	Call with CFO
October 2	General Service Board Special Meeting
October 8	Financial Update
October 13	Meeting with CFO
October 14	GSB Special Meeting
October 19	TFC Subcommittee Meeting
October 23	GSB Board Chairman Interviews
October 26	Meeting with CFO
October 27	Meeting to review Cuba Presentation
October 27	GSB Compensation Committee Meeting
October 27	Filming Cuba Presentation
October 28	Review of 990 & Financials for Board Weekend

Cathy Beckham

July 31- Aug 3	General Service Board Weekend - Virtual
August 6	SE Delegate GSB Report Back Conference Call
August 7	My Portal Update Conference Call
August 7	Post Board Weekend Zoom with Policy & Admissions Chair
August 10	Post Board Weekend Zoom with Conference Agenda Chair
August 12	Subcommittee on Conference Improvements
August 15	Special Virtual Finance Presentation to 70th GSC
August 21	TLC Subcommittee BB Access/Relatability
September 10	Conference Secretary/Subcommittee Chair Discussion Zoom Meeting
September 12	Grapevine Virtual Board Meeting
September 14	Meeting with Conference Committee Secretary
September 15	GSB Strategic Plan - Focus Group Ad Hoc Committee Meeting

September 16	Big Book Access Presentation and Video Discussion Meeting
September 16	2020-21 RIPTAB Subcommittee Meeting
September 17	Strategic Planning Focus Group
September 19-20	Georgia (Area 16) Assembly
September 21	BB Presentation meeting with Publishing Techs
September 22	Post Board Weekend Zoom with Conference Delegate Chair
September 23	Strategic Planning Focus Group
September 24	Strategic Planning Focus Group
September 25	Special GSB Board Meeting
September 26	Area 14 Assembly – GSR Workshop Presentation
September 29	TLC Disposition Preview Meeting
September 30	Meeting with GSB Chair, Conference Secretary, Staff Director
October 2	Special GSB Board Meeting
October 3-4	Area 62 Assembly – Anonymity in a Connected World Presentation
October 5	Kentucky Area 26 Literature Chair Zoom Call
October 5	TLC ACM Discussion Meeting
October 7	Subcommittee on Conference Improvements Meeting
October 10	Area 15 - TAL/SERT Meeting
October 11	Pre Board Weekend Zoom with Policy & Admissions Chair
October 11	Pre Board Weekend Zoom with Agenda Chair
October 14	SSAASA Planning Meeting
October 15	TLC RIPTAB Subcommittee Meeting
October 15	Special TGSCC Meeting
October 17	Mississippi (Area 37) Big Book Presentation Workshop

Jimmy Dean

August 7	AAWS CFO Interview (Zoom)
August 7	GSB MyPortal Status Update (Zoom)
August 8	Area 03 Arizona Delegate Meeting (AAWS Report) (Zoom)
August 9	Southwest Regional Delegates Post-GSB Update (Zoom)
August 11	AAWS CFO Candidate Ratings (Zoom)
August 11	Southwest Regional Delegates Post-GSB Update Group 2 (Zoom)
August 12	SWRAASA Meeting (Area 66 Northwest Texas) (Zoom)
August 13	AAWS Delta Committee (Zoom)
August 14	70 th GSC Finance Presentation (Zoom)
August 18	GSO Employee Huddle (Zoom)
August 18	GSB Retirement Committee (Zoom)
August 25	AAWS Nominating NTD Candidate Review (Zoom)
August 29	District 54 (Area 65 NETA) Service Fair (Zoom)
August 30	CPC Workshop (Area 92 E Washington) (Zoom)
August 31	AAWS Internal Audit (Zoom)
September 3	AAWS Executive Session (Zoom)
September 9	GSB ICRF Strategic Plan Update (Zoom)
September 11	AAWS Strategic Planning (Zoom)
September 12-13	Area 57 Oklahoma Election Assembly (Zoom)
September 16	AAWS/GSO IG Seminar Planning Meeting (Zoom)
September 17	AAWS Nominating NTD Interviews (Zoom)
September 18	GSB Compensation Committee (Zoom)

September 18	IGCO Seminar (Zoom)
September 19-20	Area 65 Northeast Texas Election Assembly (Zoom)
September 20	Area 39 Western Missouri Election Assembly (Zoom)
September 20	SWACYPAA (Zoom)
September 22	AAWS Nominating NTD Interviews (Zoom)
September 22	Area 67 Southeast Texas Mock Assembly Meeting (Zoom)
September 23	AAWS Nominating NTD Interviews (Zoom)
September 23	GSB Strategic Plan Meeting w/Delegates (Zoom)
September 24	AAWS Nominating NTD Interviews (Zoom)
September 24	AAWS Executive Session (Zoom)
September 25	2021 Regional Forum Discussion (Zoom)
September 25	AAWS Nominating NTD Interviews (Zoom)
September 25	AAWS Internal Audit (Zoom)
September 25	GSB Meeting (Board Chair Selection Discussion) (Zoom)
September 28	AAWS Finance Update (Zoom)
September 29	GSO/GV VRIP Retirement Party (Zoom)
September 30	AAWS Nominating NTD Wrap Up (Zoom)
September 30	Trustees Finance Meeting (Zoom)
October 1	Trustees Finance 7 th Tradition SubCommittee (Zoom)
October 2	GSB Special Meeting (Zoom)
October 4	Area 67 Southeast Texas Election Assembly (Zoom)
October 10	Area 38 Eastern Missouri Trustee Talk (Zoom)
October 14	GSB Special Meeting (Zoom)
October 15	Trustees Conference Meeting 71 st GSC (Zoom)
October 15	AAWS/Management Bring to Date Meeting (Zoom)
October 16	AAWS Finance meet with new CFO (Zoom)
October 19	Trustees Finance 7 th Tradition SubCommittee (Zoom)
October 20	Area 38 Eastern Missouri Mock Assembly Meeting (Zoom)
October 21	AAWS Nominating Meet New Regionals (Zoom)
October 23	GSB Board Chair Interviews (Zoom)
October 24	Area 38 Eastern Missouri Election Assembly (Zoom)
October 26	GSB GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
October 27	GSB Compensation Committee (Zoom)
October 27	AAWS Nominating Meeting (Zoom)
October 28	AAWS Delta Committee (Zoom)
October 30	AAWS Board Meeting (Zoom)
Oct 30-Nov 2	GSB Quarterly Meeting (Zoom)

Josh Eggleston

August 6	GV Finance Subcommittee Meeting
August 7	CFO Selection Committee
August 11	CFO Selection Committee
August 12	Subcommittee on Conference Improvements
Aug 14	Comprehensive Media Plan Subcommittee
Aug 15	Special Finance Presentation
Aug 18	Retirement Subcommittee
Aug 26	AAGV Licensing Subcommittee
Aug 27	Equitable Workload Subcommittee

September 4	Comprehensive Media Plan Subcommittee GV Finance Subcommittee Meeting
September 8	GV Licensing Subcommittee
September 10	Subcommittee on Conference Improvements
September 11	AA Grapevine Strategic Planning Meeting
September 12	AA Grapevine Board Meeting
September 20	GV Board Meeting
September 23	Trustees Finance meeting
September 24	GSB Meeting
September 25	Comprehensive Media Plan Subcommittee
September 25	GSB Meeting
September 29	GV Finance Subcommittee Meeting
September 30	GSB Meeting
Oct 1	7 th Tradition Subcommittee NTD Interviews
Oct 2	GSB Meeting
Oct 3	Service Workshop Basics Group (Area 51)
Oct 7	Subcommittee on Conference Improvements
Oct 8	NTD Interviews
Oct 9	NTD Interviews
Oct 14	Grapevine Finance Meeting GSB Meeting Area 26 Owensboro 1728 Meeting
Oct 15	Grapevine GST Interviews
Oct 17	Area 51 CPC / PI Workshop
Oct 18	GSB Interview Prep
Oct 19	7 th Tradition Subcommittee
Oct 20	Comprehensive Media Plan Subcommittee Grapevine GST Interviews
Oct 21	Subcommittee on Conference Improvements
Oct 22	Grapevine GST Interviews
Oct 23	GSB Chair Interviews
Oct 30	AAGV Board Meeting

Mark Everett

August 12	Subcommittee of the TCGSC on Conference Improvements
August 15	Illinois State Convention
August 15	GSC Finance presentation
August 21	Ohio State Convention
August 22	Ohio State Convention
August 31	Trustees Nominating Committee
September 6	ECR Officers Meeting – CDPP planning
September 10	Subcommittee of the TCGSC on Conference Improvements
September 11	AAWS Board Meeting
September 12	AAGV Board Meeting
September 13	Area 21 Election assembly
September 17	ECR Forum meeting with METS
September 23	Strategic Plan Focus group

September 25	GSB Special Meeting
September 27	Area 21 Workshop planning meeting
September 29	GSO/GV retirement celebration
October 2	GSB Special Meeting
October 3	Area 21 Workshop
October 7	Subcommittee of the TCGSC on Conference Improvements
October 7	ECR CDDP planning meeting
October 14	GSB special meeting
October 15	TCGSC full committee plus guests special meeting
October 21	Subcommittee of the TCGSC on Conference Improvements
October 23	GSB special meeting

Kathi Fowler

Aug 7- Nov 2	Weekly call with AAGV Executive
August 7	Self-Support Committee conf. call
August 9	Area 09 Trustee Report
August 11	Call with AAGV/LV Conference Committee chair
August 15	GSC Financial Report
August 17	Trustee Report Pacific Region delegates
August 24	Videoconference. with Trish LaNauze and Omar, trustee Mexico
August 31	Videoconference with TNC
September 4	AAGV Finance Committee
September 8	AAGV Podcast meeting
September 11	AAWS Virtual meeting in am
September 11-13	GV/LV Board Meeting
September 15	ICOAA meeting
September 16	Strategic Planning GSC
September 17	Strategic Planning GSC
September 18-20	ICOAA, Des Moines, Iowa, Chair roundtables and give presentation
September 19	SoCal Convention Trustee report
September 20	Special AAGV Board Meeting
September 20	Speak at SWACYPAA-virtual
September 23	AAGV Podcast interview
September 23	GSC Strategic Planning
September 25-27	Area 69 Utah, Election Assembly, report and speak
September 25	GSB Special Meeting
September 29	AAWS and AAGV retirement party virtual
Oct. 1-Nov 30	Weekly AAGV Staff meetings
October 1	AAGV NTD interviews
October 2	GSB Special Meeting
October 2-4	Area 72-W. Washington Elections, report and speak- virtual
October 8	AAGV NTD Interviews
October 12	Conference Committee chair calls, AAGV and Trustees Committee
October 13	Board Chair call
October 14	GSB Special meeting
October 15	Special GSC Committee meeting
October 15	AAGV GST interview
October 16 and 17	Area 42 Nevada elections and report Virtual
October 20	AAGV GST interviews virtual

October 22	AAGV GST interview
October 23	GSB Chair interviews
October 24	Concept II talk for Spanish district-Area 03
October 29	HR call for AAGV
Oct. 30-Nov. 2	AAGV and GSB Weekend, virtual platform

Francis Gilroy

August 4, 31 2020	NERAASA Overall Planning
August 6	AA Grapevine Inc., Finance Subcommittee Meeting
August 7	Technology, Communication, and Services Update on MyPortal
August 9, 16	Northeast Regional Delegates and Alternates Meeting
August 11	Northeast Regional Alternate Delegates Meeting
August 13	AA Grapevine, Inc., Governance Subcommittee Meeting
August 15	GSB Treasurer's Finance Presentation to the GSC
August 16	Area 45 7 th Tradition Workshop Assembly
August 20	Area 28 (Maine) Summer Service Series "Fun"-shop
August 23, 30	NERAASA Inventory Planning
August 29	Area 11 Corrections Workshop
August 29	Area 29 Our General Service Structure – An Overview
August 30	Area 13 Treasurer's Finance Presentation Report from the GSC
September 1, 8	Northeast Regional Alternate Delegates Meeting
September 3	North America Alternate Delegates Meeting
September 4, 20, 29	AA Grapevine Inc., Finance Subcommittee Meeting
September 5	Area 79 (BC/Yukon) Mock Election Assembly
September 11	AAWS Board Meeting
September 11	AA Grapevine, Inc., Strategic Planning Meeting
September 12	Area 49 (Southeast New York) Elections (Morning Session)
September 12	AA Grapevine, Inc., Board Meeting
September 13	Area 47 (Central New York) Elections Assembly
September 15, 29	Area 28 (Maine) What a Concept! Workshop(s)
September 15	Area 48 (Hudson Mohawk Berkshire) 7 th Tradition in the Digital World
September 16, 24	General Service Board Strategic Plan Discussion Session(s)
September. 17 – 20	35 th Annual Intergroup and Central Office AA Seminar (Iowa)
September 17	2021 Forums Planning with GSO METS department
September 17	Tradition 2 and Concept II Workshop
September 18	GSB Compensation Meeting (AAWS & AAGV Corporate Committee)
September 19	Area 49 Joy of Service (Archives) Workshop
September 20	Northeast Regional Delegates and Alternates Meeting
September 22	AA Grapevine, Inc., Non-trustee Director Interviews
September 23	Joint Trustee's Archives-Literature Committee Meeting with GM-GSO
September 25	Area 30 Grapevine and La Viña Meeting
September 25	Area 11 "Virtual Bus Trip to GSO," including GV and LV
September 25	GSB Planning for GSB Chair Interviews
September 26	National AA Archives Workshop – "The Wonderful World of Archives"

September 26	Area 44 Convention – Grapevine “Mystery Theatre”
September 29	General Service Office’s Virtual Retirement Party
September 29	General Service Board “Cash Flow Projection” Meeting
October 1, 8-9	AA Grapevine, Inc., Non-trustee Director Interviews
October 2, 14	Special Meeting of the General Service Board
October 5	Area 30 Literature Workshop
October 6, 13, 18	Northeast Regional Alternate Delegates Meeting
October 9, 26	Area 43 and Area 60 Registrar’s Task Force
October 9-10, 21	Area 59 Election Practice Session
October 12	Area 49 AA Grapevine Story Hour
October 14	Area 44 (Northern New Jersey) Elections Planning Meeting
October 15	Trustees’ General Service Conference Committee
October 15, 20, 22	AA Grapevine, Inc., General Service Trustees Interviews
October 17	Area 44 (Northern New Jersey) Elections Assembly
October 18	Area 59 (Eastern Pennsylvania) Area Day 2020
October 19	Area 45 (Southern New Jersey) District 24 Outreach
October 23	General Service Board Chair Interviews (Opening in April 2021)
October 25	Area 13 (Washington, DC) Elections Assembly
October 27	GSB Compensation Meeting (AAWS/AAGV Corp. Committee)
Oct. 30 – Nov. 2	General Service Board Quarterly Meeting

Michele Grinberg

July 20	Spoke on concept VII at Park Slope Caton group [zoom]
September 1	Recorded Greetings From US/Canada GSO video for Australia’s convention and 75th birthday
October 2-4	Attended parts of Australia convention [zoom]
October 3	Spoke at Delaware convention [zoom]

Sister Judith Ann Karam

August 2	GSB Committee on Archives
August 3	GS Board
August 31	AAWS Internal Audit Committee
September 25	GS Board Special Meetings
October 2	GS Board Special Meetings
October 4	Area 79 Archives Committee Event – The Early Days of AA Presentation of Sr. Ignatia Gavin
October 14	GS Board Special Meetings
October 27	GSB Compensation Committee
October 30	AAWS Board
October 31	AAWS Internal Audit Committee
October 31	GSB Committee on Corrections
October 31	GSB Committee on Nominating (Observer)
October 31	1728 Meeting
November 1	GS Board
November 1	GS Board Executive Session
November 2	GS Board

Trish LaNauze

August 8	Meeting with WSM Delegate Alberto C., members of the General Service Board of Argentina and Delegates to the GSC of Argentina re: virtual GSC
August 11	REDELA (Meeting of the Americas) Sharing Session organized by Paraguay (Teleconference)
August 14	PI Committee/Comprehensive Media Plan Sub-Committee Teleconference Meeting
August 15	Area 79 Districts 70 & 64 service workshop
August 15	Virtual Finance Presentation
August 16	Western Canada Regional Meeting
August 23	Area 79 Public Information meeting
August 26	Trustees' International Committee sub-committee on International Travel
August 29	World Service Meeting Policy/Admissions Finance Committee Meeting
September 1	Services Touchpoint Meeting
September 4	PI Committee/Comprehensive Media Plan Sub-Committee Teleconference Meeting
September 5	Area 79 mock election
September 9	Trustees' International Committee sub-committee on International Travel
September 11	AAWS Board meeting observer
September 12	AA Grapevine Board meeting observer
September 13	National Corrections Committee meeting with Nancy McCarthy
September 15	Argentina Co-Operation with the Professional Community National Event (Teleconference)
September 16	Phone meeting with PI Staff Secretary
September 17	REDELA (Meeting of the Americas) Sharing Session organized by Paraguay (Teleconference)
September 24	GSB Strategic Planning Meeting
September 25	General Service Board Meeting
Sept 26 – Oct 4	General Service Conference of Argentina
September 29	GSO/Grapevine retirement gathering
October 1	Trustees' International Committee sub-committee on International Travel
October 2-4	Australian National Convention
October 11 & 12	Women's Encounter III, Argentina
October 13	Services Touchpoint Meeting
October 13	Phone meeting with PI Staff Secretary
October 14	General Service Board Meeting
October 14	Phone meeting with Conference PI Committee Chair
October 15	REDELA (Meeting of the Americas) Sharing Session organized by Paraguay (Teleconference)
October 16-18	Area 79 Voting and Election Assembly
October 20	PI Committee/Comprehensive Media Plan Sub-Committee Teleconference Meeting
October 23	Board Chair interviews
October 25	Area 79 Districts 5 & 7 Sponsorship Workshop

October 27
Oct 30 – Nov 2

Services Touchpoint Meeting
General Service Board Weekend

Jan Lembke

August 5
August 7
August 15
August 19
August 25
August 31
September 3
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October 5
Oct 9 - 11
October 14
October 15
October 15
October 16
October 21
October 23
Oct 24 – 25
October 27
October 30
Oct 31 – Nov 2

GSB Weekend Report Back to Region
My Portal Meeting
GSC Members Final Audit Report
Area 82 Pre-Election Zoom Training
AAWS NTD Candidates Selections
TNC Mtg – NTDs eligibility
AAWS Board Mtg
Area 83 3rd Legacy Voting
AAWS Strategic Planning
AAWS Board Mtg
AAWS NTD Interview
Area 82 Mock Election
AAWS NTD Interviews (2)
AAWS NTD Interviews (2)
GSB Strategic Planning Session
AAWS NTD Interview
AAWS Executive Session
AAWS NTD Interview
GSB Meeting
Area 87 Gratitude Panel
AAWS Finance Mtg
CERAASA
GSO Retirement Party
AAWS Nominating Committee Mtg
GSB Mtg
Area 82 Election Training
Area 82 Assembly
GSB Mtg
TGSCC Mtg (Observer)
AAWS Board Mtg
Mtg with METS re: Rule 62 set up
AAWS Nominating Mtg
GSB Mtg – Chair Interviews
Area 83 Assembly
AAWS Nominating Committee Mtg
AAWS Board Mtg
GSB Weekend

Mike Lewis

August 7
August 15
September 9
September 10
September 11

Update on My Portal status - Zoom Meeting
Special Virtual Finance Presentation to the 70th GSC- Zoom
Cedar Rapids Foxhall – Speaker – Zoom
TLC – Subcommittee, Black/African American Pamphlet -Zoom
A.A.W.S. Board Meeting – Visitor – Zoom

September 12	A.A.G.V. Board Meeting – Visitor – Zoom
September 14	West Central Regional Delegates Meeting – Zoom
September 17	2021 Regional Forums Discussion – Zoom
September 20	LICYPAA concepts Workshop – Speaker – Zoom
September 23	GSB Strategic Planning – Discussion Session – Zoom
September 25	Trustees Meeting – Zoom
September 25	Area 76 Summer Business Assembly – Observer - Zoom
September 29	Trustees Literature Committee Disposition Preview Meeting
September 30	Subcommittee Meeting – Black/African American Pamphlet
October 2	Special meeting of the GSB – Zoom
October 3	Area 36 Election Assembly – Observer - Zoom
October 5	Trustees Literature Committee – ACM Discussion Meeting
October 9 & 10	Area 24 Fall Conference – Observer – Zoom
October 15	Special TGSCC Meeting on 71 st Conference Format – Zoom
October 18	GSB Chair Interview Panel Preparation – Zoom
October 21	Meeting with A.A.W.S. Nominating Committee – Zoom
October 23	GSB Chair Interviews – Zoom
Oct 30 – Nov 2	General Service Board Weekend - Zoom

Nancy McCarthy

August 3	Grapevine/ La Vina Strategic Planning Meeting
August 10	Grapevine/ La Vina Strategic Planning Meeting
August 4	AAGV Nominating and Governance Meeting
August 17	Grapevine/La Vina Strategic Planning Meeting
August 24	Grapevine/ La Vina Strategic Planning Meeting
August 26	Sub-Committee for International Travel
August 31	Grapevine/La Vina Strategic Planning Meeting
September 11	Grapevine/ La Vina Strategic Planning Meeting
September 12	Grapevine/La Vina Board Meeting
September 14	Grapevine/ La Vina Strategic Planning Meeting
September 15	GSB Strategic Planning Training
September 16	GSB Strategic Planning Session
September 17	GSB Strategic Planning Session
September 20	Grapevine/La Vina Executive Board Meeting
September 21	Grapevine/ La Vina Strategic Planning Meeting
September 22	Sub-Committee for International Travel; Interviews for GV/LA NTD
September 23	GSB Strategic Planning Session
September 24	GSB Strategic Planning Session
September 28	Grapevine/ La Vina Strategic Planning Meeting
September 29	TLC Disposition Preview Meeting
September 30	Sub-committee on pamphlet for Black/African-American Pamphlet
October 1	Interviews for GV/LV NTD; Sub-committee for International Travel
October 5	Grapevine/La Vina Strategic Planning Meeting
October 7	Subcommittee on pamphlet for Black/African-American
October 8	GV/LV Interviews for GV/LV NTD

October 15	GV/LV interviews for GV/LV GST
October 16-18	Area 79 Assembly via ZOOM
October 19	Grapevine/La Vina Strategic Planning Meeting
October 20	Grapevine/La Vina GST interviews
October 22	GV/LV GST Interviews
October 23-25	Area 80 Assembly
October 26	Grapevine/ La Vina Strategic Planning Meeting

Al J. Mooney

September 12	Area 8 San Diego Assembly,
September 16	South Africa GSO CPC webinar, workshop and planning
October 17	Area 51 CPC Workshop

Newton Pritchett

July 31	Zoom Conference – A.A.W.S. Board Meeting Guest
August 1-3	Zoom Conference – 3 rd Quarter General Service Board W/E
August 6	Zoom Conference – WSM Discussion
August 8	Zoom Conference – Argentina GSC Delegates Meeting
August 11	Zoom Conference – REDELA Delegates' Get-Together
August 15	Zoom Conference – Special Finance Presentation to GSC Delegates
September 11	Zoom Conference – A.A.W.S. Board Meeting Guest
September 12	Zoom Conference – National A.A. Technology Workshop
September 15	Zoom Conference – Argentina C.P.C. Event
September 16	Zoom Conference – GSB Strategic Planning Meeting
September 17	Zoom Conference – REDELA Delegates' Get-Together
September 25	Zoom Conference – General Service Board Special Meeting
September 26	Zoom Conference – National A.A. Archives Workshop
Sept 26 - Oct 4	Zoom Conference – 57 th General Service Conference Visitor
October 2	Zoom Conference – General Service Board Special Meeting
October 11	Zoom Conference – Area 51 Workshop on Roberts' Rules of Order
October 14	Zoom Conference – General Service Board Special Meeting
October 15	Zoom Conference – REDELA Delegates' Get-Together
October 18	Zoom Conference – Area 05 Election Assembly
October 23	Zoom Conference – General Service Board Special Meeting
October 24	Zoom Conference – Colombia Area 03 Mtg on General Service Structure

Ginger Rhoades Bell

August 1-3	GSB Weekend
August 6	AAGVB Finance Committee
August 7	GSO update on My Portal
August 13	AAGVB Nominating & Governance Committee
August 15	Special Virtual Conference Finance Presentation
August 20	Board Events Steering Committee
August 27	Board Events Steering Committee
August 31	Trustees Nominating Committee

September 4	AAGVB Finance Committee
September 11	AAGV Strategic Planning
September 12	AAGV Board Meeting
September 15	GSB Strategic Planning
September 16	GSB Strategic Planning Focus Groups
September 17	GSB Strategic Planning Focus Groups
September 18	GSB Compensation Committee
September 20	GSB Special Meeting
September 22	AAGVB Interviews
September 24	Board Events Steering Committee
September 24	GSB Strategic Planning Focus Groups
September 29	AAGVB Finance Committee
September 30	Trustees Finance Committee
October 1	AAGVB Interviews
October 2	GSB Special Meeting
October 8	AAGVB Interviews
October 9	AAGV Interviews review
October 14	GSB Special Meeting
October 15	AAGVB Nominating & Governance Committee
October 20	AAGVB Nominating & Governance Committee
October 22	AAGVB Nominating & Governance Committee
October 23	GSB Chair Interviews
October 27	GSB Compensation Committee
October 29	Board Events Steering Committee
October 30	AAGV Board Meeting
October 31-Nov 2	GSB Weekend

Irma Van De Bon Nicol

August 15	Special Virtual Financial Presentation
August 16	Western Canada Regional Meeting
August 30	Western Canada Regional Meeting
September 5	Area 79 Mock Election
September 11	A.A.W.S. Board Meeting (attended as an observer)
September 12	AAGV Board Meeting (attended as an observer)
September 16	General Service Board Strategic Planning Discussion Session
Sept 18, 19, 20	Area 78 Fall Assembly
September 25	Special Meeting Trustees-HR & GSB Chair Process
October 2	Special Meeting General Service Board
October 7	Area 91 Preparations for Fall Assembly Elections
October 9	Phone Meeting with Trustee Buddy
October 11	Western Canada Regional Meeting
October 14	Area 91 Mock Election
October 15	Trustees General Service Conference Committee Meeting
October 16-17	Area 91 Fall Assembly
October 17, 18	Area 79 October Assembly
October 21	A.A.W.S. Nominating Committee (meet briefly)
October 23	General Service Board Chair Interviews
October 30	A.A.W.S. Board Meeting

October 30	AAGVB- AA Meeting
October 30	General Service Board Meeting
Oct. 31-Nov. 2	General Service Board Committee Meetings

A.A. World Services, Inc.
November 2020 – January 2021
Beau Bush, Chair

Since its October 30, 2020 meeting, the A.A. World Services (AAWS) Corporate Board has met twice by videoconference: December 11, 2020 and January 29, 2021. During this same period, the AAWS Finance, Publishing, Technology/Communication/Services and Internal Audit committees each met twice.

SERVICES SUMMARY

Accessibilities/LIM

During these challenging times, the Fellowship has been actively sharing their efforts to reach alcoholics who have accessibilities issues. The staff secretary continues passing along the shared experience available in the Accessibilities Committees Service web page as well as in the desk digital files. The Remote Communities Service page will soon be available on aa.org. The page will include relevant literature and access to useful links for service work.

Conference

The Conference Communications Kit was made available to all Conference members starting January 5, 2021. The kit includes the list of preliminary Conference committee agenda items, committee assignments and buddy lists. The new Committee Assignment Application implementation was a success and produced randomized committee assignments for all incoming Panel 71 delegates, meeting all the policy requirements requested by the General Service Conference for this process. New CFO Paul Konigstein communicated the "2021 Area Contribution Letter" informing delegates and area treasurers about Conference expenses and self-support.

Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment

The incoming coordinator is responding to assignment-related and regional correspondence, along with requests from GSO and various committees interested in exchanging information and experience with treatment committees throughout the US and Canada.

Corrections

The Winter version of "Sharing from Behind the Walls" was distributed to prisoners across the U.S. and Canada, along with requested books and pamphlets. Over 560 male inmates were matched January - December 2020; 105 females were matched for the same period. There were 1,390 Insiders/Outsiders linked.

Group Services

The new coordinator is continuing to work with the Fellowship Connection team gathering post-launch feedback from area registrars on how to improve the database. One topic that is prevalent on this assignment is the listing of Online Groups, specifically what information should be captured and their participation in the general service structure.

International

The 26th World Service Meeting held a follow-up "Gratitude in Action" Sharing Session and a special virtual tour of Stepping Stones on December 12, 2020. Currently the International desk is working with the Publishing department to produce the 26th World Service Meeting Final

Report. The report will be published in an anonymity-protected digital format; no print version will be produced. The GSO in Mexico will translate the WSM Final Report into Spanish. The 27th WSM will be held in Tokyo, Japan, October 1-6, 2022, and the theme will be "Carrying the Message of A.A. in the Digital Age." The desk is also working with Technology Services and Operations preparing for the annual sweep of international GSOs to update our records and collect estimates of groups and members.

Literature

The Literature desk continues administering *Box 4-5-9* event listings and sending welcome letters and electronic and print material to new chairpersons of local literature committees. Committee support has taken place since October for a subcommittee of the trustees' Literature Committee as well as the 2020-21 Conference Literature Committee.

Nominating

Resume submissions for 2021 regional trustee vacancies in the East Central and Southeast regions and for the trustee-at-large/U.S. vacancy have been collected and acknowledged. Work has begun with the conference coordinator on the trustee elections that will take place at the virtual 2021 General Service Conference.

Public Information

The most recent press release regarding the 26th World Service Meeting was placed on the press/media page December 21, 2020, and distributed in PDF to U.S./Canada General Conference Members, central/intergroup offices and 62 International GSOs. In February, all Panel 70 and 71 delegates will be sent a memo outlining the Procedures for Anonymity Breaks at the public level. Included with the memo will be sample letters that can be sent with relevant A.A. literature (or email links) on anonymity.

Regional Forums

The incoming coordinator will join the planning already in progress for the four virtual forums that will take place in 2021. Insights gathered from the US/CANs will inform the ongoing planning. The assignment will also be included in the planning for the North-South Forum – a pancontinental virtual Forum targeting remote communities in Argentina and Canada. Under the purview of the International assignment, it is anticipated that this one-day forum will take place in May 2021.

Note: GSO staff members have participated virtually in a number of Fellowship-wide service events throughout December and January.

OFFICE MANAGEMENT

Administration: The office has continued functioning at a very high level on an entirely remote basis, with exceptional collaboration and teamwork throughout. Management and the leadership team have prioritized the overall wellbeing of all employees and have been focused on advancing project accountability in all departments. Conference planning, communications planning and development of the HR strategy are all moving ahead. A tentative date for returning to the workplace has been moved back from March to April or May (post-Conference) at the earliest and will incorporate a voluntary modified schedule.

Archives: Archives staff is preparing to relocate 300 cartons (392 cubic feet) of archival materials currently housed at an Iron Mountain facility, to a secured, onsite storage room on the 8th Floor. The materials include original masters of video and audio recordings, reels, cassettes, digital masters and copies of digitized recordings on CDs. This relocation will significantly reduce Archives expenses, help in appraisal of the unprocessed materials, and other related tasks. The permanent withdrawal and relocation is scheduled to be completed by mid-March 2021.

Human Resources: Amy Bailey joined GSO Staff Services on December 14, 2020 as a GSO staff member on the CPC assignment. Sareen Pearl joined the Human Resources department as HR director on January 5, 2021. Bruce Hartley joined the Technology Services department as senior project manager on January 5, 2021. James Hurst joined GSO Staff Services on January 19, 2021 as a GSO staff member on the Regional Forums assignment. In addition, internal postings have been made for a number of other positions. Annual performance reviews will take place at the beginning of February. To prepare, managers are completing training related to delivering feedback and using our Paylocity system to write their reviews. Annual merit increases will be tied to performance reviews and will go into effect March 1.

Operations: Fellowship Connection 2.0 was successfully launched on December 14, 2020, with about 88 area registrars trained in December on this first release. Fellowship Connection 2.1 launched on Tuesday, January 26, 2021. With Release 2.1, registrars will be able to have an interactive Dashboard and view the language of the interface in English, French and Spanish. Area registrars will continue to be able to update records, view current information, search, filter and download custom and standard reports including Groups by District, Service Position and Contacts reports. A training video and Frequently Asked Questions PDF should soon be uploaded to Fellowship Connection. These tools will be beneficial not only to the registrars but also delegates and DCMs when they get read-only access to Fellowship Connection. These enhancements should be implemented by the end of February 2021. New area registrars will be required to complete training before receiving access to Fellowship Connection 2.1. Four training sessions are scheduled, with one session conducted in French.

Technology Services: Significant Technology Services activities are underway to improve cyber and data security, integrating tools and technology used to protect computer hardware devices, e.g. laptops, desktops, etc., from potential threats. Additionally this month, encryption began for the hard drives of all laptops and remotely-deployed desktops currently supporting GSO's fully-remote workforce. These tools provide an additional data protection feature that integrates with the operating system and addresses the threat of data theft or exposure from lost, stolen, or inappropriately decommissioned computers.

The Technology Services team has played a key role in the launch of Fellowship Connection. In addition, the ERP Project Core Workstream has continued to support the launch of both Merchant-E and lockbox which will greatly simplify and enhance processes in Finance, Accounting and Order Entry.

BOARD COMMITTEES

FINANCE: The board accepted the Finance Department report highlighting the following information:

Contributions revenue in 2020 reached an all-time high of \$10,304,185, which is \$417,930 greater than the reforecast. Great gratitude was expressed to the Fellowship for contributing \$1,442,421 in December to propel Seventh Tradition contributions past the \$10 million mark for the year.

To facilitate calculating the preliminary bottom line, any invoices received after January 15 for goods or services provided in 2020 will be counted in 2021 unless the invoice is material (i.e., so large it would result in a significant change in expenses). As of the soft close, there is a small 2020 surplus of \$210,917 before depreciation. This surplus could decrease if any unexpectedly large invoices for 2020 activities are received between now and completion of the audit. Of course, all amounts are subject to change by the auditors.

Revenue

Gross literature sales revenue is \$9,098,578 compared to a reforecast amount of \$9,856,109, a difference of \$757,531. Although gross sales did not reach the reforecast amount, cost of goods sold is only 28% of gross sales compared to a reforecast 35%. Therefore, gross literature profit has exceeded reforecast by \$113,607. The revenue split between gross profit on literature sales and contributions in 2020 is about 37% literature/63% contributions compared to the historical split of 58% literature/42% contributions.

Expense

Payroll and benefits expense is \$11,329,538, which is \$374,429 less than the reforecast amount of \$11,703,967. Total expenses are \$16,667,870, which is \$45,195 less than the reforecast amount of \$16,713,065.

Cash Flow

Operating cash on hand at our U.S. bank as of December 31 was \$1,780,363. Our bank balance as of the close of business on January 20 was \$1,475,772, which represents four and a half weeks of expenses, about a week and a half more than a month ago.

Summary of Significant Changes from Budget 1.0: Budget 1.0 had a surplus of \$1,953,039 while draft Budget 2.0 has a surplus of \$641,387, a decrease of \$1,311,652. The following are the major drivers of this change:

1. Salary and Fringe increased by \$879,214. Budget 1.0 assumed that employee benefits will be 20% of salary. Budget 2.0 assumes that employee benefits will be 22% of salary, which is the actual 2020 fringe benefit rate through November 30. The additional 2% fringe equals approximately \$150,000. Budget 1.0 assumed an average payroll roughly equivalent to the first post-VRIP payroll. Budget 2.0 calculates salary and fringe on an employee-by-employee basis, with post-VRIP personnel additions included.

2. Gross literature sales revenue is reduced by \$585,000. Budget 1.0 assumed gross sales of \$750,00 per month from January to March and then \$800,000 per month thereafter for a total of \$9,450,000. Budget 2.0, developed in consultation with the publishing director, assumes sales of current titles at a rate of \$708,333 per month plus an additional \$365,000 for sales of the new souvenir book for a total of \$8,865,000. In comparison, actual gross sales since COVID have averaged approximately \$620,000 per month.

3. Individual/Groups contributions revenue is reduced by \$475,000. Budget 1.0 assumed individual/group contributions of \$850,000 per month for a total of \$10,200,000. Budget 2.0 assumes \$810,417/month for a total of \$9,725,000. In comparison, actual individual/group contributions since COVID have averaged \$881,00 per month. The average is skewed by the \$1,442,421 received in December 2020.

AAWS Self-Support Committee: The committee reviewed and discussed a sample contribution flyer and made suggestions on style, language and distribution. The committee also noted a popular "fillable PDF" flyer from the Publishing department that allowed local Intergroups/ Central Offices to include their contact information and share with the Fellowship. The committee asked the staff secretary to work with Communication Services Department to bring back a draft for review.

The committee also discussed self-support audio samples and ways they could be incorporated in current self-support communications, acknowledgements and A.A. announcements at online A.A. meetings. The committee noted that brief personal stories can bring an emotional depth and help to avoid a perception of solicitation.

The committee received an update on acknowledgments for mailed-in contributions and noted that this project is on hold. In the meantime, the committee suggested that mail-in contributions include an email as a contact point, so they could receive an acknowledgement from GSO. The committee considered ways to distribute this idea and suggested that regional trustees and area delegates could share this request.

The Board approved the following **recommendation** brought forward by the Finance Committee:

- That the budget for 2021, which reflects total revenues of \$15,594,000, total expenses of \$14,952,613 and a bottom-line surplus of \$641,387, be approved by the AAWS board.

PUBLISHING: The board accepted the Publishing department report highlighting the following information and updates:

The spread of the virus throughout the country adversely impacted manufacturers and printers, including those who supply key materials for A.A. book titles that had been ordered with them in previous months. These developments resulted in a serious backorder situation for some formats of the Big Book and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*. Communications to board, intergroups and central offices and other customers were delivered, including direct contact with customers via email and phone. The product detail pages of the webstore stated that the item was "out of stock," provided an estimated "back in stock" date, and also displayed related items available for purchase (the same content or abridged content in different formats, for example).

2020 International Convention souvenir book: *A Visual History of Alcoholics Anonymous: An Archival Journey* is available for pre-order at a special early bird discount of \$1 off the list price of \$12: December 1, 2020 – January 31, 2021.

Ingram CoreSource Plus enhanced digital distribution: AAWS officially launched its enhanced ebook and audiobook distribution implementation with Ingram CoreSource Plus, effectuating distribution via 38 major ebook platforms as well as 13 major audiobook vendors.

Researching Issues and Possible Tools to Access the Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous* (RIPTAB) PowerPoint: The project has been completed and is available in English, French and Spanish versions.

AAWS policy for keeping A.A. literature current: The committee discussed updates to five pamphlets per the “A.A. World Services, Inc., Policy on Publication: Keeping A.A. Literature Current.” The committee also discussed the procedure for processing GSO Publishing updates per the AAWS print policy. The committee noted that additional logistical details to the process warrant consideration for additional definition and agreed to continue discussions in March 2021.

The Board approved the following **recommendations** brought forward by the Publishing Committee:

- That the AAWS Board forward the draft updated pamphlets, “Frequently Asked Questions about A.A.,” “Is A.A. for You?,” “Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?” and “This is A.A.” to the trustees’ Literature Committee.
- That the AAWS Board forward the draft updated pamphlet, “Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.” to the trustees’ Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment-Accessibilities Committee.

TECHNOLOGY/COMMUNICATION/SERVICES (TCS): The board accepted the TCS report highlighting the following information and updates:

The committee heard reports from Technology Services, Group Services, the Communication Services department, and reviewed the minutes of GSO's Website Committee, along with updates on A.A. website analytics.

Progress report on website design and Meeting Guide app: Phase I is coming to a successful close and the team has begun looking at the next phase of the project. Phase II will include web server setup and development of the approved templates. A website feedback report covering September 18 through December 9, 2020 indicated receipt of 216 requests related to the website. Each request was forwarded to the appropriate assignment or department and received a response from GSO. During this period, 9 people requested twelfth-step help; 7 reported difficulty finding a meeting; 16 commented on website function or asked a question of the webmaster; 43 reported technical errors or information corrections; 3 were Daily Reflections requests; 6 for customer service; 41 contribution questions; 14 other GSO department/Grapevine questions. An additional 40 requests went to regional and service committees.

The AAWS App team launched the first Meeting Guide application upgrade since the application was handed off from the original application developer. One serious issue with the release related to the display on iPhone 12 models, was reported and resolved. Foster Made is currently working on extending Seventh Tradition contribution forms to include PayPal and Square. The team is working with OIAA to get their meetings listed in the application. The AAWS App team continues to field questions and connect new entities daily.

Progress report Google-For-Non-Profits projects:

YouTube channel: There are 113 AAWS videos posted to YouTube (some in English only, others in English, Spanish and French). As of January 2021, there are over 5,400 subscribers. All ASL videos for the Big Book and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* are posted private as of February 28, 2020 (52 English only).

GSO's new digital media creator is actively working to update the .srt files on the Big Book in ASL, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* in ASL and the 15- and 30-minute cuts of *A New Freedom*. The committee also received an overview of the YouTube channel prepared by the ACMs on the trustees' Public Information Committee.

Google Ads: In the 30 days that the AAWS Google Ads have been live, the total Grant spend for this period was \$4,560. The cost and average CPC (cost per click) are based on the keyword bidding system. The recommended bid setting for Google Grants automatically sets keywords to a \$2 maximum bid limit.

Within the account are two ad groups. "Find a Meeting" continues to see far greater attention and engagement than "Get Help." Since the last report, a few low performing keywords were removed. "Online aa meetings" was added. "Alcoholics Anonymous meeting" was removed after a recommendation from the platform as it was overly similar to one of the other terms in use. The ads are reaching a wide range of ages and genders. Men between 25-34 continue to be the top group interacting with the ads.

Disclaimer when going from aa.org to Grapevine websites: The committee discussed possible removal of the current disclaimer that appears when going from aa.org to Grapevine websites. More information will be researched regarding any potential legal considerations there may be in removing or revising such a disclaimer.

Proposed new items to add to aa.org: The committee discussed adding four new pages to aa.org and will continue discussion at subsequent meetings. The four proposed pages are: Regional Forums video; Young People's page; direct links to GV and sharing of assets between the websites; link to Al-Anon.

The Board approved the following **recommendations** brought forward by the TCS Committee:

- That the 2020 Fourth Quarter reports on A.A.'s website activities and analytics be forwarded to the trustees' Committee on Public Information as presented.
- That the 2020 Annual reports on A.A.'s website activities and website visitors be forwarded to the trustees' Committee on Public Information as presented.
- That the Regional Forums video be posted to aa.org and YouTube.
- That a revision to the committee Composition, Scope and Procedure be incorporated, as follows:

The A.A. World Services, Inc. Technology/Communication/Services (TCS) Committee is composed of not less than five voting members.

to

The A.A. World Services, Inc. Technology/Communication/Services (TCS) Committee is composed of not *more* than five voting members.

INTERNAL AUDIT COMMITTEE (IAC): The committee reviewed recommendations from the 2018/2019 External Audits, with topics including: cybersecurity; outdated software, systems and servers; document encryption; ongoing development of the Business Continuity Plan (BCP) and Business Disaster Recovery Plan (BCDR). The committee also reviewed the Management RACI Matrix, with topics including: preservation of electronic records; e-commerce and PCI compliance; review of insurance coverage; budget and contract process compliance; and a policy of responsibility that defines roles as it pertains to consultants, directors, trustees and employees.

The Board approved the following **recommendation** brought forward by the Internal Audit Committee:

- That the status report on responses to recommendations from the 2018/2019 External Audits, as reviewed and amended by the committee, be submitted to the AAWS Board.

AD HOC COMMITTEE ON PRICING, DISCOUNTS AND DISTRIBUTION (Delta): The Board approved the following **recommendations** brought forward by the Ad Hoc Committee on Pricing, Discounts and Distribution:

- That A.A.W.S., Inc. conduct a mixed unit discount plan on a three- to six-month trial basis.
- That AAWS, Inc. conduct a three- to six-month implementation of an updated shipping charge schedule as a special pilot project by April 1, 2021 with communication to include the rationale as to how it is beneficial.

OTHER BUSINESS

Safety and A.A. service pieces: GSO staff shared a proposed new service piece "Safety and A.A." flyer and proposed updates to existing service pieces: "Safety and A.A: Our Common Welfare" and the yellow Safety Card for A.A. groups. These items will be forwarded for editing and legal review.

Service Kits: The board continued discussion of the 2020 PI committee consideration that shared concerns on the relevancy of a print copy workbook and kit for PI committees. The board also noted the PI Committee's suggestions to explore development of an A.A. service committee app and the possible creation of a new digital PDF version of the PI Workbook. It was noted that GSO tends to have a "print-first" approach to publishing service material and that approach can sometimes delay updates. Many feel that evolution to a digital or web based approach as a publishing model should be explored.

International: The board reviewed and discussed the response letter sent to RSO and FOAA in Russia and will continue to monitor any further correspondence.

General Service Conference agenda items forwarded to AAWS: The board discussed five proposed agenda items submitted from the Fellowship and will gather all pertinent information and respond to the senders of the items individually.

Further discussion will take place at subsequent board meetings on the following items:

- Consider that all service pieces should go through the Conference-approval process.
- Discuss how attention to and use of the Meeting Guide app, along with undervaluing group directories, has added to confusion about the difference between groups and meetings.
- Move the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous to secure the URL "AlcoholicsAnonymous.com."

The following two items will be forwarded to the AAWS Self-Support Committee for further discussion:

- Request sharing from the Fellowship about using various “virtual” baskets - especially in terms of our Traditions, to ensure our Conference-approved literature and service pieces reflect our Fellowship’s experiences and principles.
- Have a discussion around online contributions accepted by the General Service Board from individuals (either one-time or recurring).

The next meetings of the AAWS board are scheduled for Friday, March 5, 2021 -- AAWS Strategic Planning Session.

A.A. Grapevine, Inc.
Report to the General Service Board
Monday, February 1, 2021
Kathi Fowler, Chair

The AA Grapevine Board of Directors met on December 12, 2020 and for its quarterly board meeting on January 29, 2021. The Conference Committee on Grapevine and La Viña, AAGVB chair and Grapevine and La Viña Conference Committee secretary met on January 22. The full board met for a special meeting on January 24.

Overview

Our Publisher, Albin Z., is out on medical leave and I hope that you will all continue to keep him in your prayers and good thoughts. On January 29, 2021, Chris C., began working as our Acting Publisher and we are very grateful for his willingness to fill in during this difficult period. Chris has been in the publishing business for his entire career and we are confident in his abilities to lead the AAGV during this period.

Over the past several months, I have been attending the weekly staff meetings and working with vendors on contract changes. I look forward to Chris taking over this role.

AAGV and AALV are on track to have available our two newest books in the spring. AA on the Inside and Women in AA (in Spanish). Later in the fall we have a book with stories on prayer and meditation coming out.

We are still feeling major effects from the pandemic and cancellation of the International Convention. Our book sales are down 60% and La Viña subscriptions continue to drop. They have gone from just over 10,000 to just over 6,000. This is concerning to the board and we continue to implement and look at ways to address this. SMS project for our Hispanic readers is set to begin in 2021 and we have hopes of this bringing about a difference.

Our 2020 and 2021 focused effort has and is on the Carry the Message Project which provided almost 5000 subscriptions to those who are asking for help. This effort also contributes to self-support.

It is truly an honor to serve as the AAGV Board Chair. We are dynamic and forward thinking and grateful the fellowship has given us the editorial freedom that allows us to keep up with the needs and voices of Alcoholics Anonymous!

Board Meeting: During its December 12, 2020 board meeting, the AAGVB was updated on the following:

Ongoing communications and planning with Market Partners and associates regarding GV books distribution; APDS has loaded GV and LV intellectual property onto tablets. Go live to be determined; 2021 GV Today and La Viña Hoy completed and sent to printer for inclusion in GSR kits; continued work with Circulation vendor optimizing product distribution through email efforts to customers; 2021 GV and LV price changes were re-announced with corrections; gifted WSM attendees with English and Spanish LOH MP3 downloads; the Account Management link on the bottom of the store is live; GV Online has been removed from the store; the store image for GV Complete was updated; the LV store category image for "Regalos De Suscripcion" was updated.

Director of Operations, Senior editor and Associate La Viña editor collaborating on 71st General Service Conference related matters; ongoing training with new Customer Relations Coordinator; Director of

Operations currently serving on the following internal committees/working groups: Retirement, Board Events, Business and Services Continuity Planning, Pension Annuitization, *Does A.A. Work* video and Podcast development; overseeing collaborative effort with Ingram distribution. Continuing to oversee day to day operations of AAGV, Inc.

Customer relations coordinator reported a bump in *Carry The Message* gift certificate purchases since October board meeting. 4,124 CTM subscriptions have been processed as of November 30.

Recent Grapevine magazines released: OCT (*Money & Sobriety*); NOV (*Our Twelve Traditions*); DEC (*Remote Communities & Holiday Stories*—out now); Grapevine magazines currently in production and on schedule: JAN (*Oldtimers*); FEB (*Sponsorship*); MARCH (*9th Step Amends*); APRIL (*Fun in Sobriety*); publishing more AA News and interviews with Class A Trustees; New *Prison Book* in production (spring 2021); New *Prayer & Meditation Book* (fall 2021) in production; the new 2021 Editorial Calendar is up on website with new Seniors topic added. Contacted CPC desk to help call out for CPC stories.

Recent La Viña magazine released: January/February 2021 *The Home Group*; La Viña magazines currently in production and on schedule: March/April 2021 *Newcomer Issue*; May/June 2021 *Spirituality*; July/August 2021 La Viña Celebrates it's 25th Anniversary. Ongoing Projects (updates): *Voices of Women* in Spanish – Manuscript has been reviewed and will be sent to proof the first week of December. On schedule for Spring 2020; LV EAB meeting was held on November 11; LV Complete will be announced pending confirmation from sales/management; 2021 events/outreach.

The Production Manager discussed current issues and ePubs available; investigating other printer options; audio projects in progress with area Corrections members; conducting pre-production for Spring titles; updating GV and LV Youtube content; working with staff and Ingram/MPI representatives book product distribution; discussing linking YouTuber's back to the Store.

The Web Coordinator reported historical files are being moved from Panix to a more reasonably priced provider; continuing post launch tasks for the new La Viña website; uploading back issues onto LV website; ongoing work with vendor on updating metadata on website; redesigning Account Service pages; ongoing maintenance and support of GV and LV websites; continue to improve subdomains on sites.

AAGV, Inc. Strategic Plan has been revised; more discussion will take place with vendor on metrics and trends.

A.A. Grapevine Financial Report

Grapevine

Circulation

	December 2020 Actual YTD	December 2020 Budget YTD	Variance Actual vs Budget	December 2019 Actual YTD	Variance 2020 vs. 2019
GV Magazine GV	63,397	67,802	(4,406)	66,376	(2,979)
Online GV Sub App	3,558	4,046	(488)	3,152	407
GV ePub	-	-	-	1,654	(1,654)
	1,617	-	1,617	-	1,617
	68,571	71,848	(3,277)	71,182	(2,610)

Total Circulation

Financial Activity

	December 2020 Actual YTD	December 2020 Budget YTD	Variance Actual vs Budget	December 2019 Actual YTD	Variance 2020 vs. 2019
Net Magazine	1,003,700	1,209,645	(205,945)	1,286,807	(283,106)
Net Other Publishing Items	313,535	789,853	(476,318)	660,530	(346,996)
Miscellaneous Income Reserve	11,246	-	11,246	-	11,246
Fund Interest	30,000	30,000	-	30,918	(918)
Total Income	1,358,481	2,029,498	(671,017)	1,978,255	(619,774)

	December 2020 Actual YTD	December 2020 Budget YTD	Variance Actual vs Budget	December 2019 Actual YTD	Variance 2020 vs. 2019
Editorial	879,440	768,790	110,650	605,609	273,831
Circulation & Business	783,440	1,065,757	(282,317)	1,091,989	(308,549)
General & Administrative	69,563	190,338	(120,775)	308,872	(239,309)
Total Cost & Expenses	1,732,443	2,024,885	(292,442)	2,006,470	(274,026)

Net Income	(373,963)	4,612	(378,575)	(28,215)	(345,748)
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La Viña

Circulation

	December 2020 Actual YTD	December 2020 Budget YTD	Variance Actual vs Budget	December 2019 Actual YTD	Variance 2020 vs. 2019
LV Magazine	6,435	10,100	(3,665)	10,150	(3,715)
	-	-	-	-	-
Total Circulation	6,435	10,100	(3,665)	10,150	(3,715)

Financial Activity

	December 2020 Actual YTD	December 2020 Budget YTD	Variance Actual vs Budget	December 2019 Actual YTD	Variance 2020 vs. 2020
Net Magazine	21,831	53,234	(31,402)	49,933	(28,101)
Net Other Publishing Items	12,425	14,174	(1,749)	15,158	(2,734)
	-	-	-	-	-
Total Income	34,256	67,408	(33,152)	65,091	(30,835)

	December 2020 Actual YTD	December 2020 Budget YTD	Variance Actual vs Budget	December 2019 Actual YTD	Variance 2020 vs. 2020
Editorial	243,066	225,813	17,253	226,233	16,833
Circulation & Business	178,691	152,936	25,754	130,571	48,120
General & Administrative	5,125	5,683	(558)	5,683	(559)
Total Cost & Expenses	426,881	384,433	42,448	362,487	64,394
Contribution GSB	252,080	-	252,080	-	-

Net Income	(140,545)	(317,025)	176,480	(297,396)	(95,229)
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Editorial Advisory Board: The GVEAB met on December 15. The LVEAB met on November 11. Next meetings will be held in February 2021.

Grapevine Editorial Report: The senior editor reported Grapevine magazines currently in production and on schedule: MARCH - *Ninth Step Amends*; APRIL - *Fun in Sobriety*; MAY - *Our Twelve Steps*; JUNE – *Dating & Relationships*; Audio Project: More stories are now being used and uploaded on Youtube; publishing more AA News and interviews with Class A Trustees; new *Prison Book* (spring 2021)—in layout interior done, cover done, being proofed, finishing touches; new *Prayer & Meditation Book* (fall 2021)—stories selected and formed into chapters and chapter intros being written; working with web coordinator to improve website archive search function; Metadata—constant updates on all product descriptions to improve searchability. An up-to-date on-going master list has been created for consistency.

La Viña Editorial Report: The La Viña editor reported recent La Viña magazine released: January/February 2021 *The Home Group*. La Viña magazines currently in production and on schedule: March/April 2021 *Newcomer Issue*; May/June 2021 *Spirituality*; July/August 2021 *La Viña Celebrates it's 25th Anniversary!* Ongoing Projects: *Voices of Women* in Spanish – final proofing stages, on schedule for Spring 2021; LV EAB schedule being prepared for this year as well as 2022 editorial calendar and LV style guide; LV Complete ads will begin circulating in March/April 2021 issue; preparing bi-monthly LV News; dedicated eblasts and next catalog update; SMS service schedule and scope being updated; updates on RLV registrations and story submissions.

Grapevine Web Report: The Web Coordinator reported monthly web traffic in the 4th quarter averaged at 88,503 unique visitors and 371,404 page views.

General Service Conference: The A.A. Grapevine Board reviewed agenda item requests and **agreed to forward** the following to the 2021 General Service Conference Committee on the Grapevine:

- Review progress report on Grapevine Workbook revisions. *(2020 carry over)*
- Review progress report on actions taken from the findings of the AA Grapevine Fellowship Survey. *(2020 carry over)*
- Consider a request to develop an A.A. Grapevine pamphlet on how the AA Grapevine can be utilized to carry the A.A. message. *(2020 carry over)*
- Review progress report on development of Instagram account.
- Review generalized language options to the A.A. preamble.
- Consider the list of suggested Grapevine book topics for 2022 and later.

Requests **not** forwarded:

- Grapevine and La Viña provide the option to receive the “*Daily Quotes*” via text message.
The Board took no action as this matter is currently under management’s review for implementation.
- Requests the addition of “*One Day at A Time*” to the set of five slogans the GV currently has for purchase (MS-04).
The Board took no action as this matter is currently under management’s review for possible implementation.

The Board reviewed these requests with great interest, appreciation and lengthy discussion.

Board Actions:

In addition to approving the minutes of September 12, 2020, the Grapevine and La Viña Treasurer's report, the Board took the following actions at its meeting on December 12, 2020:

- **Agreed** to amend AAGV, Inc. Strategic Plan dates to reflect 2021-2024.
- **Approved** Marks, Paneth as the AAGV, Inc.'s 2021 auditor.

In addition to approving the minutes of the October 30, 2020 board meeting and the Grapevine and La Viña Treasurer's report, the Board took the following actions at its meeting on January 29, 2021:

- **Approved and agreed** to forward the 2021 Grapevine budget to trustees' Finance and Budgetary committee.
- **Approved and agreed** to forward the 2021 La Viña budget to trustees' Finance and Budgetary committee.
- **Agreed** to change March 6, 2021 board meeting date to March 20, 2021.
- **Approved** request from Portugal to translate *Language of the Heart* into European Portuguese.

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Trustees' Archives Committee

Sunday, January 31, 2021

The trustees' Archives Committee met via videoconference on Sunday, January 31, 2021 at 10 a.m.

Present: Francis Gilroy, chairperson; Jimmy Dean, Mark Everett, Ino Fernandez, Sister Judith Ann Karam, Mike Lewis and Michelle Mirza, secretary.

Also present: Patrick Claymore, Jacob Diaz, Mary Ferguson, April Hegner, Debi Keane, Jan Lembke, Ruth Llano, Jess Nickum, Sheri Poore, J.J. Stafford, Jeff Wine and Sandi Wright.

Chair's remarks: The chair welcomed all committee members and guests, especially the corresponding 2021 Conference Committee on Archives chair, J.J. Stafford.

Report: The report of the November 1, 2020 meeting was approved.

Archives report: The archivist's report was read and accepted. The report contained a summary of the Archives department goals for 2021.

General Service Board Strategic Plan: The committee vice chair provided the latest update of the G.S.B. Strategic Plan items relevant to this committee. The vice chair shared that as the committee continues to review and update Archives literature items to avoid gender specific language, we ought to also be sensitive to avoid such language in the committee report.

Draft "Report on Proposed Book on A.A. history": The committee reviewed and accepted the draft "Report on Proposed Book on A.A. history." The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Archives the "Report on Proposed Book on A.A. history."

Proposal to distribute video recordings of General Service Conference presentations: The committee discussed a proposal to distribute video recordings of the General Service Conference presentations. The archivist informed the committee of a 2015 Advisory Action regarding distribution of specified audio recordings of General Service Conference presentations but there is no guiding policy on distributing video recordings.

Following a lively discussion, the committee agreed to take no action on the proposal. It was agreed that an audio counterpart of Conference sessions is available for distribution in accordance with a 2015 Conference Advisory Action:

Audio recordings of General Service Conference presentations published in the General Service Conference Final Report and audio recordings of the trustees' farewell talks given at the closing brunch be made available in accordance with Archives' Policies. Access to all other General Service Conference sessions will continue to be prohibited.

Additionally, the GSC Final Reports include published content of presentations made at the Conference.

Permission request: Prior to this meeting and through electronic mail, the committee approved one request in accordance with G.S.O. Archives policies:

A request from Ken Baratko to access a personal correspondence from Larry J. to Bill W. dated May 23, 1942.

Old business:

Update to Shared Experiences section in the Archives Workbook: The committee reviewed six of the seventeen submissions from local archives, selected by the G.S.O. Archives department for updating the “Shared Experiences” section in the Archives Workbook. Additionally, excerpts from seven other submissions were selected for the committee’s consideration, for inclusion in a new subsection. This subsection will include shares on topics related to archives work to supplement the proposed six submissions.

New business:

G.S.O. Archives Mission and Purpose Statement: The committee chair proposed a minor modification to add new language to address digital materials to the first bullet of the “Purpose” section of the Archives “Mission and Purpose” statement that currently reads:

Receive, classify, and index all relevant material, such as administrative files and records, correspondence, and literary works and artifacts considered to have historical importance to Alcoholics Anonymous.

Following discussion, the committee agreed to add “digital materials” to the first bullet of the “Purpose” statement to read:

Receive, classify and index all relevant material such as administrative files and records, **digital materials**, correspondence, literary works and artifacts considered to have historical importance to Alcoholics Anonymous.

The meeting adjourned at 11:38 a.m.

Trustees' General Service Conference Committee

Saturday, January 30, 2021

The trustees' General Service Conference Committee met via videoconference on Saturday, January 30, 2021 at 10 a.m.

Present were: Cathy Beckham, chairperson; Beau Bush, Josh Eggleston, Mark Everett, Ino Fernandez, Kathi Fowler, Michele Grinberg, Deborah Koltai, Peter Luongo, Stephanie Lyles, Greg Tobin, and Patrick Claymore, secretary.

Also present: Molly Anderson, Carolyn Barnes-Walsh, Terry Bedient, Jimmy Dean, Mary Ferguson, Kevin Fowler, Francis Gilroy, James Hurst, Bill Lewis, Donny Maclean, Sheri Poore, Newton Pritchett, Gary Provo, Randy Shaw, Attallah Sophas, Craig Weidner, Mike Wilson, and Sandra Wilson.

Chair's remarks: Cathy Beckham, chairperson, welcomed all in attendance, especially the 2021 Conference committee chairs: Conference Committee on Agenda, Gary Provo; Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions, Kevin Fowler; and Conference Report and Charter Committee, Mary Ferguson.

Report: The committee approved the October 31, 2020 report.

Staff report: The staff report was accepted as written.

Review of Proposed items for 2021 Conference Agenda:

A. Online groups not affiliated with a physical meeting space:

- i. Consider a request from a local district that recognizes "Online Groups" as voting members of the district and asks that the Conference take action to grant "Online A.A. Groups" the same privileges as "Brick and Mortar Groups."
- ii. That the General Service Conference consider allowing participation of all virtual groups not affiliated with a physical meeting space, by creating a 94th Area to our service structure that will encompass those A.A. groups.
- iii. Adapt the General Service structure to recognize online-only groups as official groups. Without that recognition, members have no voice and are denied access to service opportunities.
- iv. Consider allowing virtual or online groups to register under their respective district and area instead of the Online Intergroup.
- v. Consider holding a discussion about how to give online only (virtual) meetings a voice and a vote in the General Service structure and access to General Service Office (G.S.O.) services.
- vi. Discuss the current procedure of referring non-face-to-face Groups to an entity outside the A.A. service structure to be listed and consider creating a Traditions based policy that meets the needs of the Fellowship and its Groups.

Online groups not affiliated with a physical meeting space: The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions six proposed agenda items related to the topic of online groups not affiliated with a physical meeting space, having a voice and a vote in the General Service structure.

Procedure to appeal a ruling by the Conference chair: The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions a proposed agenda item to “Request a procedure be drafted to appeal a ruling by the Conference chair. This procedure may include that the chair provides an explanation as to such ruling and the process for challenging a ruling of the chair as defined in Robert's Rules of Order.”

Implement new opportunities for A.A. members to submit input on Conference agenda: The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Agenda a proposed agenda item to “Consider the implementation of new opportunities for A.A. members to submit input on the General Service Conference agenda items prior to the full Conference convening.” The committee understands the importance of pre-Conference meetings that occur across the U.S./Canada service structure to gather local member input.

Schedule General Service Conference in mid-May annually: The committee reviewed a proposed agenda item to “Consider that the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous be scheduled and held in mid-May of each year” and took no action. The committee appreciates the allowance of more time for local discussion that the movement of the Conference to mid-May could make. However, the committee agreed that maintaining flexibility to negotiate contracts and manage unexpected events is critical to scheduling. In addition, The Bylaws of the General Service Board include quarterly meeting date requirements and this change could adversely impact post- Conference work.

Revise Process of Polling the G.S.C. between Annual Meetings: The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions a proposed agenda item to “Consider revising the Process for Polling the General Service Conference between Annual Meetings as to include virtual meeting technologies.”

Alternate G.S.C. between a virtual and face-to-face format: The committee discussed a proposed agenda item to “Consider that the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous implement a ten-year trial period alternating face-to-face with virtual General Service Conferences, to commence after current contractual obligations are met” and agreed that a decision to implement a trial is premature. The committee acknowledged there has only been one virtual Conference experience, and that lessons learned are being implemented to host the second for the 71st G.S.C. The committee asked the staff secretary to place an agenda item on the July 2021 meeting to continue this discussion.

Revise the Current Conference Charter: The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Report and Charter Committee a proposed agenda item to “Update paragraph 1 of the current Conference charter, the *Purpose*, to include the Concepts in addition to the Steps and Traditions as the legacies that the General Service Conference serves as guardians for. The revised text of the *Purpose* paragraph would read “The General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous is the guardian of the world services and of the Twelve Steps, the Twelve Traditions and the Twelve Concepts of Alcoholics Anonymous....”

Update the Concept XI essay in the *Twelve Concepts for World Service*: The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Report and Charter Committee a proposed agenda item to “Update the Concept XI essay to accurately describe both the Trustee Committee structure and the organization of the service corporations, Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc., and the AA Grapevine, Inc. The ownership of these service corporations by the General Service Board should also be clarified.”

2021 Proposed Agenda Items Report: The committee received the grid of 61 items that have been submitted as proposed agenda items or carried over from a prior year and still under consideration for placement on the 2021 Conference Agenda as part of an annual review.

Subcommittee on Conference Improvement and Conference Week Schedule: The committee discussed the work completed by the subcommittee and approved the recommended 71st Virtual General Service Conference week schedule for implementation by the Conference coordinator.

Subcommittee on equitable distribution of workload: The committee **agreed to forward** the revised proposed process for equitable distribution of workload including a scoring tool to the 2021 Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions for consideration.

General Service Board Strategic Plan items: The committee received a report from the committee vice chair on the General Service Board Strategic Plan items that are relevant to this committee. The vice chair highlighted that the committee is acting on goals by scheduling activities and making improvements to the Conference experience using the 70th G.S.C. evaluation responses. In addition, the pre-Conference remote communities meeting is planned for the 71st G.S.C. to continue to expand awareness of underrepresented populations.

Report on Committee Assignment Application: The committee discussed a report on the newly developed Conference Committee Assignment Application implemented for the 2020 Committee Selection process. The committee **agreed to forward** the report to the 2021 Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions for consideration.

Conference evaluation: The committee reviewed the 2021 Conference Evaluation Forms. The 2021 Conference Committee on Agenda will review the forms, process and 2020 Evaluation Summary Report as a standard agenda item.

Report on Conference Agenda Process: The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Agenda the “Report to the Conference on the Implementation and Effectiveness of the 2021 Conference Agenda Process.” This report includes an annual survey of Conference committee chairs about the effectiveness of the communication between the trustees’ committee chair or corporate board chair and the corresponding Conference committee chair.

Trustees’ Nominating Committee recommendation for ACMs to attend the 71st G.S.C.: The committee discussed a recommendation from the trustees’ Nominating Committee to invite ACM members from trustees’ committees, to attend the 71st General Service Conference.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board:

That the request to invite ACM members from trustees’ committees to attend the 71st General Service Conference, except sessions designated for delegates or trustees only,

on a one-year trial basis, as non-Conference members to share points of information, be approved.

Invite Panel 70 delegates to attend a future in-person General Service Conference: The committee considered a new business item brought forward by a committee member to discuss the idea of extending an open invitation to all Panel 70 delegates to attend a future in-person General Service Conference.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board:

To extend an open invitation to all Panel 70 delegates to attend a future face-to-face General Service Conference as a non-voting observer with each delegate to cover their own expense for the trip.

The committee adjourned at 12:17 p.m.

RECOMMENDATIONS:

That the request to invite ACM members from trustees' committees to attend the 71st General Service Conference, except sessions designated for delegates or trustees only, on a one-year trial basis, as non-Conference members to share points of information, be approved.

To extend an open invitation to all Panel 70 delegates to attend a future face-to-face General Service Conference as a non-voting observer with each delegate to cover their own expense for the trip.

**Trustees' Cooperation with the Professional Community/
Treatment and Accessibilities Committee**
January 31, 2021

The trustees' Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee met by videoconference on Sunday, January 31, 2021 at 1:00 p.m.

Present: Peter Luongo, chairperson; Christine Carpenter, Tommi Hanley, Al Mooney, David Noll, Irma Van De Bon-Nicol, George Wright, and co-secretaries, Amy C. Bailey and Irene Donoso.

Also present: Mary Cumings, Jan Lembke, Bill Lewis, Mike Lewis, Nancy McCarthy, Kerry Meyer, Shar Miller, Jamey Nehring, Jess Nickum, David Rosen, Yael Shmilovitz, Jullisa Soriano, J.J. Stafford, Ames Sweet, and Sandra Wilson.

Part I

Chair's remarks: Peter Luongo, chairperson welcomed all committee member and visitors in attendance.

Report: The committee approved the November 1, 2020 report.

Part II – Cooperation with the Professional Community

Staff report: The committee accepted the staff report as presented.

"A.A. in Your Community": The committee reviewed a progress report submitted by G.S.O's Executive Editor and provided clarification about the target audience for the pamphlet. The committee looks forward to a draft or progress report at the July 2021 meeting.

Discuss using Health Care Media distribution: The committee discussed using Health Care Media distribution for PSAs and agreed that this would be an effective way to reach the suffering alcoholic. The committee asked the staff secretary to explore developing language that would encourage conversations about problem drinking.

C.P.C. Exhibits: The committee recognized that due to COVID-19, most face-to-face exhibits have been canceled. The committee asked the staff secretary to continue to monitor and explore opportunities to exhibit at videoconference events or face-to-face when available.

G.S.B. Strategic Plan: The Vice chair provided an update of the G.S.B. Strategic Plan items relevant to this committee.

Review Memo from Ad Hoc Working Group "Does AA Work?" Video: The committee reviewed a memorandum from the senior manager of the Communication Services department regarding the "Does Alcoholics Anonymous Work?" video produced by Stanford University. The committee requested that the staff secretary craft a memorandum to the Ad Hoc working group expressing their appreciation for their work thus far and requesting that the working group continue exploring ways to use the video "Does Alcoholics Anonymous Work?"

Review draft update "Members of the Clergy Ask about A.A.": The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community the draft update of the pamphlet "Members of the Clergy Ask about A.A."

Part III – Treatment

Staff Report: The committee approved the staff report as presented.

"Bridging the Gap" Pamphlet: The committee reviewed a progress report from G.S.O.'s Publishing department regarding the update to the pamphlet "Bridging the Gap" and provided clarification about the target audience for this pamphlet. The committee expressed appreciation for the ongoing work and looks forward to a progress report or draft at the July 2021 meeting.

Bridging the Gap Service Materials: The committee reviewed the grid of shared experience on Bridging the Gap (BTG) by local committees. The committee asked that the staff secretary share the grid with G.S.O.'s Executive Editor for use in updating the BTG pamphlet and other service material. The committee looks forward to receiving updated BTG materials at the July 2021 meeting.

G.S.B. Strategic Plan: The committee vice chair provided an update of the G.S.B. Strategic Plan items relevant to this committee.

Part IV – Accessibilities

Staff report: The staff report was accepted as written.

Update on "A.A. for the Older Alcoholic": The committee received a verbal update regarding the pamphlet "A.A. for the Older Alcoholic." The committee noted that additional stories would be helpful for the development of the pamphlet. The committee requested that the staff secretary release another call for stories with a deadline no later than March 15. The committee suggested that a subcommittee to work on story selection might be

formed at the July 2021 meeting. The committee **agreed to forward** a progress report to the 2021 Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.

Update on Audio interviews with Military Professionals: The committee listened to one final draft of an audio interview by the appointed committee member (ACM) and an A.A. member in the military. The committee expressed appreciation for the work being done and noted the effectiveness of the interview format for carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics in the Armed Services. The committee asked the secretary to work with the Publishing department to finalize the three remaining audio interviews by the ACM and A.A. member from the military. The committee **agreed to forward** a progress report to the 2021 Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.

Update on communications with senior personnel in the military: The committee received a verbal update from the ACM regarding communications with senior military personnel in the U.S., including a podcast interview with the Communications Director of the Veterans of Foreign Wars (VFW) which the VFW posted on its website. The ACM also reported on the established relationships with the Outreach Officer for the Director of the National Guard and the Assistant Secretary of Defense for Support to Military Families at the Pentagon. Discussions are underway with these senior military personnel about how Alcoholics Anonymous can be of service to their organizations at a time when alcohol abuse continues to be a serious problem within the military community.

The committee expressed appreciation for the ongoing work by the ACM and asked the staff secretary to forward a memo to the A.A.W.S. board requesting that the ACM podcast be considered for posting to the A.A. website. The committee also asked that the staff secretary provide an update to this request at the July 2021 meeting.

General Service Board Strategic Plan: The committee vice chair provided the latest update of the G.S.B. Strategic Plan on items relevant to this committee.

The meeting adjourned at 2:52 p.m.

Trustees' Corrections Committee

Saturday, January 30, 2021

The trustees' Corrections Committee met via videoconference on Saturday, January 30, 2021 at 10:00 a.m.

Present were: Nancy McCarthy, chairperson; Al J. Mooney, Cindy French, Jan Lembke, Sister Judith Ann Karam, Mike Lewis, Tommi Hanley, Trish LaNauze, and Brenda Brown, secretary.

Also present: Debi Keane, Conference Committee chair, Leslie Backus, Julie Blattberg, Christine Carpenter, Ruth Llano, Kerry Meyer, Jess Nickum, Kevin Prior, David Rosen, Yael Shmilovitz, JJ Stafford, Irma Van De Bon-Nicol, Jeff Wine and Sandi Wright.

Chair's remarks: Nancy McCarthy, chairperson, welcomed all in attendance, especially the 2021 Conference Committee on Corrections chair, Debi Keane.

Report: The committee approved the October 31, 2020 report.

Staff report: The committee accepted the staff report. The committee discussed that the corrections desk receives inquiries from inmates who are transgender and are requesting to correspond with other alcoholics of similar experience for identification and safety purposes. These circumstances will be communicated in an upcoming Corrections Activity Update from the desk to continue adding to the internal list of A.A. members with transgender and non-binary experience who are willing to correspond with alcoholics behind the walls.

Additionally, the staff secretary discussed this topic as it relates to the Corrections Correspondence Service form for insiders. It was agreed that the staff secretary would continue working with Publishing and staff to revise the form to include a gender marker option.

A.A.W.S. Digital Literature: The publishing director gave a report on digital literature distribution and noted that, on January 14, 2021, A.A.W.S., Inc. officially launched its enhanced eBook and audiobook distribution implementation with Ingram Core Source Plus. This enables e-books to be available in prison libraries through the National Corrections Library.

American Prison Data System: The committee received a report from Market Partners on the American Prison Data System (APDS) project. AA Grapevine (AAGV) will be working with APDS on how facilities might better understand their content to encourage them to opt into receiving it. Four other vendors who supply tablets to correctional facilities in the U.S. were discussed as well. There was also a presentation on what might be done to encourage digital distribution of A.A. literature in Canadian correctional facilities. The presentation will be forwarded to the staff secretary to share with committee members.

Discuss suggested revisions to the Corrections Workbook: The committee reviewed suggested revisions to the Corrections Workbook. The committee expressed appreciation for the substantial work of the National Corrections Conference committee and others who submitted their shared experience to inform the service material. The

trustees chair will provide updates to the “Letter to the Warden” and submit to the staff secretary.

The benefits of digital kits, including quicker updating and easy linking to video assets and having a print-on-demand option for those without digital access was discussed. The committee suggested that the Conference Committee on Corrections add this to their review of the corrections kit.

Discuss the development of a plan for full review of corrections literature: The committee continued discussing alternatives to the use of the term “inmate” and considered the term “confined member.” The committee asked the staff secretary to compile the background on this item for discussion by the 2021 Conference Committee on Corrections.

The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Corrections a proposed agenda item “that the Conference Committee on Corrections review corrections related literature intended for use by members in corrections facilities and take action to remove the words 'inmate' and 'offender' from A.A.W.S. literature and replace these words with more inclusive terms.”

Consider suggested text for addition to pre-release service material for A.A.s on the inside: The committee suggested that the Conference Committee on Corrections, in their review of corrections service material, consider the different quotes provided for the pre-release flyer for A.A.’s on the inside. The committee asked the staff secretary to compile the background on this item for discussion by the Conference Committee on Corrections.

Request sharing on innovative ways of carrying the message to correctional facilities: The committee discussed the request to assist A.A. groups in finding innovative ways of carrying the message to alcoholics in correctional facilities/programs. The committee noted how important this is, especially with all the changes that continue because of the pandemic.

The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Corrections a proposed agenda item to “request sharing from the Fellowship to assist A.A. groups in finding innovative ways of carrying the message to alcoholics in correctional facilities/programs” for consideration and discussion.

New Business:

Corrections Correspondence Service in Canada: The committee discussed the Corrections Correspondence Service in Canada (CCS-Canada) including a verbal report on past efforts to introduce CCS in Canada. The staff secretary will continue gathering shared experience from Canadian members involved in corrections service. The committee will continue this discussion at the July 2021 meeting.

The committee adjourned at 12:00 p.m.

Trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee

Sunday, January 31, 2021

The trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee met via videoconference on Sunday, January 31, 2021 at 1:00 p.m.

Present were: Leslie Backus, chair; Carolyn Barnes-Walsh, Beau Bush, Jimmy Dean, Josh Eggleston, Cindy French, Francis Gilroy, Michele Grinberg, Sister Judith Ann Karam, Stephanie Lyles, Ginger Rhoades Bell, Greg Tobin, and Zenaida Medina, secretary

Also present: Molly Anderson, Cathy Beckham, Brenda Brown, Patrick Claymore, Mark Everett, Mary Ferguson, Kathi Fowler, Kevin Fowler, James Hurst, Racy Joseph, Debi Keane, Paul Konigstein, Deborah Koltai, Trish LaNauze, Ruth Llano, Donnie McLean, Sheri Poore, Kevin Prior, Newton Pritchett, Gary Provo, Ginger Rhoades – Bell, Steven SanInocencio, Randy Shaw, Attallah Sophas, Craig Weidner, Mike Wilson, Jeff Wine, Sandi Wright.

Report: The report of the November 1, 2020 meetings was approved with amendments

Chairperson's remarks: Leslie Backus opened the meeting with a moment of silence and the Serenity Prayer. After roll call Leslie welcomed Randy Shaw, Conference Committee on Finance chair.

The Defined Benefit Plan Retirement Committee and the Retiree Medical Benefits Committee met on November 19, 2020. Tom Sutton, BPAS investment adviser, reviewed the portfolio performance for the nine months ended September 30, 2020. The ending value for the quarter was \$39,709,592. An investment gain of \$4,760,939 was offset by withdrawals of \$3,051,492. The return on investment for the quarter was 5.24% compared to the target index return of 4.99%. Year to date, the portfolio return is 8.95% compared to the index return of 8.41%. Year to date management, actuarial, and trustee fees total \$63,227, which is about 0.18% of the portfolio market value.

Amy Kemp and Nick Mark, BPAS actuary team, provided a report on the actuarial position of obligations and assets of the Defined Benefit Pension Plan and Retiree Medical Plan. The accounting standard for calculating the pension benefit obligation assumes that assets will earn a return of 2.62%. Under this assumption, plan assets as of September 30, 2020 are \$32,076,498 and liabilities are \$37,499,296, making the plan 86% funded. Assets and liabilities both declined during 2020 due to the early retirement window and lump sum elections.

The government mandated minimum funding requirement calculation assumes that assets will earn a return of 5.36%. Under this assumption the plan is either 133% funded or 116% funded depending on whether the government relief option is elected. This method yields a higher percent funded than the accounting method because it is more optimistic about how much the assets will grow in the future. The present value of benefits expected to be earned by participants in 2020 is \$925,521. The PBGC premium for 2020 is \$13,695.

As of December 31, 2019, the accounting liability for the postretirement medical plan is \$6,398,120. The accounting cost of the plan for 2020 is expected to be \$279,695.

The chair reported that of the \$4.5 million dollars that was approved by the committee to withdraw from the Reserve Fund due to the pandemic, G.S.O. has withdrawn \$4M dollars in 2020.

G.S.O. Financial Results: The committee reviewed G.S.O. unaudited financial results for 2020. Gross Sales for 2020 of \$9,098,578 were \$757,531 lower than budgeted. Gross Profit from literature was \$6,315,675 and represented a 72.00% Gross Profit Percentage.

Contributions for 2020 are a record breaking \$10,304,185. This is \$417,930 greater than budgeted and \$1,448,488 more than 2019 (\$8,855,697 was received from the Fellowship in 2019). The committee expressed its gratitude to the Fellowship for the continuing Seventh Tradition support.

Historically about 58% of revenue comes from literature sales and about 42% from contributions. In 2020, literature sales make up 37% of revenue with 63% coming from contributions.

Total Revenue (gross profit from literature plus contributions) was \$16,878,787 and \$502,849 more than budgeted.

Preliminary total expenses for 2020 were \$16,667,870. This is \$337,127 less than budgeted. The Travel, Meals and Accommodations line is \$205,987 which is significantly lower than last year due to a reduction in travel caused by the cancellation of events because of COVID-19. This reduction in travel also reflects that the G.S.B., A.A.W.S. and AAGV board meetings are now held virtually. Professional fees are \$1,923,880 for 2020 which is \$1,241,058 more than budgeted. Contracted Services were \$836,271 for 2020 and is \$917,531 less than budgeted. The Professional fees line and the Contracted Services line are best analyzed together. Due to our new chart of accounts, all of Contracted Services is being reclassified into the appropriate detailed Professional Fees line.

The combination of the above revenues and expenses resulted in G.S.O. reporting a preliminary gain of \$210,917 for 2020. This compares to a budgeted loss of \$337,127.

General Service Board support of the La Viña service activity was \$392,625 compared with a budgeted amount of \$317,025 and an actual of \$297,396 in 2019.

The G.S.O. financial report was accepted by the committee.

G.S.O. 2021 Budget Presentation: The 2021 G.S.O. budget projects gross sales of \$8,865,000. After subtracting manufacturing costs and shipping expense, gross profit is budgeted at \$5,639,400 or 64% gross profit percentage.

Contributions are budgeted at \$9,725,000 and assumes \$810,417/month. In comparison, actual individual/group contributions since COVID have averaged \$881,000 per month.

Total budgeted expenses for 2021 of \$14,952,613 are \$1,715,257 less than 2020 actual. After deducting \$14,958,613 of operating expenses from the anticipated revenue of \$16,878,787, the result is a budgeted net profit of \$641,387 before depreciation compared

to the preliminary net gain of \$210,917 in 2020.

The committee was briefed on the extra efforts made to decentralize the budget process and engage direct involvement of senior managers to create budgets for their departments.

The committee recommended that the General Service Board approve the 2021 G.S.O. budget, which reflects total revenues of \$15,594,000, total expenses of \$14,952,613 and a bottom-line surplus of \$641,387 before depreciation.

Grapevine Financial Results: Josh Eggleston presented the unaudited year end results for 2020. Average paid circulation of the Grapevine magazine was 63,397. This compared with a budget of 67,802 and 2019 actual of 66,376. Online and GV Subscription app circulation are 5,175 in 2020 compared to a budget of 4,046 and actual of 4,806 in 2019.

Gross profit on the magazine of \$1,003,700 was \$205,945 less than budgeted. Gross profit on other content-related materials of \$313,535 was \$476,318 lower than budgeted and \$346,996 less than 2019.

Total gross profit for the year was \$1,358,481 which is \$671,017 lower than budgeted and \$619,774 less than the \$1,978,255 achieved in 2019.

Total costs and expenses of the magazine for the year were \$1,732,443, which were \$292,442 lower than budgeted and \$274,026 less than the \$2,006,470 in 2019.

After adding interest earned, there was a shortfall in 2020 of \$373,963 compared with a net loss of \$28,215 in 2019 and a budgeted net profit of \$4,612 for 2020.

Josh Eggleston provided detail on the impacts that have influenced the finances in 2020. Some positive impacts include the Carry the Message initiative, new websites, and the 2019 Conference Advisory Action on allowing outside sales. On the other hand, historical assumptions toward subscription and literature sales related to the 2020 International Convention had a negative impact.

The Grapevine financial report was accepted by the committee.

2021 Grapevine Budget Presentation: The 2021 budget assumed average paid circulation of the Grapevine magazine of 62,124 and Grapevine Subscription app circulation of 5,442. Total income is \$1,358,481.

Total gross profit for the year is estimated to be \$1,463,633. Total costs and expenses of the magazine are \$1,817,859.

After adding interest earned there's a budgeted deficit of \$354,225.

The committee recommended that the General Service Board approve the 2021 Grapevine budget, which reflects total revenues of \$1,358,481 and a bottom-line deficit of \$354,225.

La Viña Results: For the unaudited year end results for 2020, average paid subscriptions for La Viña were 6,435 compared to 10,100 budgeted and 10,150 for 2019. Income from

magazine sales at year end of 2020 was \$73,895 compared with a budget of \$116,567. After deducting the costs and expenses of \$426,881, a shortfall between revenue and expenses of \$392,625 resulted for this service activity. This compares with a budgeted shortfall of \$317,025 for 2020 and a shortfall of \$297,396 for 2019. The shortfall for the La Viña service activity is funded by a transfer from the General Fund of the G.S.B.

The La Viña financial report was accepted by the committee.

2021 La Viña Budget Presentation: The 2021 budget assumed average paid circulation for La Viña of 5,605. Total income is \$62,968.

After deducting the costs and expenses of \$426,783, a shortfall between revenue and expenses of \$401,790 is assumed for this service activity.

The committee recommended that the General Service Board approve the 2021 LaViña budget, which reflects total revenues of \$62,968 and a bottom-line deficit of \$401,790.

Reserve Fund: On December 31, 2020 the Reserve Fund balance was \$12,297,131. There was a total of four withdrawals from the reserve fund totaling \$4 million in 2020 due to the pandemic. The current balance covers 7.74 months of expenses.

International Convention Financial Reporting Update – The committee referenced the 2020 International Convention financial report provided by Talley Management that was discussed at the last meeting. The committee discussed drafting a short narrative to provide additional context for the report when sharing it with the Fellowship at the 2021 71st General Service Conference and in other appropriate venues.

Policy Reviews – The committee reviewed and discussed two proposed policies for 1) selection of the independent auditor and 2) annual review of IRS Form 990 information return for not-for-profits. The committee provided feedback on the policies and it will be brought back in July with amendments.

A.A.W.S. Report on Self-Support: Jimmy Dean gave a brief update on the Self-support subcommittee noting discussion of the contributions envelope, especially in light of the move to Lockbox services with the bank. The Lockbox will change the P.O. Box for contributions, which will necessitate redoing the business reply envelopes. There were ideas and input into the envelope on the importance of capturing email addresses and the verbiage that is contained on the envelope. The committee requested information from the Archives on how long business reply envelopes have been in circulation and the committee learned they have been in existence since 1953. The committee suggested we continue to supply business reply envelopes with the new P.O. Box that will be created for Lockbox. There have also been discussions on flyers that focus on self-support. It was noted that the business reply envelopes we currently use are only valid in the US. Paul Konigstein reported to the committee that staff would begin looking into the steps of using Canadian business reply envelopes.

Ad Hoc Committee Progress Report – Google Grants and the Seventh Tradition: Jimmy Dean, chair, shared that the committee has created a report that was included in the background. Extensive amounts of research and work went into creating this report and the

main objective was to give facts as to what it is to be a non-profit to receive this benefit. One of the main topics was discussing other non-profit benefits that are received by us and other similar non-profit organizations, such as audit rates and bank fees. The chair stated that this report will be forwarded to the Conference Committee on Finance.

The committee **agreed to forward** the Ad Hoc Committee Progress Report – Google Grants and the Seventh Tradition to the Conference Committee on Finance.

Pension Annuitization Update – Amy Kemp and Nicholas Mark from BPAS, the defined benefit pension plan actuarial consultant, presented an updated analysis of the benefits and costs of a pension annuitization plan to management on January 27. Retirement Committee chair Paul Konigstein will schedule a Retirement Committee meeting in February to discuss the updated analysis and make a recommendation to this committee.

Conference Committee on Finance proposed agenda items: The committee reviewed proposed agenda item A, “Consider the relevance and applicability of the passage in the essay portion of Concept Twelve, Warranty Two, (A.A. *Service Manual*, p. 62) which states that neither the groups nor A.A. as a whole should function as a 'money charity' via the practice of ‘selling of our books at cost or less.’”

The committee **agreed to forward** the agenda item: “Consider the relevance and applicability of the passage in the essay portion of Concept Twelve, Warranty Two, (A.A. *Service Manual*, p. 62) which states that neither the groups nor A.A. as a whole should function as a 'money charity' via the practice of ‘selling of our books at cost or less’” to the Conference Committee on Finance.

The committee reviewed proposed agenda item B, “Discuss how the pamphlet 'Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix' has contributed to the mechanization of group contributions that has not worked well in these peculiar times.”

The committee **agreed to forward** the agenda item: “Discuss how the pamphlet "Self-Support" Where Money and Spirituality Mix" has contributed to the mechanization of Group contributions that has not worked well in these peculiar times” to the Conference Committee on Finance.

The committee met in executive session and discussed the Grapevine Support Discussion. Josh Eggleston presented the following accounting of Grapevine losses as a result of the cancellation of the 2020 International Convention:

Item	Amount
Translation services	7,835
Designer Interior	4,400
Designer CVRs	1,300
Project Editors	5,550
Proofer	960
Printing/shipping	36,111
Refunded pre-sales	53,383
Administrative	70,461

TOTAL	180,000

The committee recommended that Grapevine be reimbursed \$180,000 for expenses from the 2020 International Convention.

The meeting adjourned at 3:35 p.m.

The committee recommended that the General Service Board approve the 2021 G.S.O. budget, which reflects total revenues of \$15,594,000, total expenses of \$14,952,613 and a bottom-line surplus of \$641,387.

The committee recommended that the General Service Board approve the 2021 Grapevine budget, which reflects total revenues of \$1,358,481 and a bottom-line deficit of \$354,225.

The committee recommended that the General Service Board approve the 2021 La Viña budget, which reflects total revenues of \$62,968 and a bottom-line deficit of \$401,790.

The committee recommended that Grapevine be reimbursed \$180,000 for expenses from the 2020 International Convention.

Trustees' International Committee

Sunday, January 31, 2021

The trustees' International Committee met via videoconference on Sunday, January 31, 2021 at 10 a.m.

Present: Newton Pritchett, chair; Kathi Fowler, Michele Grinberg, Trish LaNauze, Stephanie Lyles, Nancy McCarthy, Al Mooney, David Noll, Greg Tobin, Irma Van De Bon-Nicol, and Mary Cumings, acting secretary.

Also present: Molly Anderson, Carolyn Barnes-Walsh, Cathy Beckham, Christine Carpenter, Kevin Fowler, James Hurst, Racy Joseph, Bill Lewis, Donny MacLean, Hon. Kerry Meyer, Maria Morales-Lamm, Jamey Nehring, Kevin Prior, Gary Provo, David Rosen, Randy Shaw, Rabbi Yael Shmilovitz, Attallah Sophas, Craig Weidner, Mike Wilson, and Sandra Wilson.

Chair's remarks: The chair warmly welcomed all committee members and guests.

Report: The committee approved the report of November 1, 2020.

Staff report: The staff report was accepted as presented. The committee noted that the virtual 26th World Service Meeting was fully self-supporting for the first time due to the generous support of the World Service Meeting Fund by service structures around the world, and the reduced expenses for a virtual meeting.

Virtual international event reports: The committee received reports on the following virtual international events, followed by questions and discussion:

October 30, 2020	China A.A. International Convention	Greg Tobin
Nov. 2020-Jan. 2021	REDELA Sharing Sessions	Newton Pritchett Trish LaNauze
Oct. 31-Nov. 1, 2020	1st Iran Transnational Virtual Convention Tehran, Iran	David Rosen Mary Cumings
November 4-6, 2020	International Medical Conference Guantanamo, Cuba	Leslie Backus Newton Pritchett
November 28-30, 2020	Virtual 26th World Service Meeting U.S./Canada	Newton Pritchett Trish LaNauze Michele Grinberg
December 12, 2020	51st Anniversary of G.S.O. in Mexico Mexico	Greg Tobin

December 20, 2020	Argentina XIII A.A. Seminar	Newton Pritchett Trish LaNauze
January 17, 2021	AA CIS & Baltic Countries 12th Stepping Your Neighboring Country	Newton Pritchett Trish LaNauze Mary Cumings
January 20, 2021	54th G.S.O. Anniversary Peru	Greg Tobin

List of scheduled international meetings: The committee reviewed a list of international meetings scheduled for 2021:

Monthly 2021	REDELA Sharing Sessions (virtual)	Newton Pritchett Trish LaNauze
February 5-6, 2021	XXIII A.A. Gathering of the Southern Area Chile (virtual)	Trish LaNauze
February 13, 2021	AOSM Policy/Admissions/Finance Committee Meeting (virtual)	Trish LaNauze
March 19, 2021	45th Anniversary of A.A. Japan (virtual)	TBD
July 9-11, 2021	Asia Oceania Service Meeting Hyderabad, India (virtual)	TBD
October 3-7, 2021	REDELA Meeting of the Americas Antigua, Guatemala (face-to-face)	TBD
Sept. 24-26, 2021 OR October 1-3, 2021	Sub Saharan Africa Service Meeting Johannesburg, South Africa (face-to-face)	TBD
October 22-24, 2021	European Service Meeting York, England (Meeting in June to decide virtual or in person)	TBD

NOTE: The January 23, 2021 meeting of The Netherlands General Service Conference was cancelled.

Subcommittee on Trustees' International Travel Policy: The committee received the report from the subcommittee on Trustees' International Travel Policy.

After thoughtful discussion, the committee agreed that all invitations for international travel, including requests for virtual participation, requests for G.S.O. personnel and

requests that have been declined, come to the Trip Consultation Team (TCT), and the TCT institute a regularly scheduled meeting (at least quarterly). The TCT will meet on an ad hoc basis to consider emergency requests.

The committee reviewed and approved the following revisions to the document “Purpose of Travel by Trustees & Staff (AA., US/Canada)”:

- a) From paragraph six, the following be deleted:

“Most often a Staff member meets or travels with one or more Trustees participating in an overseas trip in order to assist with preparations, obtain translation services, and to lessen the burden on travelling Trustees – most trips are physically exhausting.”

- b) In the section titled Trustees' International Committee-Consultation Team - Additional Clarification, the following paragraph be deleted:

“It was agreed that any international trips involving the G.S.O. Publications Department, Archives or other department outside the usual “Group Services” international trips generally made by the Manager, International Desk and/or designated Trustees did not have to be brought to the Consultation Team for consideration. These trips would be decided upon at the General Manager’s discretion, and management would seek input from the A.A.W.S. board when deemed appropriate.”

- c) And replace it with:

“The Trip Consultation Team consists of the Chair of the General Service Board, the Trustees-at-Large U.S. and Canada, one other trustee, the G.S.O. General Manager and the G.S.O. Staff person on the International Assignment. It reports to the trustees' International Committee, and meets regularly to review all International travel requests, assessing each request based on the purposes and activities in this document, and on the 2003 (affirmed in 2005) policy outlined in paragraph #5 of this document.”

The committee recommended that the General Service Board adopt the revised “Purpose of International Travel by Trustees & Staff (A.A., U.S./Canada)” as policy (attached) .

The committee approved replacing the current Trip Consultation Team Review Worksheet and International Trip Report Form with the revised versions.

North/South Connections: The committee reviewed a proposal to participate in a virtual pan-continental two-way shared experience. Extending the virtual hand of A.A. from the extreme latitudes in the North (the upper reaches of Eastern and Western Canada) to the extreme latitudes in the South (Patagonia and Tierra del Fuego in Argentina and Chile) would allow members who experience the challenges of living in remote communities at

extreme latitudes an opportunity for cross-sharing on challenges and solutions and to know that they are not alone. Phase1 of the proposal consists of the U.S./Canada participating as guests in Argentina's upcoming Region 6 Forum (Patagonia, Tierra del Fuego) on May 15, 2021. The U.S./Canada would provide the virtual platform, technical expertise, interpretation in French and Spanish, and participate as appropriate with projected cost of \$16,500. We are exploring shared financial responsibilities with Argentina. The committee noted that the unique nature of this event makes it difficult to accurately anticipate costs.

The committee recommended that the U.S./Canada participate in Argentina's Region 6 Forum on May 15, 2021, providing the virtual platform, technical expertise, and interpretation in French and Spanish, with a projected cost of \$16,500.

The committee tabled discussion on the following agenda items to the July 2021 meeting:

- Meeting of the Americas/REDELA and Self-support.
- International A.A. Data Map.
- Discuss G.S.B. Strategic Plan P4.1: The G.S.B. will develop a plan to embrace more direct contact with other countries to increase meaningful two-way shared experience, will explore ways to strengthen our relationships with other service structures and ways to make the World Service Meeting more efficient and effective.

The meeting adjourned at 12:00 p.m.

RECOMMENDATIONS:

The committee recommended that the General Service Board adopt the revised "Purpose of International Travel by Trustees & Staff (A.A., U.S./Canada)" as policy (attached).

The committee recommended that the U.S./Canada participate in Argentina's Region 6 Forum on May 15, 2021, providing the virtual platform, technical expertise, interpretation in French and Spanish, with a projected cost of \$16,500.

Attachment:

"Purpose of International Travel by Trustees & Staff (A.A., U.S./Canada)" revised
1/2021

Purpose of International Travel by Trustees & Staff (A.A., U.S./Canada)

The primary reasons that Trustees and G.S.O. Staff travel beyond our Conference Structure are to respond to requests for: 1) A.A. experience sought by professionals or A.A. members in locations where A.A. is taking root; and, 2) assistance and clarification on how to establish A.A. groups and a service structure.

A.A. first began spreading to other countries in the 1940s through individual A.A. members in U.S. armed forces who sought to share A.A.'s message with alcoholics in locations where A.A. was unknown. The media was also instrumental in awakening interest in A.A. through such as the 1946 *Reader's Digest* article published in foreign editions. Letters began to pour into "headquarters" (G.S.O.) leading to Bill W. and Lois' 1950 travels to Norway, Sweden, Denmark, Holland, France, England and Ireland. By 1955, Bill was able to declare at the St. Louis Convention that "A.A. had established beachheads in seventy foreign lands." Those "beachheads" evolved into A.A. groups who established their own service offices—and eventually their own service boards and publishing operations, usually through direct guidance furnished by G.S.O. Staff on behalf of the General Service Board or A.A. World Services.

The trustees' International Committee hosts the World Service Meeting (W.S.M.) when it meets in New York City, and Trustees-at-Large are U.S./Canada delegates to the biennial W.S.M. and to the Meeting of the Americas (REDELA) that meets in countries beyond our structure.

Since the early 1990s, overseas travel is most often initiated by invitation—or call for help—from members or boards in other countries. Each invitation is carefully considered to ascertain that the purposes are sound and the activities are within the purpose and scope of the board's and G.S.O.'s capacities. Most trips fall within one or more of these categories:

- Publication: Policies and procedures regarding translations, licensing and printing of A.A. literature.
- Service: Basics of setting up/operating a service office; composition, scope and procedures of boards, conference structures, service committees; placing principles ahead of personalities in service; The Twelve Concepts for World Service; and the relationship of service entity and structure to A.A. groups.
- New A.A. Groups: Setting up; principles of group conscience; sponsorship, attracting self-support, autonomy and participation in service structure. Steps: share experience and explain spiritual aspects of A.A. program.
- Traditions: Importance of principles within A.A. and in relation to the outside world; topics of interest to members and professionals include primary purpose, affiliation; anonymity and money.
- CPC and PI: Sharing A.A. facts and experience with public via print, radio and TV resources; speak with officials involved in treatment and/or correctional facilities (presentations at professional conferences usually given by a Class A trustee).
- Special Events: Participation in conventions or gatherings to celebrate A.A. milestones, e.g., a 50th anniversary of A.A. in a country.

In 2003, the trustees' International Committee recommended to the General Service Board the following regarding the value of trustees participating in overseas travel:

“...that (1) As trips are planned to areas beyond North America, the trip should, whenever possible, include trustees and especially trustees-at-large; (2) G.S.O. should make known availability of our trustees for sharing to areas where the chairman of the General Service Board and the G.S.O. General Manager believe such a visit would help to carry the message and further our relations with an A.A. office or service structure of those countries that express a need of shared experience.” The committee reaffirmed the General Service Board policy in 2005.

Over many years, G.S.O. Staff have gladly accepted the responsibility of sharing current facts and background on A.A. in other lands with trustees and directors. These practices have benefited trustees-at-large, in particular. A.A. history, the expanding need for translations of A.A. literature and the continued growth of A.A. across the world consistently demonstrate the value of the board's policy of supporting overseas travel to share experience and encourage country-to-country sponsorship—by U.S./Canada and other established A.A. structures.

The General Service Board U.S./Canada generally finances most approved international travel by trustees and staff because A.A. and/or professionals in most countries do not have sufficient resources, although they may be able to cover hotel costs, meals and/or intra-country travel.

Over many years, the U.S./Canada General Service Conference and Board have enthusiastically encouraged and supported services and travel to assist A.A. to take root in other lands, so that no suffering alcoholic stumbles in the dark without the hope offered by sobriety in A.A.

Trustees' International Committee – Consultation Team - Additional Clarification

The Trip Consultation Team consists of the Chair of the General Service Board, the Trustees-at-Large U.S. and Canada, one other trustee, the G.S.O. General Manager and the G.S.O. Staff person on the International Assignment. It reports to the trustees' International Committee, and meets regularly to review all International travel requests, assessing each request based on the purposes and activities in this document, and on the 2003 (affirmed in 2005) policy outlined in paragraph #5 of this document.

Revised 1/2021

Trustees' International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee

January 30, 2021

The trustees' International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee met via videoconference on Saturday, January 30, 2021 at 1 p.m.

Present: Jan Lembke, chairperson; Leslie Backus, Jimmy Dean, Cindy French, Francis Gilroy, Michele Grinberg, Newton Pritchett, Ginger Rhoades Bell, Irma Van De Bon-Nicol, and Sandra Wilson, acting secretary.

Also present: Molly Anderson, Mary Cumings, Mark Everett, Kevin Fowler, James Hurst, Diana Lewis, Ruth Llano, Donny MacLean, Jessica Nickum, Kevin Prior, Hon. Glade Roper, J.J. Stafford, Attallah Sophas, and Mike Wilson.

Chair's remarks: The chair opened the meeting with a moment of silence and warmly welcomed all committee members and guests, especially Jessica Nickum, chair of the 2021 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

Approval of meeting report: The report of the October 31, 2020 quarterly meeting was approved.

Part II—Regional Forums

Staff report: The committee accepted the staff report as presented.

Evaluation questionnaire summaries: The committee discussed the evaluation questionnaire summaries from US/Canada East and West Forums held December 5 and 19, 2020, respectively. Committee comments included:

- Kudos to the team for a job well done.
- "A Class Act" panel discussion proved popular and should be added to future regional forums. The committee noted that the discussion provided an opportunity for the Fellowship to get to know the Class A trustees.
- The workshop on "Who Is and Who Is Not in the Rooms" was well attended and should be added to future regional forum programs.
- The skit received negative feedback. It was suggested future skits, if any, be vetted and shown in a breakout room.
- Create an online, real-time prompt for attendees to complete the forum survey.
- The Q&A online function proved useful. Going forward, we should make sure that directors from both A.A.W.S. and Grapevine boards are available to answer online questions.

2021 virtual forums: The committee discussed and received an update on the planning for the 2021 regional forums – all which will be held as virtual events. It was noted that experience gained from the U.S./Canada Forums and the virtual World Service Meeting held in 2020 will greatly inform the planning and implementation process.

The committee also discussed a request submitted by the A.A.W.S. board to consider holding similar events like the U.S./Canada Forum in the future (even when we are not held under the restrictions of a pandemic) and to explore the feasibility of broadcasting in-person events to maintain this newly discovered accessibility to members who would not normally be able to attend in-person only events. The committee appreciated the spirit of the request and noted that at their August 1, 2020 meeting they discussed ways to increase wider participation at regional forums (including remote communities) and, at that time, agreed to the addition of a virtual component when returning to in-person regional forums in 2022. The committee looks forward to future exploration of ways to make regional forums more accessible.

New business:

The committee discussed the possibility of a virtual pan-continental special forum that would target remote communities and provide an opportunity for cross-sharing on challenges and solutions experienced by members in remote communities. After a lively discussion covering a wide range of ideas, the committee recommended the addition of a virtual pan-continental Special Forum targeting certain international and U.S./Canada remote communities to be held near the end of 2021.

The committee also agreed to evaluate the effectiveness of the special forum to determine the need for additional special forums in the future.

Part III—International Conventions

No report is currently due.

G.S.B. Strategic Plan – Update Process Grid: The committee reviewed the process grid, noting that all suggestions pertaining to Goal 1 on the G.S.B. Strategic Plan (*the G.S.B. will bring an inclusivity focus to all aspects of our services*) have been implemented accordingly on the Regional Forums and International Convention assignments, including, but not limited to, revision of correspondence to reflect more inclusive language and implementation of the “Who’s Not in the Room” workshop at regional forums.

Before adjourning, the Regional Forums video was played; the video will be available on the aa.org website in early February,

The meeting adjourned at 2:35 p.m.

RECOMMENDATION

The committee recommended the addition of a virtual pan-continental Special Forum targeting certain international and U.S./Canada remote communities to be held near the end of 2021.

Trustees' Literature Committee

Saturday, January 30, 2021

The trustees' Literature Committee met via video conference on Saturday, January 30, 2021 at 4:00 p.m.

Present: David Noll, chair; Cathy Beckham, Deborah Koltai, Mike Lewis, Peter Luongo, Nancy McCarthy, Carolyn Walsh, Amalia Castillo, Katie Heilmann, and Steve Smith, secretary.

Also present: Patrick Claymore, Jimmy Dean, Julia Dillon, Irene Donoso, Josh Eggleston, Francis Gilroy, Gary Glynn, Michele Grinberg, Hon. Glade Roper, James Hurst, Trish LaNauze, Bill Lewis, Hon. Kerry Meyer, Jess Nickum, Sheri Poore, Gary Provo, David Rosen, Randy Shaw, Rabbi Yael Shmilovitz, J.J. Stafford, and Ames Sweet.

Chair's remarks: David Noll warmly welcomed all committee members and guests including the corresponding Conference Committee on Literature chair, Sheri Poore.

Report: The report from the October 31, 2020 meeting was approved.

Staff report: The staff report was accepted.

Review agenda items forwarded to the 71st General Service Conference pertinent to this committee: The committee reviewed agenda items forwarded to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature pertinent to this committee and expressed appreciation for the efforts of the Conference Committee on Literature.

Consider an item related to request to update the pamphlet "A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic": The committee reviewed a draft memo to the Conference Literature committee related to the request to update the pamphlet "A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic." The committee **agreed to forward** the memo as part of the background of this committee which is already being forwarded for the agenda item under consideration by the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.

General Service Board Strategic Plan (July 2019): The trustees' Literature Committee reviewed the General Service Board Strategic Plan, updated July 2019. The committee discussed the Publishing department update of efforts underway related to trustees' Literature Committee goals in the General Service Board Strategic Plan (July 2019).

The committee expressed appreciation for the work being done through the A.A.W.S. Publishing Committee and Publishing department and looks forward to receiving updates at the July 2021 meeting.

Consider not retiring the existing version of the pamphlet "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated": The committee discussed the request not to retire the existing version of the pamphlet

“Twelve Traditions Illustrated” and agreed that an existing version of a literature item might remain in publication after a revised, updated version has been approved.

The committee noted that the revised updated draft of the pamphlet, “The Twelve Traditions Illustrated,” that is forwarded to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature is essentially a new item, largely resulting from the complexity of revising the illustrations.

The committee agreed that the existing version of the pamphlet, “The Twelve Traditions Illustrated,” might remain in distribution. The committee requested that the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature discuss whether the existing version be retained in its original form or revised with any updates.

Progress Report regarding language on safety and A.A. to be included in *Living Sober* and “Questions and Answers on Sponsorship”: The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature the draft language on safety and A.A. to be included in the booklet, *Living Sober*, and the pamphlet, “Questions and Answers on Sponsorship.” The committee noted that care was taken to address accessible reading levels in the draft language.

Progress Report regarding the pamphlet “Twelve Traditions Illustrated”: The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature the draft update of the pamphlet, “The Twelve Traditions Illustrated,” with the working title, “Experience Has Taught Us: Our Twelve Traditions Illustrated.” The committee noted that the revision suggestions from the 2020 Conference Committee on Literature were addressed.

Progress Report regarding pamphlet for Spanish-speaking women in A.A.: The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature the draft of the pamphlet for Spanish-speaking women in A.A.

Progress Report regarding development of a pamphlet based on A.A.’s Three Legacies: The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature the draft pamphlet based on A.A.’s Three Legacies with the working title, “Recovery, Unity and Service: Our Three Legacies.”

Progress Report regarding the pamphlet “Twelve Steps Illustrated”: The committee discussed the process to update the pamphlet “Twelve Steps Illustrated.” The committee tabled discussion to the July 2021 meeting, noting that further progress on the pamphlet “Twelve Traditions Illustrated” needs to be completed.

Progress Report regarding the pamphlet “Twelve Concepts Illustrated”: The committee discussed the process to update the pamphlet “Twelve Concepts Illustrated.” The committee tabled discussion to the July 2021 meeting, noting that further progress on the pamphlet “Twelve Traditions Illustrated” needs to be completed.

Progress Report regarding the pamphlet “Too Young?”: The committee discussed the request to update the pamphlet “Too Young?” and expressed appreciation for the ongoing work in Publishing and looks forward to a progress report at the July 2021 meeting.

Progress Report regarding the pamphlet “Young People in A.A.”: The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature the draft revised pamphlet “Young People and A.A.” The committee suggested that the Publishing department forward the stories that were submitted but not included in the pamphlet for consideration in the A.A. Grapevine.

Discuss making current literature accessible in all possible formats: The trustees’ committee reviewed the verbal progress report provided by the Publishing department regarding making current literature accessible in all possible formats under the purview of A.A.W.S. The committee noted the multiple strategic plans in process in Publishing for making A.A. literature more accessible, such as publishing audiobooks and eBooks and digital distribution of literature, including into prisons. The committee requested that Publishing provide a written version of their verbal report to be included as background material for the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.

The committee appreciates the ongoing work and looks forward to a progress report at the July 2021 meeting.

Progress Report regarding development of a Literature Committee Workbook: The committee received the Publishing department’s verbal progress report on the development of a Literature Committee Workbook. The committee expressed appreciation for the ongoing work and looks forward to a progress report at the July 2021 meeting.

Consider if proposed agenda items for plain language, simplified language, accessible translations and large print versions of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, as well as workbooks to help study the program of Alcoholics Anonymous, can be addressed with a common solution: The trustees’ Literature Committee continued exploring if proposed agenda items related to the accessibility of the Big Book can be addressed with a common solution.

The committee noted that the video presentation “The Big Book: Researching Issues, Possible Tools and Access (70th General Service Conference 2020),” which was presented to the Conference Committee on Literature during their May 2, 2020 agenda reduction meeting, was made available, in English, Spanish and French as requested, with an announcement and link to the video to members of the 69th, 70th and 71st General Service Conferences.

The committee discussed a progress report from the Subcommittee on Researching Issues, Possible Tools and Access to the Book (2020-21 RIPTAB), *Alcoholics Anonymous*. The committee noted the report’s focus on accessibility and relatability of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous* in terms of the A.A. message reaching a wider

demographic of alcoholics. The committee expressed appreciation for the significant scope of considerations as well as the suggested possibilities to guide ongoing discussions for moving forward.

The committee also noted the specific options outlined in the report to discuss digital material related to the message of recovery along with the idea to develop a plain language version of the Big Book. This idea of a new book is not meant to replace the Big Book, rather to overcome relatability and accessibility barriers so the A.A. message might reach more still-suffering alcoholics.

The committee **agreed to forward** the progress report from the Subcommittee on “Researching Issues, Possible Tools and Access to the Book (2020-21 RIPTAB), *Alcoholics Anonymous*” to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.

Consider presenting the A.A. program of recovery in digital formats: The committee discussed the request to present the A.A. program of recovery in digital formats. The committee noted that the item is now part of the ongoing discussion of the agenda item:

“Consider if proposed agenda items for plain language, simplified language, accessible translations and large print versions of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, as well as workbooks to help study the program of Alcoholics Anonymous, can be addressed with a common solution.”

The committee agreed to table discussions until the July 2021 meeting.

Consider adding the Long Form of each Tradition at the beginning of each essay for that Tradition in the book, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*: The committee considered adding the Long Form of each Tradition at the beginning of each essay for that Tradition in the book *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* and **agreed to forward** the item to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.

Consider revising the pamphlet, “Experience, Strength and Hope: Women in A.A.”: The committee considered revising the pamphlet, “Experience, Strength and Hope: Women in A.A.” and took no action. The committee agreed not to revise existing personal shared experience that is already published in the pamphlet, nor to revise the pamphlet content to reflect current events. The committee noted the AA Grapevine and La Viña magazines as avenues for shared personal experience with alcoholism in the context of current events.

In addition, the committee suggested that the Publishing department consider developing content related to the role that women in A.A. have played as it relates to virtual settings for meetings which might be included in service material or perhaps be posted to the website aa.org.

Consider updating the pamphlet “A.A. for the Native North American”: The committee considered updating the pamphlet, “A.A. for the Native North American,” and noted the

need for an overall update including ensuring that the language is respectful and more effective at carrying A.A.'s message. It was recognized that research will likely be necessary for a comprehensive revision.

The committee **agreed to forward** the item to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.

Consider the development of a draft Fifth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, noting past Advisory Actions: The committee considered the development of a draft Fifth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, noting past Advisory Actions and **agreed to forward** the item to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.

The committee noted that the discussions and progress report from its "RIBTAB II" subcommittee include sharing on the topic of the language in the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous* as part of the agenda item to:

"Consider if proposed agenda items for plain language, simplified language, accessible translations and large print versions of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, as well as workbooks to help study the program of Alcoholics Anonymous, can be addressed with a common solution."

Consider revising the pamphlet, "The A.A. Group," to reflect the importance of the group as a "spiritual entity" as stated in the Long Form of Tradition Five: The committee considered revising the pamphlet, "The A.A. Group," to reflect the importance of the group as a "spiritual entity" as stated in the Long Form of Tradition Five and **agreed to forward** the item to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.

Consider revising language on page 29, question 9 in the pamphlet, "The A.A. Group": The committee considered revising language on page 29, question 9 in the pamphlet, "The A.A. Group" related to text highlighting service roles at the group level. The committee **agreed to forward** the item to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.

Discuss G.S.O. Publishing updates per the A.A.W.S.' print policy: The committee reviewed G.S.O. Publishing updates approved by the A.A.W.S. Board per its print policy.

The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature the draft update of the pamphlet, "Is A.A. for You?"

The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature the draft update of the pamphlet, "Is there an Alcoholic in Your Life?"

The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature the draft update of the pamphlet, "Frequently Asked Questions about A.A."

The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature the draft update of the pamphlet, "This is A.A."

The committee noted that the draft update of the pamphlet, "Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A." was forwarded by the A.A.W.S. Board to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment – Accessibilities which has purview of the literature item.

The meeting adjourned at 6:05 p.m.

Trustees' Nominating Committee

Saturday, January 30, 2021

The trustees' Nominating Committee met via videoconference on Saturday, January 30, 2021 at 4:00 p.m.

Present: Kathi Fowler, chair; Leslie Backus, Beau Bush, Christine Carpenter, Mark Everett, Jan Lembke, Stephanie Lyles, Newton Pritchett, Ginger Rhoades Bell, Greg Tobin, and Diana Lewis, secretary.

Also present: Molly Anderson, Terry Bedient, Josh Eggleston, Kevin Fowler, Francis Gilroy, Ruth Llano, Donny MacLean, Jamey Nehring, Irma Van De Bon-Nicol, Craig Weidner, Sandra Wilson, and Sandi Wright.

Chair's remarks: The chairperson warmly welcomed all committee members and guests, especially Sandi Wright, chair of the 2021 Conference Committee on Trustees.

Meeting report: The committee approved the October 31 and December 9, 2020 reports.

At the committee's December 9th meeting, the committee recommended to the General Service Board that Procedure No. 2. "Procedures for Selecting ACM" be updated to reflect that "ACMs have a voice and a vote at the trustees' committee to which they are appointed."

Staff report: The staff report was accepted as presented.

Status of appointed committee members: The committee reviewed an update on the status of appointed committee members serving on trustees' committees of the General Service Board for the year 2020-2021.

Calendar of events: The committee reviewed and accepted the Calendar of Events of the trustees' Nominating Committee through the 2021 General Service Conference.

Consider G.S.B. Position Appraisal Report: The committee agreed to table this discussion to their next committee meeting.

Discuss policy around the use of consultants: The committee agreed to table this discussion to their next committee meeting.

Review 2022 announcement letters: The committee reviewed the announcement letters for the vacancies in 2022 and offered suggestions. The committee noted that the search for Class A trustees will take place in 2021 and asked the secretary to work with the office to place the vacancy announcements in A.A. publications and appropriate professional journals.

Discuss Memo from Communication Services Department "Does A.A. Work?" Video: The committee agreed to table this discussion to their next committee meeting.

Memo response in Consideration of Alternate Trustees: The committee reviewed their response to the Conference Committee on Trustees regarding consideration of Alternate Trustees as part of the procedures for a partial or complete reorganization of the General Service Board/Corporate Boards. The committee **agreed to forward** the memo to the 2021 Conference Committee on Trustees.

Statement of Concern and Motion to Censure the General Service Board: The committee carefully considered the Statement of Concern and Motion to Censure the General Service Board and took no action. The committee cherishes the process to have an informed group conscience produced by a full discussion of the whole picture. The committee felt that the mechanism and the information contained in the submission did not reflect a complete picture and prevents all the current work and resolutions from being shared and from redacting any confidential personnel excerpts.

While the committee understands the challenges noted as observations in the submission, there were misgivings about not having had an opportunity sooner to reveal some of the resolutions that have taken place. Some of the committee members have volunteered to draft a memo to the 2021 Conference Committee on Trustees highlighting the progress made on some of the observations raised in the submission.

The committee suggested that adding a discussion section during the General Service Conference to address this issue would allow for all Conference members to share on the submission's reflections, speak to building trust, ask questions and talk about the progress made.

The committee met in executive session from 5:36 p.m. to 7:21 p.m. (*The committee also met in executive session on January 26, 2021 and reviewed the slate of directors of A.A. World Services, Inc. and AA Grapevine, Inc. and made recommendations as noted below.*)

Executive Sessions:

Clarifying the role of the Conference Committee on Trustees in the process of approving Corporate Board slates: The committee reviewed the memo from the Conference Committee on Trustees on clarifying the role of the Conference Committee on Trustees in the process of approving the corporate board slates. The committee noted the 2012 subcommittee report, "Procedures in the Event of Disapproval of a State of Trustees of Directors" and affirmed its findings.

Status of appointed committee members: The committee recommended to the General Service Board that Katie Heilmann of Fair Oaks, CA be reappointed for an additional one-year term to serve as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Literature Committee commencing with the July 2021 General Service Board Weekend.

Rotation of Class A trustees: The committee recommended to the General Service Board that Nancy McCarthy remain for an additional one-year term to serve as Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee on the General Service Board, with her term expiring in 2023.

Resumes of candidates eligible for election as regional trustees and trustee-at-large/U.S.:
The committee reviewed all candidates submitted for Southeast regional trustee and trustee-at-large/U.S. and found all the candidates eligible for election in April 2021. The committee reviewed all candidates submitted for East Central regional trustee and found all of the candidates eligible for election in April 2021, with one exception.

Slates of Trustees and Officers of the General Service Board and Directors of the A.A.W.S. and AA Grapevine Corporate Boards: The committee reviewed and recommended to the General Service Board the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April 2021, following presentation at the 2021 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A Trustees

Molly Anderson
Hon. Christine Carpenter
Linda Chezem, J.D.
Sr. Judith Ann Karam, C.S.A.
Al Mooney, M.D., FAAFP, FASAM
Nancy McCarthy
Kevin Prior, MBA, CFA, CPA

Class B Trustees (See "Note" below)

Beau Bush
Jimmy Dean
Josh Eggleston
Kathi Fowler
Francis Gilroy
Tommi Hanley
Deborah Koltai
Trish LaNauze
Jan Lembke
Mike Lewis
Irma Van De Bon-Nicol
East Central Regional Trustee-elect
Southeast Regional Trustee-elect
Trustee-at-Large/U.S. Trustee-elect

Note: East Central, Southeast Regional trustees, and Trustee-at-Large/U.S. to be elected at April 2021 Conference.

The committee reviewed and recommended to the General Service Board the following slate of officers of the General Service Board for election at the Second Quarterly Meeting of the General Service Board in April 2021, following presentation at the 2021 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Chairperson:	Linda Chezem, J.D.
First Vice-Chairperson:	Trish LaNauze
Second Vice-Chairperson:	Jan Lembke
Treasurer:	Kevin Prior, MBA, CFA, CPA
Secretary:	Francis Gilroy
Assistant Treasurer:	Paul Konigstein *
Assistant Secretary:	Jeff Wine*

*G.S.O. employees

The committee reviewed and recommended to the General Service Board the following slate of Directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., for election in April 2021, following presentation at the 2021 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Beau Bush	Irma Van De Bon-Nicol
Jimmy Dean	Carolyn Walsh
Vera Farrell	John Weis
Deborah Koltai	Jeff Wine*
General Manager*	

*G.S.O. employees

The committee reviewed and recommended to the General Service Board the following slate of Directors of AA Grapevine, Inc., for election in April 2021, following presentation at the 2021 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Josh Eggleston	Coree Hogan
Ino Fernandez	Mike Lewis
Cindy French	Nancy McCarthy
Francis Gilroy	Albin Zezula*
Tommi Hanley	

*AA Grapevine employee

Recommendations of the Trustees' Nominating Committee:

At the committee's December 9th meeting, the committee recommended to the General Service Board that Procedure No. 2. "Procedures for Selecting ACM" be updated to reflect that "ACMs have a voice and a vote at the trustees' committee to which they are appointed."

The committee recommended to the General Service Board that Katie Heilmann of Fair Oaks, CA be reappointed for an additional one-year term to serve as an appointed committee member on the trustees' Literature Committee commencing with the July 2021 General Service Board Weekend.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board that Nancy McCarthy remain for an additional one-year term to serve as Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee on the General Service Board, with her term expiring in 2023.

Slates of Trustees and Officers of the General Service Board: The committee reviewed and recommended to the General Service Board the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April 2021, following presentation at the 2021 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A Trustees

Molly Anderson
Hon. Christine Carpenter
Linda Chezem, J.D.
Sr. Judith Ann Karam, C.S.A.
Al Mooney, M.D., FAAFP, FASAM
Nancy McCarthy
Kevin Prior, MBA, CFA, CPA

Class B Trustees (See "Note" below)

Beau Bush
Jimmy Dean
Josh Eggleston
Kathi Fowler
Francis Gilroy
Tommi Hanley
Deborah Koltai
Trish LaNauze
Jan Lembke
Mike Lewis
Irma Van De Bon-Nicol
East Central Regional Trustee-elect
Southeast Regional Trustee-elect
Trustee-at-Large/U.S. Trustee-elect

Note: East Central, Southeast Regional trustees, and Trustee-at-Large/U.S. to be elected at April 2021 Conference.

The committee reviewed and recommended to the General Service Board the following slate of officers of the General Service Board for election at the Second Quarterly Meeting of the General Service Board in April 2021, following presentation at the 2021 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Chairperson:	Linda Chezem, J.D.
First Vice-Chairperson:	Trish LaNauze
Second Vice-Chairperson:	Jan Lembke
Treasurer:	Kevin Prior, MBA, CFA, CPA
Secretary:	Francis Gilroy
Assistant Treasurer:	Paul Konigstein *
Assistant Secretary:	Jeff Wine*

*G.S.O. employees

The committee reviewed and recommended to the General Service Board the following slate of Directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., for election in April 2021, following presentation at the 2021 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Beau Bush	Irma Van De Bon-Nicol
Jimmy Dean	Carolyn Walsh
Vera Farrell	John Weis
Deborah Koltai	Jeff Wine*
General Manager*	

*G.S.O. employees

The committee reviewed and recommended to the General Service Board the following slate of Directors of AA Grapevine, Inc., for election in April 2021, following presentation at the 2021 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Josh Eggleston	Coree Hogan
Ino Fernandez	Mike Lewis
Cindy French	Nancy McCarthy
Francis Gilroy	Albin Zezula*
Tommi Hanley	

*AA Grapevine employee

Trustees' Public Information Committee

Saturday, January 30, 2021

The trustees' Public Information Committee met via videoconference on Saturday, January 30, 2021 at 1 p.m.

Present were: Trish LaNauze, chair; Cathy Beckham, Allison Callis, Christine Carpenter, Josh Eggleston, Ino Fernandez, Michele Grinberg, Tommi Hanley, Deborah Koltai, Stephanie Lyles, Shari Miller, Greg Tobin, Carolyn Walsh and Racy Joseph, secretary.

Also present: Amy Bailey, Beau Bush, Clement Cann, Mary Ferguson, Kathi Fowler, Kevin Fowler, Tracey Godsil, Julie Gonzalez, Debi Keane, Bill Lewis, Ruth Llano, Nancy McCarthy, Kerry Meyer, Al Mooney, Jamey Nehring, Kalilah Prendergast, Newton Pritchett, Gary Provo, David Rosen, Shane Shepard, Yael Shmilovitz, Julisa Soriano, Craig Weidner and Sandy Wright.

Chairperson's remarks: The chair welcomed all committee members and guests, including the corresponding Conference Committee on Public Information chair, Shane Shepard.

Report: The reports of the October 31, 2020 and January 25, 2021 meetings were approved as submitted.

Staff and Communication Services department reports: The committee accepted the reports with appreciation.

Progress report on the development of two PSAs: The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information a progress report of the development of two PSAs.

The committee will continue to meet to review the current rough cuts and to provide feedback. The committee asked that the Conference P.I. chair be included in their next meeting. The committee noted that if draft PSAs are completed prior to the 71st General Service Conference that they be forwarded to the 2021 Conference Public Information Committee for review.

The committee suggested that if a new PSA were approved that the PSA be centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$40,000, in addition to the work of local Public Information committees. The committee also noted that a targeted online paid PSA placement might be explored.

Comprehensive Media Plan (CMP): The committee reviewed a list of items and activities of the CMP subcommittee. The committee reviewed and **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information a report on the progress on the development of a Public Information Comprehensive Media Plan.

Public Information Media Platforms: The committee accepted all Media Platform reports.

The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information a report, Google Ads Performance: December 16, 2020 to January 14, 2021.

The committee noted with appreciation the sharing and inquiries provided by members regarding Google Ads/Grants Advisory Actions and noted that the concerns mentioned in the sharing have been addressed and clarified in prior reports. The committee also noted that the report, Google Ads Performance: December 16, 2020 to January 14, 2021, being forwarded, will also provide additional informational sharing on this topic.

The committee reviewed reports from both corporate boards regarding their respective websites and **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information the 2020 Annual Report on A.A.W.S. Board Oversight of G.S.O.'s A.A. website and the Report from Grapevine Board on Oversight of the Grapevine/La Viña website.

G.S.O. Podcast: The committee discussed the request to create a G.S.O. podcast. The committee reviewed the Communication Services department draft plan to create a podcast and **agreed to forward** the plan to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information.

Anonymity Traditions on Social Media: The committee discussed the request to create a new form of communication on anonymity and social media. The committee also noted the 2020 Public Information committee consideration that the trustees' Public Information Committee continue to discuss this request and that preliminary information be gathered before moving forward. The trustees' committee reviewed potential survey questions that could be shared with the Fellowship and requested that notes be provided to the staff secretary regarding the draft survey questions.

A.A. Membership Survey: The committee reviewed and accepted the report from the Survey Methodology working group on the Triennial A.A. Membership Survey. The committee **agreed to forward** the report to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information including the suggestion that the 2021 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted, including updated pre-survey communications, survey instructions and the option for a digital delivery method.

The committee also noted the importance of updating the questionnaire to expand the gender markers to allow for better reflection of the diversity of our membership and potential members.

Public Information pamphlets: The committee reviewed a request to consider a revised version of the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings." The committee **agreed to forward** to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information the request that the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" be revised.

The committee also discussed the trustees' Public Information Committee working group report on the review of Public Information pamphlets. The committee suggested that further discussion and review of the research grid provided to the full committee is needed to best evaluate the relevancy and content of literature under the purview of Public Information. The committee will add this item to their agenda at their meeting to review the PSA rough cuts and provide any findings from their review of the pamphlets to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information.

P.I. Kit and Workbook: The committee noted receipt of a memo from the A.A.W.S. Board in response to the 2020 P.I. committee consideration that shared concerns on the relevancy of a print copy workbook and kit for P.I. committees. The board also noted the P.I. Committee's suggestions to explore the development of an A.A. service committee app and the possible creation of a new digital PDF version of the P.I. Workbook. The committee asked that the staff secretary include the memo as background to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information.

The committee adjourned at 3:35 p.m.

General Sharing Session

Saturday, January 29, 2021

Regional trustee Mark E. warmly welcomed everyone to the General Sharing Session at the General Service Board Weekend, including our delegate chairs and Class A trustee candidates. The topic was: “Communication Up and Down the Triangle.”

Grapevine director Cindy F. began by presenting the subtopic, “Has the Fellowship Abdicated Their Responsibility to the Service Structure? Making group involvement practical and effective.” Cindy shared about a situation she experienced in 2011. “I was asked by a neighboring area to chair their election assembly. I was psyched about it. When I entered the room, there were a little more than 100 members present. Approximately 25% were GSRs, representing roughly 10% of all the groups in the area. I was shocked... We have a participation problem, and I am not entirely sure what the solution is to solve it.”

Cindy reflected on what could be the reason for low participation. “Are we making service work attractive so that the Fellowship, i.e., individual members, will participate in service beyond their Twelfth Step responsibilities of sponsorship? I often hear ‘I am too busy for that type of service work.’ Are the members getting an idea that service work is exceedingly time consuming and will adversely affect them in some way? Or are they hearing that through service work, they will experience the joy and growth that can be derived from participation in service.”

Cindy asked how we can encourage the participation discussed in Concept IV. “It starts with me in my home group. It is important for me to practice these principles in all my affairs, including the group conscience meetings. It is important for *me* to participate but not rule at my district or area. Here at the board level, it is incumbent on each of us to listen for the quiet, small voice. To pray and meditate on tough decisions, to ask the members we represent for input. Each one of us has the responsibility of listening for the collective conscience of our whole Fellowship. At the bottom of our service structure, we have many voices, and they are providing input. Are we listening?”

General service trustee and Grapevine director Josh E. followed with the subtopic, “Is General Service Disconnected from the Fellowship? Effectively Using Technology to Support Concept I.”

Josh shared that “Concept I places ‘ultimate authority’ and ‘final responsibility’ for A.A. world services in the collective conscience of our Fellowship as whole... I keep picturing the upside-down triangle, as it was depicted three years ago in our Communications Audit. The groups at the top of the triangle overtaken by a series of ever-expanding lines to represent all those groups that do not connect with Conference structure at all. The overarching critique that ‘Information is not traveling up or down the Conference structure effectively or efficiently.’ It is hard to refute many of the findings of that report.”

Josh noted that some of the findings from the Communications Audit include the following: Many A.A. groups exist outside of the Conference structure. Groups connected to the structure are not necessarily well informed. There is poor transfer of information from the boards to the delegates and delegates to others. Barriers limit ideas and funding coming from groups down the triangle. Services are not well aligned to needs up the triangle due to communication gaps.

Josh suggested that we often use technology and communication interchangeably but, "Can technology help with the more intangible purpose of coming to a healthy group conscience? ... Can technology take my inventory, or hear my Fifth Step, or help me to make service more attractive through how I participate? ... Can technology help me to share ideas in an open-minded way that leaves room in my heart for other's opinions, and not just debate my facts vs. your facts to try to prove who is wrong?" With respect to technology and Concept I, Josh said, "Unity, clarity, and inclusivity; none of these are challenges that technology can solve." Then Josh offered a solution with the statement, "But just like in my personal recovery, if I focus on my own spiritual growth and try to put those principles before my personality, I will likely be more welcoming and attractive when I find those who are not connected to our group conscience and invite them in."

Mark thanked both presenters and invited attendees to share. One delegate mentioned that in his experience, technology is bringing members who may have never had a vision of what goes on "behind the scenes" to a now "Bird's eye view." Another delegate conveyed that his area's GSRs do not have two-thirds voice at the area assemblies.

One Class A trustee noted that the pandemic has freed us from the fear of change and has helped us communicate better. She also asked that we consider, "How many faces of color are in this room? ... How many who speak a different language as their first language are here? ... and are we making service attractive for those not in the room?"

A delegate shared experience of his early days in A.A. when newcomers came directly to the Fellowship; however, since the 1980s we often see newcomers after they've been to treatment, where they may have developed a different picture of A.A. than if they had come to us first.

A Regional trustee asked us to consider the message we are sending other members. Are we saying you need to be financially secure, have constant connectivity to the internet, an endless amount of time to spare? Or do we show the spirit of A.A.?

One Class A candidate, who's worked with thousands who have achieved sobriety in A.A., hopes that technology will not alter the effectiveness of A.A. or the essential character of what constitutes A.A.

A couple of delegates rounded out the sharing with a few thoughts. "We do not go to an A.A. meeting to talk about how much we dislike recovery, why do it with service?" "It is hard to listen if no one is talking and we all need work on communication, based on the current data."

General Service Board Sharing Session
Theme: “Communication Up and Down the Triangle”

**Presentation: “Is General Service Disconnected from the Fellowship?
Effectively Using Technology to Support Concept I.”**

Josh E., A.A. Grapevine Director

January 29, 2021

Concept 1 places “ultimate authority” and “final responsibility” for A.A. World Services in the collective conscience of our fellowship as whole. Concept 2 charges all of the 135 members of our General Service Conference with the responsibility to act as the “actual voice” of that collective conscience. In Concepts 3, 4, and 5, we strengthen our Conference, and our collective conscience, with principle. Inclusion, equality, autonomy, consideration, and respect. In Concept 6 our principal responsibility as a Conference is given to its Trustee members to initiate and take active responsibility for, through their actions as the General Service Board. Concept 7 is a reminder that this thing only works if we do it together. In Concept 8, The General Service Board takes the large burden of active responsibility and passes much of it to our two corporations for execution, providing custodial oversight by selecting the directors of those corporations’ boards. Concept 9 says let’s inspire, not intimidate or interfere. Concept 10 says define your lane and stay in it. Concept 11 says find amazing teammates and treat them as such, and Concept 12 again strengthens the whole process, and hopefully each decision, with principle.

Sounds like a program that works, even in rough waters, but do we find ourselves talking to ourselves? Is

I keep picturing the upside-down triangle, as it was depicted 3 years ago in our Communications Audit. The groups at the top of the triangle overtaken by a series of ever-expanding lines to represent all those groups that don’t connect with Conference structure at all. The overarching critique that “Information is not traveling up or down the Conference Structure effectively or efficiently.” It’s hard to refute many of the findings of that report.

Their research suggested:

1. Many A.A. groups exist outside of the Conference Structure.
2. Groups Connected to the structure are not necessarily well informed.
3. There is poor transfer of information from Boards to Delegates and Delegates to others.
4. Barriers limit ideas and funding coming from groups down the triangle.
5. Services are not well aligned to needs up the triangle due to communication gaps.

When I read that a few years ago it felt daunting. When saying it tonight, it still sounds daunting. But then I think of all of the advancements we've made in just the three years since that report was received. The Meeting Guide app has connected AA's around both our countries and out into the broader world. It was a critical tool as our groups and members flooded to the internet for virtual meetings with the world around them in crisis. AA Grapevine has advanced its online presence with a redesigned website experience which was used by over 250,000 alcoholics in April of 2020 as lockdowns ensued and they were seeking connection. AA World Services has created a Communications Department to begin to focus outward communications and announcements through a single source. The long task of revitalizing very out of date systems is now beginning to bear fruit in Fellowship Connect and our refreshed Conference Dashboard. Internally more modern project management softwares and processes are beginning to be explored and, in some departments, adopted.

There are a lot of platforms and systems that would allow us to more actively connect with the fellowship directly. We continue to explore how we can make our message more engaging, inviting, and relevant while ensuring that information is transmitted clearly and accurately. I am optimistic about the progress we have made and the path ahead. I think we will continue to improve in this area as we gain more experience.

One of the things I find interesting is we often use technology and communication almost interchangeably. Communication in a simple definition is "the imparting or exchanging of information or news" Technology is "the application of scientific knowledge for practical purpose." Technology can help me with the practical purpose of exchanging information or news. We can use a variety of great tools and systems to *improve* the exchange of information or news. We are doing that currently and it continues to evolve and improve.

I don't actually think that we have a technology problem. I think as a group that we all have the same goal of using modern communication tools to connect. Recent events have broken down old barriers to adoption. In an age of zoom meetings, old concerns have been met with the kind of experience and acceptance that necessity can inspire. Our disconnection to those members who don't want to participate in General Service is still about attraction, or the lack of it.

Can technology help with the more intangible purpose of coming to a healthy group conscience? Can it make our discussions or debate more spiritual in nature? Can technology take my inventory, or hear my 5th step, or help me to make service more attractive through how I participate. Can technology help me to share ideas in an open-minded way that leaves room in my heart for other's opinions, and not just debate my facts vs your facts to try to prove who's wrong. Is there an app that helps you "turn it over"?

I think one of the principle challenges we have to communication up and down the triangle is unity, our first tradition. If we can't walk into the room in the unity of Tradition 1, we can't form a group conscience in Tradition 2. It will not work. As a Conference, if we don't present unity out in the fellowship how attractive is participation in General Service? If

General Service isn't attractive why would those groups from the out beyond the top of our triangle want to come down and connect? Unity does not mean uniformity, but it does require that when we come to decisions as a group, that we support those decisions as a group when we leave the meeting. If we can't come together in unity and *leave* in unity, we haven't actually formed a group conscience. If I left my Homegroup's business meeting, and found you outside in the parking lot to tell you how stupid my group was for having made a ridiculous decision would you be excited to join that group or attend its meeting? I have experienced this in a variety of ways from Homegroup's, Board Meetings, Committee Meetings, and numerous General Service Conferences. I have been guilty of it myself. I still struggle with my ego, and my self-righteousness. But when I can find the place in my heart where you are not wrong, and I am not right, but we are just two people sharing ideas in the hopes of making the best decision for Alcoholics Anonymous it becomes a pleasure to serve. It makes the work more useful to the organization, it makes the experience more pleasant for the participant, and it make the process more attractive to the fellowship as a whole. If *what* we talk about is relevant, and *how* we talk about it is with love and respect, people will want to engage.

I think a second challenge to our communication up and down the triangle is actually that of over-communication. I am a huge believer in engagement, transparency, and open dialogue. But we are talking about too many things, in too much detail, without enough prioritization of subject, material or content. We lack focus. The background for this weekend alone contains almost 1,400 pages and that doesn't include the thousands of pages of corporate board background. We have two-hour meetings with 300 pages of content to review. There is a potential of 97 agenda items at the conference this year. Imagine if we spent *more* time fully discussing *less* items each year. We might find that more complete conversation would allow for greater consensus in our conclusions and decisions which could offer greater faith in the group conscience that came before. If we spend too much time in minutiae as opposed to focusing the discussion policy and targeted goals, how attractive is that to a fellowship that can make its own websites, content, and social media pages on the computer in their pocket. They may get so far out ahead of our conversations that it becomes a bridge too far to cross.

A last challenge I'll touch on really briefly that we often face is those disconnected from the General Service process because they don't feel their experience is valued. Those members who feel marginalized or struggle to be seen or heard. While this is another area that I am optimistic about as we continue to focus on it as an organization, I do think some of the conversations ahead will require a great amount patience and open-mindedness. If we invite, participation, opinion and experience that may feel different then our historical experience, and take no action as a result, we will likely just lose all those participants. If we truly want to reach the widest possible group conscience and connect to the fellowship as a whole, that is going to involve a massive level of acceptance of individual's experiences that are different than my own. To accomplish that will require eliminating the idea that "that's how we've always done it." is a reason, instead of just a crutch.

Unity, clarity, and inclusivity; none of these are challenges that technology can solve. But, just like in my personal recovery, if I focus on my own spiritual growth and try to put those principals before my personality I will likely be more welcoming and attractive when I find those who aren't connected to our group conscience and invite them in, whether at my Homegroup, in an online forum, or at a General Service Conference.

General Service Board Sharing Session
Theme: “Communication Up and Down the Triangle”

Presentation: “Has the Fellowship Abdicated Their Responsibility to the Service Structure? Making Group Involvement Practical and Effective.”

Cindy F., A.A. Grapevine Director

January 29, 2021

Thank you so much Mark for this loving invitation and opportunity to share my experience, strength, and hope in communicating up and down the triangle. When I first received the topic of “Has the fellowship abdicated their responsibility to the service structure? Making group involvement practical and effective.” I thought, “no, of course not, no one’s abdicating their responsibility”. We claim our responsibility for maintaining world services, through active participation at all levels of our service structure. What does this look like? I am sure that if you ask a group how they make decisions, they will explain that they hold a group conscience to discuss, maybe argue, and then vote. On the other end of the spectrum, the Conference would probably say something like, “we extensively discuss the pros and cons of every issue within the committees. The committees bring the output of that discussion to the floor, and we do it all over again. We have thoroughly discussed each item and therefore, an informed group conscience.” But have we?

I remember a situation in 2011, I was asked by a neighboring area to chair their election assembly. I was psyched about it. When I enter the room, there were a little more than 100 members present. Approximately 25% were GSRs, representing roughly 10% of all the groups in the Area. I was shocked. In my area, we were always frustrated that we only have about 15-20% participation by GSRs at an Area Assembly. We have a participation problem, and I am not entirely sure what the solution is to solve it.

As I thought about it a little bit longer, I realized that we still have challenges getting people to volunteer for service work. Seems that the 80/20 rule is alive and well in AA. I guess my question is truly are we making service work attractive so that the fellowship, i.e., individual members, will participate in service beyond there 12 step responsibilities of sponsorship.

Does the fellowship know that there is a service structure? Do they know where they fit in? Is there an abdication of their responsibility or a misunderstanding of their role in service? I would propose that the Fellowship may not think that “service” work outside of their Home Group is something *they* need to do. In **The AA Group** pamphlet it starts with, “The entire structure of A.A. depends upon the participation and conscience of the individual groups, and how each of these groups conducts its affairs has a ripple effect on A.A. everywhere. Thus, we are ever individually conscious of our responsibility for our own sobriety and, as a group, for carrying the A.A. message to the suffering alcoholic who reaches out to us for help.” Later in the pamphlet it states, “Group service from coffee maker to secretary, treasurer or chairperson is usually the way members first experience the joy and growth that can be derived from a service.” We discuss much

about the service performed within the AA group and its responsibility to the suffering alcoholic. We also discuss what the General Service Office does, but, in my humble opinion, the pamphlet may be light on tying the groups to the responsibility they have for AA as a whole, as explained in Concept 1. We say in multiple places within our literature that the General Service Representative acts as the important liaison between the group and A.A. as a whole — carrying the group's voice to the general service structure and reporting news of the greater Fellowship back to the home group. If there is strong district present, GSRs thrive; if not, then the message to the groups is their group service representative — is simply a communication channel. While that is true, in some respect, I would suggest that we do not really drive home Concept 1 throughout our AA Group pamphlet. Our focus on Tradition 1 which speaks of Unity and our common welfare, but I think that may keep the focus within the groups' common welfare and not focused on AA as a whole.

I often hear that I am too busy for that type of service work. Are the members getting an idea that service work is exceedingly time consuming and will adversely affect them in some way? Or are they hearing that through service work, they will experience the joy and growth that can be derived from a participating in service. I was told early on that if I am too busy, I am not in balance, and I need to put my Higher Power's Will back where it belongs — ahead of mine. I was taught by my old timers that Sponsorship is my 12-step responsibility in action. But to truly do service work as part of AA's Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity, and Service, it is important for me to participate in the service related to the group and outside of my group. I was taught that my step work is how I participate in my Recovery, that my service to my homegroup is how I participate in Unity, and my service outside of the group, is my demonstration of our third legacy of Service.

When preparing for this topic, the first thing I thought about was Concept One. ***The final responsibility and ultimate authority for a world services should always reside in the collective conscience of our whole fellowship.*** Bill wrote that the AA groups hold Ultimate Responsibility, and final authority for our World Services — those special elements of overall service activity which make it possible for our society function as a whole. The groups assumed that responsibility at the Saint Louis International Convention of 1955. I wonder if the groups were listening.

Bill wrote that the average member is preoccupied with his group life and in his own 12 stepping." Most of them know nothing of the AA World Services, not one member in 1000 could tell who the Trustees were, and 10s of thousands already owed their chance of sobriety to the little noticed activity of our Trustees in General Services. But few realized this to be true. I would submit to you, that this is still true today.

Bill writes that the main principles of Tradition Two are crystal clear; the AA groups are to be the final authority; their leaders are to be entrusted with delegated responsibilities. This Tradition is the basis of our collective group conscience.

So, it seems to me that in our fellowship, our responsibility is clearly defined. Our service structure has been built with the ultimate responsibility to care for our world services. In

developing an affective group conscience, the groups must *participate* to be heard. I was also taught that in a group conscience, we need to listen. A quiet, small voice may be the voice of our Higher Power – trying to get a word in edgewise.

It is so important to lead by example, and that means that at all levels of our structure, We must encourage the Right of Participation, our 4th Concept, throughout the service structure. How do we do this? It starts with me in my homegroup. It is important for me to practice these principles in all my affairs, including the group conscience meetings. It is important for *me* to participate but not rule at my District or Area. Here at the board level, it is incumbent on each of us to listen for the quiet, small voice. To pray and meditate on tough decisions, to ask the members we represent for input. Each one of us has the responsibility of listening for the collective conscience of our whole Fellowship. At the bottom of our service structure, we have many voices, and they are providing input. Are we listening?

I would also ask you to consider how a newcomer, whether they are new to AA in your homegroup, a new Delegate to the conference, or a new member of one of our Boards – do they see something that looks like it is lightly structured, informed, and effective or do they see chaos, power driven decision makers, and a true lack of their Right of Participation?

We must take responsibility of our world services – Joy and growth are the gifts we receive and is what awaits us in service.

Trustees' activities since the November 2020 meeting:

Cathy Beckham

November 4	Post Board Weekend Report Back to SE Region
November 5	TLC RIPTAB Subcommittee Meeting
November 6	Post Board Weekend Zoom with Conference Agenda Chair
November 9	Post Board Weekend Zoom with Delegate Chair
	Post Board Weekend Zoom with Policy & Admissions Chair
November 11	SSAASA VI Planning Meeting
November 12	TLC RIPTAB Subcommittee Meeting
November 14	Big Book Presentation Area 78
November 16	Delegates Get-Together Planning Meeting
November 17	Trustees Planning & Sharing Zoom
November 23	TLC RIPTAB Subcommittee Meeting
November 25	SSAASA VI Planning Meeting
December 1	TGSCC Agenda and Background Planning Zoom
December 2	SSAASA VI Planning Meeting
December 5	US/CAN East Virtual Forum
December 7	TLC RIPTAB Subcommittee Meeting
December 10	GSB Strategic Plan Ad-Hoc committee meeting
December 12	Grapevine Board Meeting
December 14	TLC RIPTAB Subcommittee Meeting
December 17	Proposed Agenda Item Disposition Meeting
January 2	Big Book Presentation – Area 50
January 6	SSAASA VI Planning Meeting
January 7	TLC RIPTAB Subcommittee Meeting
January 9 – 10	Area 14 Assembly
January 11	Pre Board Weekend Zoom – Conference Committee on Agenda
January 13	Pre Board Weekend Zoom – Report & Charter committee
January 16	Area 73 Agenda Planning
January 20	Pre Board Weekend Zoom – Policy & Admissions committee
January 22	Conference Chair Orientation
January 24	Pre Board Weekend Zoom with Delegate Chair
	Pre Board Weekend Zoom with Agenda Committee Chair
January 25	Pre Board Weekend Zoom with Policy & Admissions Committee Chair
	GSB Strategic Planning Meeting
January 29	A.A.W.S./GV Board Meeting
Jan. 30 – Feb. 1	GSB Quarterly Meeting

Jimmy Dean

November 8 – 9	Finance Advisory Body (FAB) Meeting (Zoom)
November 10	ICOAA Steering Committee Meeting (Zoom)
November 12	AAWS IAC Executive Session (Zoom)
November 13 – 15	Area 10 (Colorado) Assembly (Zoom)
November 16	AAWS Delta Committee Meeting (Zoom)
November 17	GSB Trustees Planning/Sharing Session (Zoom)
November 18	AAWS Self Support Sub-Committee Meeting (Zoom)

November 19	GSB Retirement Committee (Zoom)
November 20	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
November 23	GSB Sub-Committee on GM Relationship to Boards (Zoom)
November 25	AAWS IAC Meeting (Zoom)
November 27	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
November 30	AAWS Finance w/Paul & Zenaida Meeting (Zoom)
December 1	GM Search Discussion Meeting (Zoom)
December 3	GM Search – Meeting with WittKieffer (Zoom)
	Trustees' Finance Committee 7 th Tradition Sub-Committee (Zoom)
December 4	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
December 5	Eastern USCAN (Zoom)
	Delegate Conference Committee Selection Training (Zoom)
December 7	Southwest Regional Delegates Bring to Date (Zoom)
December 8	Finance Advisory Body (FAB) Meeting (Zoom)
	Delegate Conference Committee Selection (Zoom)
December 9	AAWS Nominating Committee (Zoom)
	AAWS Board Executive Session (Zoom)
December 10	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
	ICOOA Steering Committee Meeting (Zoom)
December 11	AAWS Board Regular Meeting (Zoom)
December 18	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
	AAWS Executive Session (Zoom)
December 19	Western USCAN (Zoom)
December 21	Trustees' Finance Committee 7 th Tradition Sub-Committee (Zoom)
December 29	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
January 5	AAWS IAC Meeting (Zoom)
January 8	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
January 11	Trustees' Finance Committee 7 th Tradition Sub-Committee (Zoom)
January 12	Finance Advisory Body (FABV) Meeting (Zoom)
	AAWS Self-Support Sub-Committee Meeting (Zoom)
	2021 Budget Review Meeting AAWS Finance/TFC (Zoom)
January 14	AAWS IAC Executive Session (Zoom)
January 15	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
	AAWS/Management Bring to Date Meeting (Zoom)
January 16	Area 25 (Kansas) Assembly Trustee Report (Zoom)
January 19	AAWS Delta Committee Meeting (Zoom)
January 20	AAWS IAC Meeting (Zoom)
January 22	GSC Delegate Chair Orientation (Zoom)
	AAWS IAC Executive Session (Zoom)
January 23	GM Search Committee Meeting (Zoom)
January 26	AAWS Nominating Meeting (Zoom)
January 29	AAWS Board Regular Meeting (Zoom)
Jan. 30 – Feb. 1	General Service Board Meeting

Josh Eggleston

November 4	GV Finance Subcommittee Meeting
November 14	Interviewed for Boiled Owl Podcast
November 17	GV Finance Subcommittee Meeting
	GSB Trustees Sharing Planning and Sharing Session

November 19	Retirement Committee
December 5	Virtual US/CAN Forum - East
	Review and Demo of Delegate Committee assignment automation
December 8	Finance Advisory Body Meeting
	Committee Selection Process for 71st Conference Incoming Delegates
December 12	AA Grapevine Board Meeting
January 5	Coordination of initiatives Ad Hoc Committee Meeting
January 7	Grapevine Nominating Committee Meeting
	Instagram Report Review
January 9 – 10	Kentucky Area Assembly
January 11	Ad Hoc Google / 7th Tradition Committee
January 12	2020 Budget Review
January 18	Grapevine Finance
January 19	Subcommittee on Conference Improvements
January 22	Delegate Conference Committee Chair Orientation
January 23	Area 87 Public Information Workshop
	Grapevine Executive Session
January 25	Trustee's PI Meeting
January 26	Coordination of initiatives Ad Hoc Committee Meeting
	Audit Committee Meeting
	NTD Interviews
January 28	GSB General Sharing Session
January 29	A.A. Grapevine Board Meeting
Jan. 30 – Feb. 1	GSB Meetings

Kathi Fowler

AAGV Staff meetings - EVERY Wednesday through January 27, 2021

November 4	AAGV Vendor conf. call
	Trustee Report to Pacific Region Delegates
November 5	GSO Employee Huddle
	Area 6 Assembly election practice
November 7	CNCA Chaired Elections
November 10	ICOAA Conference Call
	Board Chairs Call
November 11	Meeting with AAGV employees Nivia and Janet
	Trustee Report at Phoenix meeting
November 12	Video call with AAGV/LV Conference Committee Chair
	Video call with C. C. on Trustees Chair
November 13	Virtual US/Can practice session
November 17	AAGV Vendor meeting
	GSB Planning and Sharing Session
	Report for Pacific Region delegates
November 18	Conference call with Paul CFO
	Self Support Committee Meeting
November 21 – 22	Area 93, Central California Election Assembly
November 22	AAGV presentation for Area 31 MA
November 23	GM Ad Hoc Committee
November 28	Service Workshop for group "Basic AA"

November 29	Video call with C. C. on Trustees Chair
November 30	Video call with AAGV/LV Conference Committee Chair
December 1, 4	Class A Interviews
December 2	US/Can practice
December 3	Concept 8 talk for group
December 5	Virtual US/Can East Presenter
December 7	AAGV Finance Committee Meeting
December 8	GSB Finance Advisory Board
	Board Chairs Conference Call
	Area 5 District meeting Concept 12
December 9	TIC Ad hoc meeting
	TNC Committee meeting
December 10	Strategic Planning Committee Meeting
	Area 02 Election for TAL US Candidate
December 12	GV/LV Board meeting, Zoom Call
December 14	AAGV Vendor conference
December 15	AAGV and No. Cal H and I-Electronic Literature Call
December 16	Call with Diana to go over TNC Agenda
	Virtual US/Can West walkthrough
December 18	Met with Stephanie about Acting Publisher
December 19	Virtual US/Can Regional Trustee Host
December 29	TIC Ad Hoc Committee Call
January 4	TNC Committee
January 7	AAGV Committee meeting about Acting Publisher
	TIC Ad Hoc Committee Meeting
January 9 – 10	Speak and present at Area 17 Hawaii Assembly-Virtual
January 12	Finance Advisory Board Meeting
	Self Support Committee
	Board Chair Conference Call
January 13	4 Class A Candidate Interviews
January 14	Conference Call with AAGV Vendor
	4 Class A Candidate Interviews
January 15	3 Class A Candidate Interviews
January 16	AAGV/LV Conference Committee Meeting
	Trustee Report Area 92
January 18	Interview for Acting Publisher
	Meeting with the Conference Committee on Trustees
January 22	GSC Committee Chair Orientation
January 23	AAGV Executive Session
January 24	Group Inventory Chair
January 25	HR meeting AAGV
	Strategic Planning Committee Meeting
January 26	TNC Executive Committee Meeting
	Audit Committee Meeting
January 27	Greg's Farewell Event
 Francis Gilroy	
November 4, 17	AA Grapevine Inc., Finance Subcommittee Meeting
November 4, 11	Area 11 (Connecticut) Election Assembly Planning Session(s)

November 5	US/Canada Forum Planning Session
November 7	Area 47 (Central New York) DCM Summit
November 8	Area 49 (Southeast New York) Staten Island Presentation to DCMs
November 10	Northeast Regional Alternate Delegates Meeting Videoconference with GSO Archivist and the Delegate Archives Chair
November 13	US/Canada Forum-East AA Grapevine Planning Session
November 13 – 15	Area 59 (Eastern Pennsylvania) Election Assembly
November 15	Northeast Regional AA Service Assembly Inventory Planning Committee Area 11 (Connecticut) Election Assembly Northeast Regional Delegates and Alternates Meeting
November 17	GSB Trustees Planning and Sharing Session
November 18	Area 30 (Eastern Mass.) Area Committee Meeting (Alternate's Day)
November 21	Area 43 (New Hampshire) Area Assembly (Trustee-at-Large Nominee)
November 22	Area 31 (Western Massachusetts) AA Grapevine Workshop Area 30 (Eastern Massachusetts) Grapevine and La Viña Meeting
November 23	General Service Board General Manager Affiliates Subcommittee Interview with AA Grapevine, Inc.'s Nontrustee Director Nominee
November 27 – 29	CSCYPAA 35 (Connecticut State Conference of Young People in AA)
November 30	Area 38 (Missouri) "Threads of Recovery" (Corrections and Grapevine)
December 1	North America (US and Canada) Alternate Delegates Meeting
December 2 – 5	US/Canada Forum-East (and Planning Sessions)
December 3	Area 30 (Eastern Massachusetts) AA Service Manual Study
December 6	Area 49 (SENY) "The Grapevine and AA's Three Legacies" Workshop
December 7	AA Grapevine Inc., Finance Subcommittee Meeting
December 8	Northeast Regional Alternate Delegates Meeting
December 11	AA World Services, Inc. Board Meeting
December 12	AA Grapevine, Inc. Board Meeting
December 13	Area 45 (Southern New Jersey) "Recovery Through Service" Workshop
December 15	General Service Board General Manager Affiliates Subcommittee
December 16, 19	US/Canada Forum-West (and Planning Session)
December 17	AAGV Executive Session, Search for Acting Publisher
December 20	Northeast Regional AA Service Assembly Inventory Planning Committee Northeast Regional Delegates and Alternates Meeting
December 22	Northeast Regional Alternate Delegates Meeting
December 23	Area 11 (Connecticut) District 11 Formation Meeting
December 24	Area 28 (Maine) Christmas Alkathon
December 31	Area 44 (Northern New Jersey) District 24 New Year's Eve Alkathon
January 1	North America (US and Canada) Alternate Delegates Meeting
January 2	Area 50 (Western New York) General Service Assembly MSCYPAA (Mass State Conference of Young People in AA) Host NECYPAA (New England Conference of YPAA) Virtual Conference

January 4, 10, 24	Northeast Regional AA Service Assembly Inventory Planning Committee
January 7, 18, 23 January 8	AAGV Executive Session, Search for Acting Publisher Teleconference with GSO Archivist and the Delegate Archives Chair
January 9, 14 January 9	Trustees Dashboard Orientation Training Session, and Q & A Area 44 (Northern New Jersey) Tradition 2 Workshop
January 10	Area 30 (Eastern Massachusetts) General Service Assembly
January 12	Discuss Return to Workplace with GM-GSO and Interim GM-GSO 2021 Budget Review Meeting
January 12	Northeast Regional Alternate Delegates Meeting
January 15	METS (Meeting, Events, and Travel Services) to discuss NERF 2023 Area 43 (New Hampshire) to discuss Fellowship Connection
January 16	National Public Information Working Group
January 17	Northeast Regional AA Service Assembly Inventory Planning Committee Northeast Regional Delegates and Alternates Meeting
January 19	Area 30 and 31 Mass State Convention Planning in a COVID-Era
January 21	Conference Committee on Archives "Meet and Greet" Area 12, 28 & 29 (Delaware, Maine & Maryland) Service Manual Study
January 22	Conference Delegate Chairs Orientation Session
January 26	Audit Committee Meeting Pre-Audit Presentation
January 27	Northeast Regional AA Service Assembly Inventory Meeting
January 29	AA Grapevine, Inc. Board Meeting
Jan. 30 – Feb 1	General Service Board Quarterly Meeting

Michele Grinberg

November 7	Area 87 Quebec convention, speaker
November 16	Participation at concepts meetings —Park Slope Caton, Brooklyn group
November 21	Japan Shonan group – Attended and extended greetings "The Global Kitchen Table."
November 28 – 30	World Service Meeting – Chair
December 5	Virtual US/CAN Forum – East – Participated and presented
December 11	Altered Attitudes Group [based in Sweden]. "World Bill's sobriety birthday 12x12x12." Spoke on concept 12
December 12	World Service Meeting – Chair
December 19	Virtual US/CAN Forum – West – Participated and presented
December 21	Participation at concepts meetings —Park Slope Caton, Brooklyn group
January 18	Participation at concepts meetings — Park Slope Caton, Brooklyn group

Trish LaNauze

November 2	Phone Meeting with Public Information Staff Secretary
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November 5	Phone Meeting with International Desk consultant re: Int'l Cttee Sub-Committee
November 7	Area 6 Northern California Voting Assembly
November 8	Western Canada Regional Meeting
November 11	Phone meeting with Alberto C., Argentina World Service Meeting Delegate re: North/South
November 11	Phone meeting with Conference PI Committee Chair Shane S.
November 12	Trustees' International Committee sub-committee on International Travel
	REDELA (Meeting of the Americas) Sharing Session organized by Paraguay (Teleconference)
	Eastern Canada Regional Meeting re North/South Project
November 15	North East Regional Meeting
November 16	Communications and Assets Meeting
	Inter-Area Remote Communities Meeting re North/South Project
November 17	Trustees Planning and Sharing Meeting
November 20	Search Committee Meeting
November 21	World Service Meeting Mock Session
November 23	Public Information Pamphlet Working Group
November 24	Phone Meeting with PI Staff Secretary
November 27	Search Committee Meeting
	REDELA (Meeting of the Americas) Sharing Session organized by Paraguay (Teleconference)
November 28 – 30	World Service Meeting
November 30	National Corrections Committee Meeting
December 2	US/CAN Forum run-through
	Area 79 Upper Fraser Valley Corrections Committee
December 4	Search Committee Meeting
December 5	Eastern US/CAN Forum
December 8	Phone meeting with International Desk consultant
	Services Touchpoint Meeting
December 9	Trustees' International Committee sub-committee on International Travel
December 10	Search Committee Meeting
December 11	AAWS Meeting
December 12	World Service Meeting Gratitude Meeting and Stepping Stones Tour
December 12	Grapevine Board Meeting
December 13	Western Canada Regional Meeting
December 15	Entity Wide Projects Ad Hoc Committee
December 17	Public Information/Comprehensive Media Plan Meeting
	REDELA (Meeting of the Americas) Sharing Session organized by Paraguay (Teleconference)
	Eastern Canada Regional Meeting
December 18	Search Committee meeting
December 19	Western US/CAN Forum
December 20	XIII Seminario Latinoamerica de AA
December 21	Phone Meeting with PI Staff Secretary
December 22	Meeting with International Desk Consultant
	Services Touchpoint Meeting

December 29	Search Committee Meeting Phone Meeting with Staff-Co-Ordinator re: Orientation Trustees' International Committee sub-committee on International Travel
January 4	Phone Meeting with PI Secretary
January 5	Entity Wide Projects Ad Hoc Committee Services Touchpoint Meeting
January 6	Phone Meeting with Conference PI Chair Shane S.
January 7	Internal North/South Project Meeting Trustees at Large/International Desk meeting Trustees' International Committee sub-committee on International Travel
January 8	Meeting with International Desk re North/South project Search Committee Meeting Joint meeting with Argentina re: North/South project
January 10	Phone meeting re: Orientation Manual
January 12	Meeting with International Desk consultant re North/South project
January 14	Dashboard walk-through
January 15	Phone call with Ravi D. AARCISB (emerging service entity) Search Committee Meeting Joint meeting with Argentina re: North/South project Phone Meeting with PI Staff Secretary
January 17	Workshop in Russia – AARCISB Western Canada Regional Meeting
January 19	Internal North/South Project Meeting Services Touchpoint Meeting
January 20	Conference Public Information Committee Meeting
January 21	Trustees at Large/International Desk meeting REDELA (Meeting of the Americas) Sharing Session organized by Paraguay (Teleconference)
January 22	Delegate Chair Orientation Joint meeting with Argentina re: North/South project
January 23	Search Committee Meeting
January 25	Special Trustees PI Committee Meeting
January 27	Phone Meeting with PI Staff Secretary
January 29	AAWS Board Meeting
Jan. 30 – Feb. 1	General Service Board Weekend

Jan Lembke

November 4	Call with Chair of Conference Committee ICRF
November 7 – 8	Area 86 Assembly
November 11	Trustees' Nominating Committee (TNC)
November 12	ECR Report back with region
November 17	Trustees' Planning & Sharing
December 1	TNC – Class A Interviews
December 5	Eastern US/Can Forum
December 9	A.A.W.S. Nominating Committee A.A.W.S. Executive Session Trustees' Nominating Committee (TNC)

December 10	A.A.W.S. Strategic Planning
December 11	A.A.W.S. Board Meeting
December 17	ECR Meeting
December 18	A.A.W.S. Board Meeting
December 19	Western US/Can Forum
December 29	Eastern Canada Region Delegate Orientation Sub Committee
January 5	Trustees' Nominating Committee (TNC) – reconvene
January 12	A.A.W.S. – 2021 Budget meeting
January 13	TNC – Class A Interviews
January 14	TNC – Class A Interviews
January 15	A.A.W.S. Info Sharing
	TNC – Class A Interviews
January 19	ECR Delegates' Orientation Sub Committee
January 22	2021 Conference Committee Chair Orientation
January 25	CERAASA Steering Committee meeting
January 26	Trustees Nominating Committee
	A.A.W.S. Nominating Committee
January 27	A.A.W.S. – GT Farewell
January 29	A.A.W.S. Board Meeting
Jan 30 – Feb 1	General Service Board weekend

Nancy McCarthy

November 10	Call with Conference Chair
November 12	International Travel Meeting
November 13	USCAN training meeting
November 17	Trustee Planning and Sharing Meeting
December 3	GV Strategic Planning Meeting/GV Meeting
December 5	US/CAN East Forum
December 6	SENY Area 49-The Grapevine and AA's Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service
December 9	Meeting with staff for Entity wide Policy meeting
December 10	GSB Strategic Planning Meeting
December 11	Grapevine Meeting/AAWS Board Meeting
December 12	Grapevine Board Meeting
December 13	Area 45, District 24 Southern NJ—Recovery thru Service Workshop
December 15	Electronic Literature Meeting-GV
	GSB Policy Process Planning Meeting
December 16	Virtual US/CAN ZOOM practice
December 17	Grapevine Meeting
December 19	Virtual US/CAN West Forum
January 2	Corrections Workshop
January 5	Entity Wide Policy Meeting
January 7	International Travel Committee Meeting
	Grapevine Meeting
January 12	Conference Call with Corrections Conference Committee Meeting
January 18	Interview for Grapevine
January 21	TLC Disposition Meeting
January 23	California Northern Interior Area PI/CPC Workshop

January 25	GV Executive Meeting
January 26	Strategic Planning Meeting
January 27	Entity Wide Policy Meeting
January 29	Meeting with Class A Candidate
	Grapevine Board Meeting

Newton Pritchett

November 12	REDELA Delegates' Get-Together
November 17	General Service Board Planning and Sharing Session
November 21	World Service Meeting Orientation
November 26	REDELA Delegates' Get-Together
November 28 – 30	26th World Service Meeting
December 1	Trustees' Nominating Committee - Class A Trustee Candidate Interviews
December 4	68th Argentina A.A. Anniversary
December 5	Eastern U.S./Can Forum
December 9	Trustees' Nominating Committee Meeting
December 11	A.A.W.S. Board Meeting – Guest
December 12	Stepping Stones Tour for World Service Meeting Delegates and Guests
December 16	Western U.S./Can Forum
December 17	REDELA Delegates' Get-Together
December 18	Ad Hoc Bylaws Committee Meeting
December 20	13th Latin American Spiritual Principles That Guide Us Conference
January 5	Trustees' Nominating Committee Meeting
January 13 – 15	Trustees' Nominating Committee – Class A Trustee Candidate Interviews
January 15	North-South Forum Planning Committee
January 17	AACIS & Baltic Countries Workshop
January 19	North-South Forum Planning Session
January 21	REDELA Delegates' Get-Together
January 25	Ad Hoc Bylaws Committee Meeting
January 26	Trustees Nominating Committee Meeting

Irma Van De Bon-Nicol

November 8	Western Canada Regional Meeting
November 14	Area 78 Literature Presentation (attended as an observer)
	District 6 Area 91 Assisted with Elections
November 17	GSB Sharing and Planning Session
November 29	WRAASA Committee Meeting
November 30	WRAASA 2021 draft Agenda created
December 5	US/Can Regional Forum East
December 12	District 6 Area 91 (attended as a guest)
December 13	WRAASA Committee Meeting
	Western Canada Regional Meeting
December 19	US/Can Regional Forum West (moderated a panel)
December 21	Phone Meeting with Trustee Buddy
January 3	WRAASA Committee Meeting

January 6	Meeting with Area 91 Delegate (re Area Committee Meeting)
January 7	Service Manual Study
January 8	WRAASA History of participation Area 91 draft
January 14	Dashboard Tutorial
	Service Manual Study
January 17	WRAASA Committee Meeting
	Western Canada Regional Meeting
January 21	Service Manual Study
January 27	Greg's Farewell Celebration
	Meeting with Area 80 Delegate
January 28	Meeting with Area 80 Delegate
January 29	A.A.W.S. Board Meeting (attended as an observer)
January 30 – 31	Trustee Committee Meetings
	1728 Meeting Speaker (Tradition X11)
February 1	General Service Board Meeting